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Business Standard

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How markets performed last week

	Nov 6	% chg over Dec 31, '25 One-week	Local currency	in US$
Sensex#	80,999	8.8	-5.0	-9.0
Nifty#	24,986	8.4	-4.4	-8.5
Dow Jones	51,286	-0.9	6.7	6.7
Nasdaq	24,579	-3.4	5.8	5.8
Hang Seng	24,482	5.1	-4.5	-5.2
Nikkei	57,435	-9.3	14.1	12.8
FTSE	10,674	-0.5	7.5	6.5
DAX	25,820	0.0	5.4	0.0

*Change (%) over previous week; #As on Nov 8 Source: Bloomberg



WORLD 6

Eisenkot gets first shot at forming Israeli govt



POLITICS 8

PM: Maoists gone, but now 'dimagi Naxals' targeting Constitution

TECHNOLOGY 4.0 14

Enterprises face a reckoning in their AI costs



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IN BRIEF

Coca-Cola's largest India bottler cements position in South, West

Hindustan Coca-Cola Holdings Ltd , the holding company of Coca-Cola's Indian bottling business, has established a dominant position in the Southern and Western parts of the country through a multi-year re-franchising process. It has the licence to prepare, package, distribute, and sell The Coca-Cola Company's beverages exclusively in 10 states and four Union territories (UTs), keeping its operations concentrated in the South and West. HCCH can sell in all of Andhra Pradesh, Telangana, Maharashtra, Madhya Pradesh, Gujarat and the UTs of Andaman and Nicobar Islands, and Lakshadweep, reports SHARLEEN D'SOUZA 2

Frequent MCA portal glitches hit biz ops

From delaying company incorporation and board appointments to holding up access to freshly raised capital, persistent glitches on the Ministry of Corporate Affairs' (MCA) portal are disrupting corporate operations, company secretaries said. Repeated deadline extensions for statutory filings have offered companies temporary relief but failed to address the underlying technology problems, reports SHUBHAM KUMAR 4

Business Standard
SPECIALS ON MONDAY

BANKER'S TRUST 15
Empty bank accounts in Vigilance Week
Are IT-trained staff available when regular operators are on leave? Are daily-waged support workers restricted to non-sensitive areas? Banks need to address these questions.
TAMAL BANDYOPADHYAY writes

STATSGURU 15
Demonetisation puzzles between cash and clicks

POLITICS 8
Of student politics and Muslim leadership

RESULTS RECKONER
Quarter ended Sep 30, 2026;
Common sample of 2,350 companies
(Results available for 2,801 companies)

Sales		
Sep 30, 2025	₹38.33 trn	8.7%
Sep 30, 2026	₹47.59 trn	24.1%
Reported net profit		
Sep 30, 2025	₹4.16 trn	15.0%
Sep 30, 2026	₹5.35 trn	28.7%
Adj net profit (excl. extraordinary items)		
Sep 30, 2025	₹4.10 trn	14.7%
Sep 30, 2026	₹5.27 trn	28.7%

HSBC India may join Apple Pay; several others weigh tieup

AJINKYA KAWALE & SUBRATA PANDA
Mumbai, 8 November



IMAGING: AJAYA MOHANTY

Apple Pay could add HSBC India as its second banking partner in the country, following its much-awaited September launch exclusively with Axis Bank, according to multiple people aware of the discussions.

HSBC India, the local arm of the UK-headquartered bank, could join the platform by the end of the current financial year (FY27), the sources said. They also revealed that several other large Indian lenders are in commercial discussions with Apple and currently assessing the economics of partnering with the iPhone maker, whose contactless payments service operates with more than 11,000 banks globally.

The discussions come as banks assess whether the commercial terms make sense, particularly the fee Apple charges on card transactions, which comes out of the interchange income earned by issuing banks. Several lenders have been cautious about the arrangement, even as the prospect of offering Apple users a premium payments experience makes the partnership attractive.

Ashok Vaswani, managing director and chief executive officer of Kotak Mahindra Bank, said during the lender's second-quarter earnings call that it would eventually join Apple Pay, depending on customer demand. "As far as the Apple Pay ecosystem is concerned, we will eventually get there. If there is demand from our customers, we will make it happen over the next couple of quarters," he said.

Apple and HSBC India did not respond to *Business Standard*'s queries until press time.

HSBC had 1.02 million credit cards in circulation as of September 2026, according to Reserve Bank of India data. HDFC Bank was the country's largest credit card issuer, with 27.37 million cards, followed by State Bank of India with 23.16 million, ICICI Bank with 19.86 million and Axis Bank with 16.55 million.

A person with direct knowledge of the discussions said: "An Apple partnership is important because it gives a bank's customer, who owns a card, a better brand experience. Apple users themselves are considered on the aspirational, young side. HSBC is likely to roll out the service by the end of FY27."

Apple Pay allows users to store their cards in Apple Wallet and make contactless payments at merchant point-of-sale (PoS) terminals by tapping their devices, using near-field communication (NFC) technology.

Negotiations with several large card issuers remain a work in progress, with both sides seeking to agree on Apple's share of interchange, industry sources said. "Apple partners bilaterally with more than 11,000 banks globally. So, it is just a matter of time before banks prefer to be on the platform, given that it has managed to convince so many lenders on its commercial fee," a second person said.

In most global markets, Apple has negotiated a fee of around 15 basis points on each credit card transaction, although the rate varies across markets, a source said. One basis point is a hundredth of a percentage point.

Interchange is the fee paid by the merchant's bank to the card-issuing bank for processing a card transaction. It forms part of the merchant discount rate (MDR), which merchants pay to accept digital payments.

IN MOST GLOBAL MARKETS, APPLE HAS NEGOTIATED A FEE OF AROUND 15 BASIS POINTS ON EACH CREDIT CARD TRANSACTION, ALTHOUGH THE RATE VARIES ACROSS MARKETS

In India, select Axis Bank cardholders can already use Apple Pay at online and offline merchants that accept the service.

Apple Pay operates in more than 90 markets worldwide. Its India entry comes as Apple records double-digit growth in the country, alongside markets in Latin America and Southeast Asia.

Beyond the tap

- HSBC India could join Apple Pay by FY27 end
- HSBC had 1.02 million credit cards in circulation as of September 2026
- Several lenders remain cautious over Apple's share of interchange income
- Apple Pay partners with over 11,000 banks globally

Samvat 2083 off to a tepid start; Sensex, Nifty slip, smaller cos up

SHILPA RANGARAJAN
Mumbai, 8 November

Domestic equity benchmarks ended marginally in the red in the hour-long ceremonial muhurat trading session on Sunday, marking the start of Samvat 2083, the new Hindu calendar year, snapping an eight-year green streak for the Sensex and Nifty at the end of the special session.

The Sensex on Sunday settled at 80,999, down 0.04 per cent, while the Nifty 50 lost 0.18 per cent to close at 24,986, interrupting their gaining streak over the last seven consecutive trading sessions. The last time the indices turned red on muhurat day was on October 19, 2017, at the start of Samvat 2074, when the Sensex was down 0.6 per cent to 32,390 and the Nifty 50 fell 0.63 per cent at 10,147, respectively.

Traders attributed the market ending flat on Sunday to profit booking and the Diwali holidays, where trader participation is more ritualistic, as well as a truncated trading week with Tuesday being a market holiday. The banking and real estate sectors, which were the biggest gainers over the last five sessions, turned laggards on muhurat day.

Broader indices diverged from the trend, with the Nifty Midcap 100 rising 0.1 per cent and the Nifty Smallcap 100 advancing one per cent. Market breadth stood at 2,716 stocks advancing against 736 declines on the NSE and 3,253 advances and 937 declines on the BSE. Sectoral indices were mixed, with the Nifty Pharma, Nifty Media and Nifty Healthcare indices ending higher.

"We've seen corrections and major movements in the last two years, particularly in major sectors such as IT and pharma. However, the last Samvat was very difficult for the markets and we're expecting very good market movement in Samvat 2083," said Somil Mehta, head of retail research, Mirae Asset Sharekhan.
Turn to Page 5



Sundararaman Ramamurthy, MD and CEO of BSE (*centre right*), with key managerial personnel during Lakshmi poojan and muhurat trading at BSE in Mumbai on Sunday PHOTO: KAMLESH PEDNEKAR

First in 9 years: A muted muhurat for benchmarks

Samvat	Muhurat trading	% change over previous day's close Sensex	Nifty 50	Nifty Midcap 100	Nifty Smallcap 100
2074	Oct 19, 2017	-0.60	-0.63	-0.41	-0.14
2075	Nov 7, 2018	0.70	0.65	0.78	1.12
2076	Oct 27, 2019	0.49	0.37	0.66	1.18
2077	Nov 14, 2020	0.45	0.47	0.51	0.75
2078	Nov 4, 2021	0.49	0.49	0.79	1.30
2079	Oct 24, 2022	0.88	0.88	0.50	0.93
2080	Nov 12, 2023	0.55	0.52	0.61	1.14
2081	Nov 1, 2024	0.42	0.41	0.68	1.03
2082	Oct 21, 2025	0.07	0.10	0.11	0.52
2083	Nov 8, 2026	-0.04	-0.18	0.13	1.01

Source: Bloomberg Compiled by *Business Standard* Research Bureau

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₹, bond outlook hinges on W Asia conflict, inflation

The rupee and government bonds are likely to take cues from developments in West Asia, prices of crude oil, inflation, and the flow of foreign capital in Samvat 2083, with uncertainty over the currency's trajectory and the interest-rate outlook keeping investors cautious.

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- Bumpy ride may continue in Samvat 2083
- 'A fresh spark for equities as macro clouds lift'
- Global macros, uncertainty to drive commodity prices in new Samvat, too

Sensex valuation rebounds as November rally gathers pace

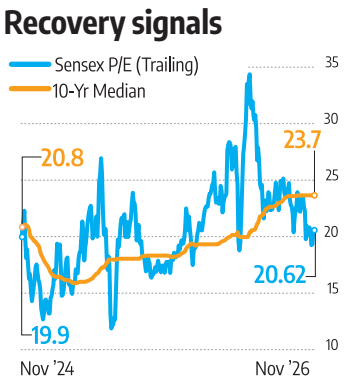
KRISHNA KANT
Mumbai, 8 November

The recent rally on Dalal Street lifted the BSE Sensex's trailing price-to-earnings (P/E) multiple to 20.62 times on Sunday, from a 77-month low of 19.1 times on October 12. This was its highest valuation since the end of August, when the multiple stood at 20.4 times, following a sharp correction that had pulled it down to 19.24 times at the end of September, its lowest monthly close since April 2020, when it fell to 18.8 times amid the Covid pandemic-led market selloff.

The Sensex gained 8.8 per cent in the first six trading sessions of November and had risen 13.1 per cent from its October closing low of 71,593.2.

The rally narrowed the index's 2026 (CY26) loss to 4.9 per cent, reversing much of the 15 per cent decline recorded in the first nine months. The Sensex had ended CY25 at 85,220.6.

Recovery signals



As on November 8, 2026 Source: BSE, *Business Standard* calculation

Despite the recovery, it remained nearly 5.5 per cent below its November 2025 closing level of 85,706.7.

In contrast, the index's underlying earnings per share (EPS) — which tracks the combined earnings of its 30 constituent companies — rose 7.2 per cent year-on-year to ₹3,929.6 on Friday, against ₹3,665.8 at the end of November last year and ₹3,667.2 at the end of September 2026.

Analysts attributed the recent rally and the accompanying expansion in valuations to softer crude oil prices and lower risk-free rates, reflected in government bond yields. "The decline in energy prices and moderation in treasury yields have improved market sentiment and triggered a risk-on trade. This could continue for some time if oil prices fall further and bond yields remain benign," said Dhananjay Sinha, co-head of research and equity strategy at Systematix Institutional Group.

The yield on the US 10-year government bond has declined nearly 50 basis points from its 52-week high, while India's 10-year government bond yield is down 30 basis points from its annual peak. Turn to Page 5

PAGE 3

US visa, PERM worries raise IT firms' subcontracting bill

Indian IT services firms have seen subcontracting costs rise over the past year as tighter US visa restrictions and uncertainty surrounding 'permanent labor certification (PERM)' applications force them to rely more heavily on locally hired talent, which typically comes at a higher cost. AVIK DAS reports

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Women hold 2/3rd of Mudra a/cs, get 43% of funds disbursed

Women entrepreneurs account for more than two-thirds of all accounts under the Pradhan Mantri Mudra Yojana (PMMY), yet receive less than half the total funds disbursed — highlighting a stark gap in loan size between them and other borrowers.
HIMANSHI BHARDWAJ reports

From farms to factories, etractors prepare for a growth spurt

SOHINI DAS & SHINE JACOB
Mumbai/Chennai, 8 November

Tractors could be the next frontier of automotive electrification following the lead given by two-wheelers, three-wheelers, passenger vehicles (PVs) and buses.

The Centre's inclusion of electric tractors (etractors) under the Sub-Mission on Agricultural Mechanisation (SMAM), alongside diesel tractors for subsidies, and incentives introduced by states including Haryana, Maharashtra and Andhra Pradesh could accelerate adoption.

Manufacturers are seeking permission for etractors to operate under commercial registration on highways, potentially expanding demand from cement, sugar, paper, tile manufacturing, and firms in fast-moving consumer goods.

Annual sales of etractors could reach around 12,000 units in the next couple of years and 50,000 by 2030, according to tractor maker AutoNxt Automation, against just 219 registrations in 2025.

Despite recording only 248 registrations between January 1 and October 31 this year, according to the VAHAN data, the industry, with fewer than 10 licensed manufacturers, has created a combined annual capacity of 35,000-40,000 units.

The emerging market is led by Thane-based AutoNxt, the Murugappa group's Montra Electric, and Moonrider Electric Tractors, operating from Bengaluru.

AutoNxt accounted for around 145 registrations, or 58 per cent of the total, during the period. It is targeting nearly tenfold revenue growth in FY27, at ₹80 crore, against ₹8.3 crore in 2025-26 (FY26).



AutoNxt said it had order books of around ₹60 crore, backed by advance payments from customers, and expects another ₹20 crore to ₹30 crore in business from other industrial sectors.

Electric units accounted for just 0.03 per cent of India's tractor registrations in the first 10 months this calendar year, as against the electric-vehicle penetration of 64.9 per cent in three-wheelers, 11.6 per cent in two-wheelers, 8.5 per cent in PVs, and around 4 per cent in commercial vehicles in September.

Etractors had recorded barely 20 registrations in 2024.

However, compressed biogas (CBG) plants, sugar mills, paper mills and other industrial users are emerging as early adopters, attracted by lower operating costs and the ability to use equipment across extended shifts.

"The tipping point is going to arrive in four to five years. And there will be a movement towards electric tractors from diesel in five years," said Pankaj Goyal, cofounder and chief operating officer, AutoNxt.

Montra Electric, operating under the brand TI Clean Mobility, has an annual manufacturing capacity of around 25,000 tractors in Chembarambakkam, Tamil Nadu. This accounts for the bulk of the industry's installed capacity.

Its E27 was India's first electric agricultural tractor to receive homologation and Central Motor Vehicle Rules compliance certification from the Automotive Research Association of India (ARAI).

"We have sold over 300 units so far (around 250 units of the E27 and 50 units of the recently launched 45 HP model). Currently, our order pipeline is over 1,000. The Centre's policy is helping to bring the costs down by 10-15 per cent. In Haryana, the government is giving a flat ₹5 lakh subsidy for etractors valued at over ₹10 lakh. These moves are going to help the industry boom," said a source from TI Clean Mobility. Turn to Page 5

- **Tata Motors keeps M&M in its rearview** P2

TaMo keeps M&M in its rearview

Strong Apr-Oct EVs sales help maintain edge, SUV portfolio expansion heats up competition

SOHINI DAS
Mumbai, 8 November



Race for No.2 spot

Registration in 2026

	Tata PV	Mahindra PV	Tata PV lead	Tata EV	Mahindra EV	Tata EV lead
Apr	57,688	55,236	2,452	9,302	5,822	**3,480**
May	55,544	51,311	**4,233**	10,340	6,210	**4,130**
Jun	57,009	54,099	**2,910**	12,187	7,766	**4,421**
Jul	58,774	56,219	**2,555**	13,678	7,742	**5,936**
Aug	57,841	50,245	**7,596**	13,158	6,464	**6,694**
Sep	57,254	57,343	**-89**	14,791	7,780	**7,011**
Oct	73,449	64,982	**8,467**	14,669	8,538	**6,131**
Total	417,559	389,435	**28,124**	88,125	50,322	**37,803**

PV: Passenger vehicles; Source: Fada press releases

The battle for the second position in India's passenger vehicle (PV) market is intensifying between Tata Motors and Mahindra & Mahindra (M&M), with electric vehicles (EVs) emerging as an important differentiator and both automobile players scaling up production to meet demand.

Tata has maintained its lead over Mahindra for most of 2026-27 (FY27), but the gap between the two has fluctuated considerably. Mahindra briefly overtook Tata in September by just 89 vehicles before Tata regained second place in October with a lead of 8,467 units, according to data from the Federation of Automobile Dealers Associations (Fada).

During April-October, Tata registered 417,559 PVs, compared with Mahindra's 389,435 units, giving it a cumulative lead of 28,124 vehicles.

Maruti Suzuki India continues to dominate the market, while Hyundai Motor India, which traditionally occupied the second position, has slipped behind in recent months.

Fada data showed that Maruti Suzuki led PV retail registrations during April-October, followed by Tata, Mahindra, Hyundai, and Toyota. While Hyundai retained fourth position throughout the period, Toyota held fifth place until September before being overtaken by Kia in October.

"A close race is going on between Tata and Mahindra for the No. 2 slot. This time Tata has overtaken Mahindra way ahead and has a healthy margin of around 9,000 vehicles. Last month, this was a marginal difference," said Sai Giridhar, president of Fada.

A two-horse race

The competition between Tata and Mahindra has remained close throughout the financial year. Tata led Mahindra by 2,452 registrations in April, with the gap widening to 4,233 units in May before narrowing to 2,910 in June and 2,555 in July. The difference widened to 7,596 units in August, but Mahindra edged ahead by 89 vehicles in September.

October saw Tata regain a more substantial lead. Its PV registrations rose 28.3 per cent sequentially to 73,449 units, while Mahindra's increased 13.3 per cent to 64,982 units. Tata's market share stood at 14.47 per cent in October, against Mahindra's 12.8 per cent.

A spokesperson for Tata Motors Passenger Vehicles said the company had delivered consistent month-on-month growth during the financial year, supported by its portfolio and customer demand. The spokesperson said the second quarter (Q2) of FY27 was Tata's highest-ever quarter, with sales of 201,723 units, up 40 per cent year-on-year (Y-o-Y). In October, its total sales, including international business, crossed 75,000 cars and sport utility vehicles (SUVs) for the first time.

In October, Mahindra said it saw its highest-ever monthly domestic SUV sales of 73,338 units and overall auto sales of 131,109 vehicles, up 9 per cent Y-o-Y. "Our primary measure of leadership is SUV revenue market share, where we continue to hold the No. 1 position. It's at 24.3 per cent in Q2FY27," said R Velusamy, president, automotive business, M&M.

Tata's electric edge

EVs have played an important role in Tata's lead over Mahindra. During April-October, Tata registered 88,125 electric PVs (ePVs), compared with 50,322 for Mahindra, giving it an advantage of 37,803 units in the segment. Excluding EVs, however, Mahindra registered 339,113 PVs during the seven months, ahead of Tata's 329,434 units. This indicates that Tata's stronger EV business has been an important factor in maintaining its lead over Mahindra. EVs accounted for around 21.1 per cent of Tata's PV registrations during April-October, against 12.9 per cent for Mahindra.

According to the Tata spokesperson, electric and compressed natural gas (CNG) vehicles together account for 51 per cent of the its volumes. Its EV sales crossed 47,000 units in the September quarter, growing 90 per cent Y-o-Y, while CNG vehicles also recorded their highest-ever quarterly sales.

The company said it had sold more than 130,000 EVs over the past year and continued to lead the ePV market with a share exceeding 40 per cent. Its CNG volumes have crossed 200,000 units, with a 21 per cent market share in PVs.

Mahindra, however, has been gaining ground. Its EV registrations rose to 8,538 units in October from 7,780 in September, while Tata's declined marginally to 14,669 units from 14,791. The gap between the two in EV registrations narrowed to 6,131 units in October from 7,011 in September.

The competition is also being shaped by the two companies' expanding SUV portfolios. According to the Tata spokesperson, the Punch and Nexon were among the country's five highest-selling models during the year-to-date period. "To serve this growing demand, we have scaled up supply and are progressively improving product availability," the Tata spokesperson said.

Mahindra's demand is being driven by the XUV 7XO, XEV 9S, Thar, and Scorpio-N, according to Velusamy. "With demand ahead of output, waiting periods remain firm on key models," Velusamy said.

More on business-standard.com

Honda's 4-month winning streak threatens Hero's lead

SHINE JACOB
Chennai, 8 November

Market dynamics

- Before the 2011 split, the Hero Honda joint venture was the market leader
- After that, Hero dominated the market, with Honda occasionally rising to the top slot
- Honda has been increasing the gap ever since it took over the top slot in July this year

After dominating the Indian two-wheeler automobile market for a decade-and-a-half, Hero MotoCorp is witnessing a shake up, with its Japanese archnemesis Honda Motorcycle and Scooter India cementing its position as the top selling player in the retail market for the fourth consecutive month in October, intensifying the race for the market leader slot in calendar year 2026 (CY26).

Despite this, Hero has been ahead of Honda so far this year by around 89,000 units, as per the VAHAN dashboard on Saturday. The difference between market leader Hero and Honda in CY25 was 647,000 units, showing that Honda has already narrowed the gap.

In the festival season, too, Honda marched ahead of Hero, driven by its strong scooter franchise and a change in entry level market dynamics. According to data shared by the Federation of Automobile Dealers Associations (Fada), Honda led the sales in October, with 637,630 units and a strong 27 per cent market share. This comes as Hero MotoCorp's sales dipped sharply year-on-year (Y-o-Y) to 598,433 units from over 1 million units in October 2025, down by 41 per cent or 408,000 units. The Indian major's market share also dipped from 31 per cent in October 2025 to 26 per cent in October 2026. Though Honda's market share was 26 per cent last year, the company also witnessed a dip in sales of 25 per cent or 213,000 units versus last October.

"Our festival period actually runs over a 100 day period. And festival to date, the way we are driving our festival performance, we've seen growth of 24 per cent. Otherwise, one gets into this conundrum that right at the start of Navratra last year, the new GST came into effect and there was a huge amount of pent up demand that then immediately resulted in sales last year, and that will skew the base. Hence, looking into this broader period gives us a good indication... And there, we have not seen any share erosion," said Hero MotoCorp Chief Executive Officer (CEO) Harshavardhan Chitale, addressing an earnings call late last month.

The dip in monthly numbers for both industry majors was due to the higher base last October, as both Navratri and Deepawali fell during the month. This was over and above the pent up demand released after the GST 2.0 rate cuts of September 22, 2025.

"Honda has out-registered Hero for four straight months, and it isn't just festival timing. Between January and September, Honda's registrations grew 25 per cent against Hero's 18 per cent, halving Hero's lead to 180,000 units," noted Sunil Dahiya, founder and lead analyst, Envirocatalysts.

He said this was also because of the change in the rural market dynamics. "Hero is not so much losing customers as watching its customers lose purchasing power. Rural, entry-level 100cc buyers have been squeezed by a weak monsoon, costlier fuel and higher rural inflation, while salaried buyers in cities, the South and the West are moving up to scooters and 125cc bikes, where Honda is strongest. November's festive sales will show how deep the shift runs," Dahiya said.

Before the 2011 split between the two industry majors, the Hero Honda joint venture was the market leader. After that, Hero dominated the Indian market, with Honda occasionally rising to the top slot in September 2022, September 2024, and July 2025. However, Honda has been increasing the gap ever since it took over the top slot in July this year. During the month, the difference between both players was 29,025 units, with Honda steadily increasing the lead in August (33,346 units), September (34,509 units), and October (39,197 units).

"Honda is now clearly establishing its position as the number one player," said Sai Giridhar, president, Fada.

QUICK READ

Adani Enterprises plans annual capex of ₹35K-40K cr in 2 years



Adani Enterprises plans to spend between ₹35,000 crore and ₹40,000 crore annually over the next couple of years, with airports, data centres and its proposed PVC complex emerging as the biggest investment drivers as the conglomerate steps up expansion across its infrastructure businesses. "We expect to do capex at a run rate of around ₹40,000 crore. So, we may be somewhere in the range of ₹35,000 crore to ₹40,000 crore, which is the rate we expect to continue over the next couple of years," Manan Vakharia (*pictured*), head of finance at Adani Enterprises, said during the company's earnings call. "The heavy lifting will be done by airports, data centres and PVC," he said. PTI

Kalpataru confident of meeting ₹6,500 cr pre-sales target for FY27

Realty firm Kalpataru will achieve its ₹6,500 crore pre-sales target this financial year (FY27), a 23 per cent rise from the previous year, as housing demand remains strong for established players, a senior company official said. In an interview with *PTI*, Mumbai-based Kalpataru CFO Chandrashekhar Joglekar said the company's sales bookings or pre-sales stood flat at nearly ₹2,600 crore in H1FY27. He noted that housing demand remains "intact" despite concerns about a possible slowdown due to global economic uncertainties. "We have given guidance for pre-sales at ₹6,500 crore. We have already achieved 40 per cent in the first half of this fiscal. We will be achieving 60 per cent in the second half of this fiscal," Joglekar said. During H1FY27, the company's sales bookings stood at ₹2,587 crore against ₹2,577 crore in the year-ago period. PTI

Hindalco flags coal constraints, sees aluminium mfg cost rising

SAKET KUMAR
New Delhi, 8 November



Satish Pai, MD of Hindalco Industries, said rains affected coal production

Hindalco Industries said coal supply at its two aluminium smelters in northern India has fallen to nearly half their normal levels, underscoring how tightening fuel supplies are weighing on major industrial consumers.

The company expects aluminium production costs to rise another 5 per cent sequentially in the December quarter (Q3), after a similar increase in the September quarter (Q2), Managing Director Satish Pai said on Friday during a media interaction after Q2FY27 financial results. The company expects coal availability will be tight in northern India during October and November, with easing expected in Q4.

Hindalco's aluminium production costs in Q2 were 5 per cent higher than in Q1, due to coal and calcined petroleum coke (CP Coke), Pai said. Coal accounted for 50-60 per cent of the rise, while CP Coke made up the remainder. Pai said costs should begin to ease in Q4 as the coal situation settles and power demand in northern areas declines in winter.

Hindalco reported a 59 per cent year-on-year rise in consolidated net profit to a record ₹7,533 crore for Q2FY27. Revenue increased 39 per cent to ₹91,708 crore, while earnings before interest, tax, depreciation and amortisation (Ebitda) grew 42 per cent to ₹13,757 crore.

Hindalco, the metals flagship company of the Aditya Birla group, is the world's largest aluminium company by revenue and India's largest copper producer. The company also operates Novelis, the world's largest recycler of aluminium.

Pai said coal availability in northern India was tight during monsoons, with heavy rains affecting production and power plants drawing more fuel amid high temperatures. This made coal availability difficult for the aluminium sector, he said.

"As a result, we had to buy a lot of spot auctions where the prices were very high," Pai said, adding that the e-auction premium on coal in the northern region was as high as 200 per cent.

Coal inventories at Hindalco's Mahan smelter in Madhya Pradesh and Renukoot in Uttar Pradesh are at 10-11 days, against a normal level of 20-25 days, Pai said. In contrast, the company's Aditya and Hirakud smelters in Odisha had more than a month's inventory, with no supply disruption reported. Until Hindalco's own coal mines become operational, it will depend on Coal India's long-term linkages and spot auctions, Pai said. The company expects its Bandha and Chakla coal mines in Madhya Pradesh and Jharkhand to begin supplying coal around the middle of next year.

Despite the cost pressures, Hindalco's upstream aluminium business, the largest contributor to the company's Q2 performance, reported Ebitda of ₹7,009 crore, up 55 per cent year-on-year. Novelis's adjusted Ebitda rose 20 per cent year-on-year to $508 million.

Coca-Cola's largest India bottler cements its reign in South, West

SHARLEEN D'SOUZA
Mumbai, 8 November



On way to listing

- The proposed IPO is entirely an OFS of up to 997.5 mn equity shares
- The entire proceeds from the offer will go to the promoter
- The book-running lead managers for the IPO include Citi Global Markets India, J.P. Morgan India, Morgan Stanley India

Hindustan Coca-Cola Holdings Limited (HCCH), the holding company of Coca-Cola's Indian bottling business, has established a dominant position in the Southern and Western parts of the country through a multi-year re-franchising process.

"Our business and operations have undergone changes as a result of a multi-year re-franchising process. Between financial years 2024 and 2026, we sold our business undertakings in Rajasthan, Bihar, Jharkhand, Northeast India, parts of West Bengal and North Gujarat (collectively, the "Refranchised Units") to other TCCC Bottlers by way of slump sales," the firm said in its draft red herring prospectus (DRHP) filed on Saturday.

It has the licence to prepare, package, distribute, and sell The Coca-Cola Company's (TCCC) beverages exclusively in 10 states and four union territories, keeping its operations concentrated in the South and West. HCCH can sell in all of Andhra Pradesh, Telangana, Maharashtra, Madhya Pradesh, Gujarat and the Union Territories of Andaman and Nicobar Islands, and Lakshadweep. It faces restrictions in Diu, parts of Puducherry and Karaikal and Mahe. In areas where it operates, the bottler had a network of 2,273 distributors as of June 30, 2026 and over half of them have been with the company for over five years.

Its production footprint comprises 14 owned production facilities with an aggregate installed capacity of 1,291.1 million unit cases per annum, supported by eight co-pack units. "Collectively, these facilities operated 90 bottling lines, including 77 owned bottling lines and 13 bottling lines at co-pack units, and were complemented by a network of 23 warehouses," it said.

"Our recent strategic reorientation encompassing completion of the re-franchising process, addition of Jubilant Beverages as one of our promoters, leadership and organisational enhancements, and renewed focus on execution, has, we believe, established our foundation for future growth," HCCH said.

The proposed initial public offering (IPO) is entirely an offer for sale (OFS) of up to 997.5 million equity shares with a face value of ₹10 by promoter Hindustan Coca-Cola Overseas Holdings Pte. Ltd. The entire proceeds from the offer will go to the promoter selling shares. The book-running lead managers for the IPO are Kotak Investment Banking, Citi Global Markets India, J.P. Morgan India, Morgan Stanley India, Axis Capital, Goldman Sachs India and IIFL Capital Services.

Coca-Cola's decision to dilute its stake in its Indian bottling business is part of a larger global strategy to move away from bottling operations and adopt an asset-light, franchise-led business model.

Rainbow Children's Medicare plans ₹2,200 crore expansion by FY32

SOHINI DAS
Mumbai, 8 November

Rainbow Children's Medicare will invest around ₹2,200 crore to expand its hospital network to more than 5,000 beds by FY32, with the money to be funded entirely through internal accruals rather than fresh debt or private equity.

The Hyderabad-based hospital chain has a network of 2,685 beds and expects to increase it to 3,875 by FY30. It is in discussions for another 1,125 beds, which could take its total capacity beyond 5,000 beds by FY32.

Abrarali Dalal, chief executive officer of Rainbow Children's Medicare, told *Business Standard* that the company will fund the expansion from internal resources.

"Whatever ₹2,000 crore or ₹2,200 crore that we need is absolutely going to happen through internal accruals," Dalal said, adding that the company was not looking to raise fresh debt or bring in private equity investors.

Rainbow had around ₹540 crore in cash and bank balances at the end of September 2026, according to Dalal.

The company estimates an average investment of ₹70-80 lakh per bed, depending on the type of hospital and its infrastructure.

Mumbai, NCR in focus

Rainbow's investor presentation for the second quarter of FY27 outlines plans to add 1,190 beds through FY30. These include 25 beds in FY27, 385 in FY28, 630 in FY29 and 150 in FY30. The projects include hospitals in Mumbai, Gurugram, Coimbatore, Pune, Indore, Bengaluru and Amaravati in Andhra Pradesh.

The company plans to commission a 100-bed hospital in Mumbai in the first quarter of FY28 and is already exploring further expansion in the city.

"Mumbai will surely have more hospitals," Dalal said, adding that the company would continue evaluating opportunities once the upcoming facility becomes operational.

Rainbow is developing two hospitals in Gurugram with a combined capacity of 450 beds: A 325-bed facility in Sector 44 and a 125-bed hospital in Sector 56. It is also exploring opportunities in Noida.

Dalal said the expansion will largely be through greenfield and brownfield projects rather than acquisitions, as there were relatively few hospital operators with a comparable combination of paediatrics, maternity and fertility services.



"WE ARE PUSHING QUATERNARY CARE. WE ARE LOOKING AT A LOT OF TRANSPLANTS"

Abrarali Dalal
CEO, Rainbow Children's Medicare

New hospitals weigh on margins

The expansion comes as Rainbow's revenue growth continues to outpace earnings growth. In the second quarter of FY27, revenue increased 23.2 per cent year-on-year to ₹548 crore, while earnings before interest, tax, depreciation and amortisation (Ebitda) rose 14.2 per cent to ₹170 crore.

Ebitda margin declined to 31 per cent from 33.5 per cent a year earlier.

Overall occupancy fell to 49.2 per cent from 52 per cent, even as inpatient discharges increased 15 per cent and outpatient consultations rose 19 per cent.

Dalal attributed part of the pressure on margins to new hospitals, which need time to reach optimal occupancy.

"A new hospital will take around 18 to 24 months to break even," he said, adding that the gestation period varied across markets.

Hyderabad, where Rainbow has an established presence, typically sees faster patient uptake than Bengaluru, where competition is stronger. He expects the impact of new hospitals on margins to remain around 0.5-1 percentage point.

Rainbow is targeting blended occupancy of more than 55 per cent over time, with mature hospitals operating at 55-60 per cent or higher.

The company's FY26 annual report showed that occupancy declined to 46.3 per cent from 50.5 per cent in FY25, even as inpatient volumes grew 6.2 per cent and outpatient volumes increased 12.1 per cent.

Average revenue per occupied bed rose 11.5 per cent during the year.

Dalal said Rainbow would aim for revenue growth of 25 per cent or more in FY27 and slightly over 20 per cent in FY28.

The company is also looking to expand advanced paediatric treatments, including organ transplants, bone marrow transplants, cardiac surgery and oncology. Paediatrics accounts for around 60-65 per cent of its business, and the company is increasing its focus on higher-end services within the segment.

"We are pushing quaternary care. We are looking at a lot of transplants," Dalal said, referring to liver, kidney and bone marrow transplants.

The proposed 325-bed Gurugram hospital will have a greater focus on paediatric oncology, including advanced diagnostic and treatment facilities.

Fertility is another growth area. Rainbow currently operates in-vitro fertilisation centres within its hospitals and two standalone fertility clinics in Bengaluru.

Dalal said more than 90 per cent of fertility patients currently come through internal referrals from the company's obstetrics departments.

Rainbow is now exploring ways to attract patients directly to its standalone clinics and expand the business.

International patients are another potential growth driver.

The company is increasing its outreach in West Asia, Africa and Commonwealth of Independent States countries, particularly for advanced paediatric procedures.

Dalal said international patient volumes had nearly doubled over the past six months, although the business still contributed a relatively small share of revenue.

The company has no immediate plans to build hospitals overseas and will instead focus on attracting international patients to its facilities in India.

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quick scroll

Warfare technology is finding a new home on Britain's farms



Across the flat expanses of Lincolnshire's fenlands, an unfamiliar hum hangs overhead. Drones — more readily associated with modern battlefields — are sweeping across some of Britain's most fertile farmland, scanning crops for the earliest signs of disease and stress. Below ground, a different technology is probing. Radar adapted from systems originally developed to detect buried landmines and unexploded devices in Afghanistan is being used to peer beneath the soil. Its target here is rather less dangerous: potatoes. The equipment is part of a growing arsenal being trialled by Tesco Plc as Britain's biggest grocer works with its partners to produce food more efficiently. The gear is deployed at its Low Carbon Concept Farm near Boston, England, a 20-acre testing ground run in cooperation with vegetable suppliers and technology firms. As extreme weather, from prolonged heat and drought to bouts of heavy rain, challenges Britain's growers as never before, the project's aim is to discover new methods to cut emissions, reduce the herbicides and water required, and make crops more resilient. "When people think of farming, you don't tend to think it's this massive data-driven exercise," said Vidyanath Gururajan, CEO, B-Hive Innovations, which is working on the drone technology in Lincolnshire. Across the farm, the drones can survey the fields of potatoes and broccoli more effectively than farmers and agronomists on foot. BLOOMBERG

US visa, PERM worries push up IT companies' subcontracting bill

AVIK DAS
Bengaluru, 8 November

Information technology (IT) services companies have seen subcontracting costs rise over the past year, as tighter US visa restrictions and uncertainty surrounding 'permanent labor certification (program electronic review management, or PERM)' applications force them to rely more heavily on locally hired talent, which typically comes at a higher cost.

Average subcontracting expenditure at eight Indian IT companies rose to 11.3 per cent of revenue in the quarter ended September 30, from 10.5 per cent a year earlier, according to data from business intelligence firm UnearthInsights.

Tata Consultancy Services (TCS), the country's largest IT services provider, recorded a 1.5 percentage point increase in subcontracting costs to 6.8 per cent. The corresponding increase at Wipro and Infosys was relatively modest at 0.2 percentage points. Among mid-tier companies, Persistent Systems remained the most exposed, with subcontracting costs rising 0.3 percentage points to 15.3 per cent. For the last 12 months (LTM), the figure climbed to 9.6 per cent from 7.7 per cent.

Infosys has acknowledged that subcontracting costs, at 8.9 per cent, remain elevated compared with about 6 per cent before the Covid-19 pandemic. The company has said the expense depends on several factors, including utilisation, business growth, the skills required and the geographies in which projects are delivered. "There is an endeavour to bring our subcontractor cost down over a period of time. It had come down and then slightly it inched up again," its Chief Financial Officer Jayesh Sanghrajka told analysts on a conference call last month.

A one percentage point reduction in subcontracting costs would give Infosys 15-20 basis points of margin headroom, Sanghrajka said. "To that extent, there is opportunity, but it will never come down to zero. So even in the best years, we have been in the range of 5-6 per cent," he added.

The increase is an immediate pressure on operating margins at a time when IT services companies are already grappling with subdued revenue growth amid macroeconomic weakness and geopolitical uncertainty. Margins remain a closely guarded metric for the sector, particularly as clients continue to scrutinise costs and defer discretionary technology spending.

"Over the past three to four quarters, we have seen subcontracting expenditure rise as more client-site work is executed through subcontractors," said Gaurav Vasu, founder and chief executive officer of UnearthInsight. Restrictions on H-1B visas and uncertainty over PERM applications are reinforcing the trend, particularly in the US, where companies need access to onsite talent.

Indian IT companies have gradually reduced their dependence on H-1B visas by training and hiring more employees in the US. But a mismatch between the availability of local talent and the skills required by clients persists. When demand rises suddenly, companies often have little choice but to turn to subcontractors, as relocating employees can be a lengthy process. The situation has become more challenging under the Donald Trump administration.

The US government has introduced several measures to tighten the entry of skilled foreign workers through its immigration system. It has also cancelled PERM-related processes, amid allegations that firms sought to bring in lower-cost foreign workers at the expense of US employees.

Rising costs

Subcontracting expenditure as % of revenue



Source: UnearthInsight

Vimag Labs looks to go global with rare-earth-free motor tech

HEMANT KUMAR ROUT
Bhubaneswar, 2 November

Vimag Labs, an advanced motor-technology company developing electric motors without rare-earth permanent magnets, is targeting revenue of ₹100 crore in the next financial year, as it moves into commercial deployment and scales up manufacturing.

The firm, which has set up its first manufacturing facility at MET City in Jhajjar, Haryana, is preparing to expand its presence across electric mobility, industrial equipment, commercial vehicles and defence and aerospace.

The firm plans to commercialise its patented Virtual Magnet Synchronous Motor (VMSM) technology across multiple power segments and expand into international markets over the next few years. "We are currently in deployment mode, and our revenue target is ₹100 crore for the 2027-28 financial year (FY28)," Manish Seth, chief executive officer and cofounder of Vimag Labs, said.



Manish Seth, CEO & cofounder Vimag Labs, said it is eyeing ₹100 crore revenue by FY28

The advanced technology addresses a significant vulnerability in the global electric motor supply chain, given the geographical concentration of rare-earth resources and processing capabilities, and price volatility.

"Our patented VMSM platform replaces physical permanent magnets with electronically controlled, software-defined magnetic fields, eliminating the requirement for rare-earth permanent magnets while delivering comparable or superior performance in terms of efficiency, power density and overall motor performance," said Seth.

The development of alternative motor technologies is significant, as India is set to expand its electric vehicle ecosystem, strengthen domestic defence manufacturing and build capabilities in advanced industrial technologies.

More on business-standard.com

Amazon Pay sets 3-yr timeline for credit, insurance foray

PEERZADA ABRAR
Bengaluru, 8 November

Over 75 per cent of Amazon Pay customers now live outside India's big cities, and more of them are using the app to borrow. During Amazon's Great Indian Festival sale, no-cost EMI transactions in Tier-III cities grew four times faster compared to metros, said Vikas Bansal, chief executive officer of Amazon Pay India.

Over the next three years, Bansal wants to take Amazon Pay beyond payments into credit and insurance. "Can I provide insurance to every Indian? Can I give credit to every Indian?" he said in an interview.

The push comes despite Amazon Pay India's net loss widening by about a third to ₹1,149 crore in FY26.

Bansal declined to say when the unit would break even or how big its loan book is. His immediate focus, he said, is customer adoption and improving unit economics.

Its digital-first model, which needs no physical presence across locations, keeps costs lower, he said.

Amazon bought Axio, formerly Capital Float, for a reported $200 million last year after Reserve Bank of India (RBI) approval. The deal, which Amazon described as one of its largest in India, turned a six-year partnership behind Amazon Pay's Buy Now Pay Later services into full ownership.

Bansal said Amazon acquired Axio to deepen its reach in Tier-II, -III and -IV cities, lower the cost of credit and expand distribution. "Can we double, treble our customer adoption to what it is today?" he asked. He declined to disclose lending revenue or profits.

Amazon's festival sale, which runs from October 8 to Bhai Dooj on November 11, has attracted more than 3.93 billion customer visits, some 70 per cent from beyond the metros. Shopping volumes rose more than 50 per cent from a year earlier. Shoppers traded up to premium phones and large televisions, even as costlier memory chips and a weaker rupee raised prices.

Easy credit helped. EMI spending grew 40 per cent year-on-year (Y-o-Y) and accounted for half of the spending on mobiles, televisions and appliances. No-cost EMI made up 90 per cent of EMI spends and was chosen by 25 per cent more customers than last year.

On Amazon Pay Later, no-cost EMI spending doubled Y-o-Y and issuances grew 30 per cent. Three in four Pay Later purchases used EMI.

Amazon Pay UPI customers grew 40 per cent and transactions nearly 50 per cent. Two in five customers chose UPI.

Amazon Pay Balance customers more than doubled, and transactions rose nearly 2.5 times. Amazon Pay ICICI Bank Credit Card users grew 25 per cent Y-o-Y, and EMI tenures of 12 months and above tripled.



Amazon Pay CEO Vikas Bansal said Amazon took over Axio to deepen its reach in smaller cities

Urban Indians pay digitally every day but have limited confidence in digital credit. While 88 per cent of consumers are aware of digital credit, only 31 per cent use it, according to the How Urban India Pays Report 2026 by Amazon Pay and Pahlé India Foundation.

UPI leads in five of six spending categories, and 75 per cent of respondents have used a financial product through their payment app. The survey covered 5,149 consumers and 1,054 merchants across 100 cities in 20 states.

The report finds that consumers broadly trust their payment apps, rating them 4.11 out of 5 for security and 3.98 for payments. But confidence drops to 3.10 when the same app offers credit.

DURING AMAZON'S GREAT INDIAN FESTIVAL SALE, NO-COST EMI TRANSACTIONS IN TIER-III CITIES GREW FOUR TIMES FASTER COMPARED TO METROS

The gap looks addressable: 51.5 per cent of consumers said they would borrow through their app if fraud protection was guaranteed, against just 16.7 per cent who would decline it.

Bansal said trust is one of the biggest barriers. Consumers worry whether they understand the terms, whether what they see is what they will get, and fraud.

Digital credit has yet to build the trust digital payments have, he said, and needs stronger consumer protection and grievance redressal.

Post Diwali, under new rules from the National Payments Corporation of India (NPCI) and the Ministry of Finance, a 0.4 per cent merchant discount rate applies to eligible person-to-merchant UPI transactions above ₹2,000.

Bansal said the industry had long sought such a framework so payment firms and banks can invest in new technologies while helping merchants move away from cash.

Bansal also expects artificial intelligence (AI) to tailor financial services to individual customers rather than broad segments, and to help build trust.

On liability, he said companies would stay liable for activities within their control. "I don't think those rules of the game will change as much as the way we deliver will change."

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TENDER NOTICE NO. ACE (P&C): TN-17:2026-27

[A] PROCUREMENT: Tender No. **(1) E-3080:** LT-PB & DCDB.,**(2) E-3112:** HW for ACSR cond. E/W.

[B] CIVIL: Const. of C.R. building, cable trench, etc. for following 66/220 kV S/s.,

Tender No	Name of Sub-station.	Name of Circle.
716	66 kV Shapar S/s	Surendranagar
718	66 kV Bilimora (Machhiwad) S/s	Navsari
719	66 kV Ratangadh S/s & area Grading and C' wall work for future 220 kV S/s	Palanpur
720	66 kV Vaso S/s	Nadiad
721	66 kV Kamlapur S/s	Gondal
722	66 kV Petlad S/s	Nadiad

715: - Bi-annual rate contract for General maintenance and renovation of existing sections at GETCO, Corp. Office.

[C] LINE: E-507,522,525,526,531,532,533,537: - (1) 132 kV 1Cx800sq mm 2*(3+0) XLPE U/G cable from work under Jambuva circle.,**(2)** 66 kV,1CX630 sq.mm XLPE Cable with Poly.Al./Al. const. on EPC basis under Navsari Circle.,**(3)** 220 kV Ukai-Mota D/C line 1&2 of Navsari Circle with ACSR zebra cond. into eq. HTLS Cond. (Eq. weight of Zebra Cond. with Higher Ampacity) (Except Gap Type Cond.).,**(4)** Conversion of (1) 66 kV Otha - Vadli, (2) 66 kV Mahuva-Vadli & other **(Nine)** lines with DOG cond. into eq. HTLS Cond. (Eq. weight of DOG Cond. with Higher Ampacity) (Except Gap Type Cond.) of Amreli Circle.,**(5)** Conversion of (1) 66 kV Tithagam – Rampura (2) 66 kV Rampura - Runi & other **(Five)** lines with DOG cond. into eq. HTLS cond. (Eq. weight of DOG cond. with higher Ampacity) (Except Gap Type Cond.) of Palanpur Circle.,**(6)** 220 kV Kosamba - Kim line 1,2 & 3 of Bharuch Circle with ACSR zebra cond. into eq. HTLS cond. (Eq. weight of Zebra Cond. with Higher Ampacity) (Except Gap Type Cond.).,**(7)** Conversion of (1) 66 kV Vidi - Khedoi (2) 66 kV Patri - Sadau & other **(Eight)** lines with ACSR DOG cond. into eq. HTLS Cond. (Eq. weight of ACSR DOG cond. with Higher Ampacity) (Except Gap Type cond.) of Anjar Circle.,**(8)** Conversion of (1) 66 kV Virpar - Tarnetar (2) 66 kV Mathak - Chupani Dungarpur & other **(Two)** lines with ACSR DOG cond. into eq. HTLS Cond. (Eq. weight of ACSR DOG cond. with Higher Ampacity) (Except Gap Type cond.) of Surendranagar Circle.

[D] SUBSTATION: E-530: - EPC for Transformer Bays at 220 kV Dahej S/s & 220 kV Zagadiya S/s Under Bharuch circle excluding Civil works.

Above tenders are available on website **www.getcogujarat.com** (for view and download only) **& tender.nprocure.com**. (For view, download and online tender submissions).

Note: Bidders are requested to be in touch with our websites till opening of these Tenders.

Date:08/11/2026 **Additional Chief Engineer (Procurement & Contracts)**

ASSAM POWER GENERATION CORPORATION LIMITED

NOTICE INVITING TENDER

E-Tenders are invited from the intending contractors/firms/service providers for execution of **"IT FACILITY MANAGEMENT SERVICE (IT-FMS) ALONG WITH AMC SERVICES OF IT AND NETWORK INFRASTRUCTURE AT ALL OFFICES OF APGCL"**. An amount of **INR 2,50,000.00 (Rupees Two Lakhs Fifty Thousand only)** is to be submitted as EMD/Bid Security:

- The Tender documents can be downloaded from **www.assamtenders.gov.in** from **10-11-2026 (16:00 hours).**
- The last date of submission of tender document is **03-12-2026 (12:00 hours).**
- The bids will be opened online on the e-procurement portal on **04-12-2026 (16:00 hours).**

The TIA reserves the right to accept or reject any bid/tender, and to cancel/ annul the bidding process and reject all bids at any time prior to contract award.

Name of the TIA: Chief General Manager (PP&I), APGCL
Address of the TIA: 3rd Floor Bijulee Bhawan, Paltanbazar, Guwahati-1

Sd/- **Chief General Manager (PP&I)**
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- **Topcon Module R Grade** Date 13/11/2026 Location : Mundra, Kutch, Gujarat
- **Used/Scrap Fire Vehicle** Date 25/11/2026 Location : Vadodara, Gujarat

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For further details Contact:
M/s. NEELAMI
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EXTRACT OF STATEMENT OF STANDALONE FINANCIAL RESULTS FOR THE QUARTER ENDED 30 SEPTEMBER, 2026

(Pursuant to regulation 52 (8) read with Regulation 52 (4) of the SEBI (LODR) Regulations, 2015 as amended)

(Amount in INR Lakhs)

Sl No.	Particulars	Quarter Ended 30/09/2026 (Unaudited)	Quarter Ended 30/09/2025 (Unaudited)	Year Ended 31/03/2026 (Audited)
1	Total Income from Operations	59,671	50,827	2,03,536
2	Net Profit / (Loss) for the period (before Tax, Exceptional and/or Extraordinary items#)	8,409	716	4,104
3	Net Profit / (Loss) for the period before tax (after Exceptional and/or Extraordinary items#)	8,409	716	4,104
4	Net Profit / (Loss) for the period after tax (after Exceptional and/or Extraordinary items#)	6,276	533	3,575
5	Total Comprehensive Income for the period [Comprising Profit/ (Loss) for the period (after tax) and Other Comprehensive Income (after tax)]	6,789	496	4,721
6	Paid up Equity Share Capital	10,164	10,158	10,161
7	Reserves (excluding Revaluation Reserve)	73,749	58,539	61,095
8	Securities Premium Account	98,792	98,739	98,792
9	Net worth	1,83,447	1,66,677	1,70,112
10	Paid up Debt Capital/ Outstanding Debt	7,71,315	7,11,192	7,68,611
11	Outstanding Redeemable Preference Shares	NIL	NIL	NIL
12	Debt Equity Ratio	4.20	4.27	4.52
13	Earnings Per Share (of Rs. 10 /- each) (for continuing and discontinued operations) - 1. Basic:	6.00	0.48	3.42
	2. Diluted:	5.55	0.46	3.17
14	Capital Redemption Reserve	NA	NA	NA
15	Debenture Redemption Reserve	NA	NA	NA
16	Current ratio	NA	NA	NA
17	Long term debt to working capital	NA	NA	NA
18	Gross Non Performing Asset	2.24%	3.41%	2.87%
	Net Non performing Asset	0.62%	1.08%	0.79%
19	Current liability ratio	NA	NA	NA
20	Total debts to total assets	0.77	0.77	0.78
21	Debtors turnover*	NA	NA	NA
22	Inventory turnover*	NA	NA	NA
23	Operating margin (%);*	NA	NA	NA
24	Net profit margin (%);	10.21%	1.05%	1.76%
25	Capital Risk Adequacy Ratio (CRAR)	26.01%	29.31%	28.13%
26	Debt Service Coverage Ratio	NA	NA	NA
27	Interest Service Coverage Ratio	NA	NA	NA

- Exceptional and/or Extraordinary items adjusted in the Statement of Profit and Loss in accordance with Ind AS Rules/ AS Rules, whichever is applicable.
*Not applicable to Bank/NBFC

Note: The above is an extract of the detailed format of quarterly/ annual financial results (consolidated) prepared pursuant to the amendment in Regulation 52(8) of the SEBI Listing Regulations and filed with the Stock Exchange under Regulation 52 and Regulation 52(4) of the said Regulations. The full format of the financial results is available on the websites of the Stock Exchange i.e., BSE Limited (BSE Reg 52 and Reg 52(4)-https://www.bseindia.com/xml-data/corpfiling/AttachLive/61cd77bb-adbb-4a31-8c16-5d2b36614cf5.pdf) and the Company (https://dg5kbfrmz7w0s.cloudfront.net/resources/investors-relation/intimations-and-disclosures/disclosure-of-information%28regulation-51%29/Reg%2051%20Meeting%20Outcome%20BM%2006-11-2026.pdf)

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Sd/-
Dibyajyoti Pattanaik
(Director)

Date: 06.11.2026
Place: Bhubaneswar

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QUICK READ

SBI expands US footprint with first subsidiary branch in Texas

State Bank of India (California), a wholly owned subsidiary of India's largest lender State Bank of India (SBI), has inaugurated its new branch in Frisco, Texas. This opening marks the subsidiary's first physical expansion beyond California, with its US branches now at eight locations. The inauguration ceremony was led by SBI Group Chairman Challa Sreenivasulu Setty, alongside Consul General of India in Houston, DC Manjunath and Frisco Mayor Mark Hill. Located in the rapidly growing North Dallas region, the new Frisco branch is designed to offer a full suite of retail and business banking services. These include personal and business deposits, commercial lending, and international remittances, tailored specifically for individuals, professionals, entrepreneurs, and corporate entities across North Texas. Welcoming the lender's strategic expansion into the Lone Star State, Consul General Manjunath highlighted the branch's role in bolstering India-US economic and commercial ties, while enhancing financial connectivity for the fast-growing Indian diaspora in North Texas. Beyond its eight California-subsidiary locations, SBI maintains a robust direct presence in the United States, operating full-service branches in New York, Chicago, and Los Angeles, along with a representative office in Washington. PTI

Nationwide inspection drive: FSSAI seizes ₹82 cr banned items

The Food Safety and Standards Authority of India (FSSAI) on Saturday said it seized 3,280 metric tonnes of food products worth ₹81.8 crore in an intensive nationwide drive between September 1 and November 5 this year. "Through rigorous checks on over 56,000 food establishments, authorities took decisive action against substandard practices — issuing over 10,000 improvement notices and suspending more than 1,100 licences to maintain uncompromising safety standards," the food regulator said in social media posts. Alongside the 10,047 improvement notices and 1,133 food licence suspensions, FSSAI also cancelled 52 licences and sealed 312 establishments. FSSAI said it collected 43,939 food samples, analysed 23,648 and found 2,273 to be non-compliant. It also initiated 410 prosecutions. The non-compliant products seized by the regulator included oils; milk and its products, such as paneer, *khoya* and ghee; bakery items and chocolates; ice creams and *namkeen*; as well as gift hampers and packaged foods. "FSSAI, in collaboration with State Food Safety Authorities, continues to work towards ensuring greater adherence to prescribed food safety standards across the food ecosystem," it said. ANANYA PODDER

IOCL to buy crude, LPG ships as West Asia crisis exposes transit risks

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
New Delhi, 8 November

State-owned Indian Oil Corporation Ltd (IOCL) plans to acquire crude oil and liquefied petroleum gas carriers of its own as disruptions to shipping around the Strait of Hormuz and soaring freight costs prompt India's largest oil refiner to strengthen control over its energy supply chain.

The company's board has already approved the purchase of a few vessels, and tenders were issued several months ago, Director of Finance Anuj Jain said during its second-quarter earnings call. "The country needs oil sector companies to focus more on the shipping area now," Jain said, adding that IOCL was also exploring the possibility of building ships in India under the government's Make in India initiative.

The move marks a potential shift in the company's shipping strategy, which has traditionally relied on a mix of time-charter and voyage-chartered vessels. IOCL is now examining three approaches: optimising existing charter arrangements, owning ships and supporting domestic shipbuilding.

The importance of securing shipping capacity has risen as tensions in West Asia disrupt commercial movement near the Strait of Hormuz, pushing up freight rates and war-risk insurance costs. IOCL currently has three crude oil vessels and nine LPG vessels on time charter. These arrangements have provided significant cost savings during the current crisis, Jain said.

The company's time-chartered crude carriers cost around $2-2.50 per barrel, compared to spot-market rates of as much as $8-10 per barrel.

LPG freight rates, which would normally be around $40 per tonne, have risen to $160-180 per tonne in the spot market, he said.

The shipping strategy is part of a broader effort to diversify crude procurement and reduce exposure to supply disruptions. IOCL sourced 55 per cent of its crude requirements from Russia during the first half of the current financial year, while Middle Eastern supplies accounted for 24 per cent, Jain said.

Africa contributed about 10 per cent, Brazil 7 per cent, the United States 2-5 per cent and Venezuela 3-4 per cent.

The company has also substantially increased its reliance on spot purchases. Spot imports accounted for about 87 per cent of crude sourcing in the first half of FY27, compared to around 50 per cent in the previous financial year.

Jain said the company had been able to negotiate discounts against benchmark prices even as global crude markets remained volatile.

Frequent glitches in MCA portal disrupt corporate ops

SHUBHAM KUMAR
New Delhi, 8 November



Persistent issues

- The Institute of Company Secretaries of India (ICSI) cited frequent downtime, slow responses, automatic logouts, pre-fill, and retrieval errors in a representation dated October 9
- Another ICSI representation on October 28 flagged 'persistent technical glitches and operational challenges' on the MCA-21 Version 3 (V3) portal
- Since 2022, the ICSI has publicly flagged glitches at least 16 times, while the ministry has extended deadlines in both V3 annual filing cycles
- The problems can affect companies from the incorporation stage
- Glitches can also restrict access to funds

From delaying company incorporation and board appointments to holding up access to freshly raised capital, persistent glitches on the Ministry of Corporate Affairs' (MCA) portal are disrupting corporate operations, company secretaries said.

Repeated deadline extensions for statutory filings have offered companies temporary relief but failed to address the underlying technology problems.

On October 24, the MCA extended the deadlines for companies to file financial statements to December 31 and annual returns to January 31 for the financial year 2025-26, following stakeholder representations seeking more time.

In a representation dated October 9, the Institute of Company Secretaries of India (ICSI) cited frequent downtime, slow responses, automatic logouts, pre-fill and retrieval errors, Digital Signature Certificate (DSC) association problems and validation failures.

Another ICSI representation on October 28, seeking an extension for other statutory forms, flagged "persistent technical glitches and operational challenges" on the MCA-21 Version 3 (V3) portal. It noted that the problems affected not just annual filings but other statutory e-forms under the Companies Act, 2013, and the Limited Liability Partnership Act, 2008.

Developed and maintained by LTIMindtree, the V3 portal serves more than two million registered companies and limited liability partnerships (LLPs).

Queries sent to the MCA and LTIMindtree remained unanswered till the time of going to press.

Asked about the representation, ICSI president Pawan G Chandak told *Business Standard* that technical issues could prevent otherwise compliant entities from meeting filing timelines.

"Corporate filings are often reviewed by financial institutions, investors, auditors, credit rating agencies, business partners and other stakeholders during due diligence exercises," he said.

Although the final phase of V3 was scheduled for launch in FY22, the migration was completed only in July 2025. Since 2022, the ICSI has publicly flagged glitches at least 16 times, while the ministry has extended deadlines in both V3 annual filing cycles.

"V3 has mainly web-based forms that need to be filled and signed digitally. A working portal is, therefore, critical. Even when the portal does not have high traffic, technical glitches persist," said Gaurav Pingle, a practising company secretary.

The problems can affect companies from the incorporation stage. If the registrar flags defects in an application or e-form, applicants are generally given 15 days to rectify them. However, portal glitches can prevent them from editing, downloading or uploading forms. The portal may also reject Digital Signature Certificates used in the original filing, forcing companies to make fresh submissions and pay the application fee again.

Glitches can also restrict access to funds. A company raising money through a private placement cannot use the proceeds until it allots shares to investors and files a return of allotment (Form PAS-3) with the MCA.

Anupriya Saxena, another practising company secretary, said validation errors and upload failures had prevented companies from submitting PAS-3 despite repeated attempts, leaving funds unavailable for use.

"A technical failure in a mandatory filing system can translate directly into a cash-flow restriction, transaction delay and business disruption for a startup. The company may have completed the substantive transaction correctly, but a portal failure prevents completion of a mandatory statutory step," Saxena said.

Other corporate approvals have also been affected. Hannu Goyal, a practising company secretary, said applications by some companies to increase their authorised share capital through Form SH-7 remained pending because payments made through Bharatkosh were not getting linked to the MCA portal, even after stamp duty had been paid.

One-time password (OTP) failures during director verification have also delayed board appointments, including investor-nominated directors. Saxena said some appointments had been held up for weeks or months because OTPs were not received and profile registration remained incomplete.

Several of these problems were flagged by the ICSI to the MCA in a February 2023 representation. Most also figure in its latest representation dated October 28, 2026.

The MCA said that as of January 31, 2026, it had received 316,877 help desk tickets during FY26, of which around 98 per cent had been resolved. These included suggestions and feedback, apart from complaints related to technical glitches.

Jigar Shah, a practising company secretary, said the extension reflected the difficulties with the portal. "When the annual general meetings are conducted by September, we (company secretaries) should be able to file forms within 30 to 60 days. This extension is proof that the website is not functioning properly," he said.

Saxena called for reliable portal infrastructure and a transparent mechanism to report technical failures, preserve evidence of attempted filings and obtain regulatory assistance when statutory filings cannot be completed for reasons beyond a firm's control.

Govt to start accepting applications for ECMS on rolling basis from July 2027

AASHISH ARYAN
New Delhi, 8 November



Deepening the value chain

- Notified on April 8, 2025, the ECMS was originally proposed to be rolled out with a budget of ₹22,919 cr
- In the Union Budget for 2026-27, the outlay for the scheme was nearly doubled to ₹40,000 cr
- Since 2025, 118 applications have been approved to date
- Govt has got nearly 250 applications under the scheme

The government is likely to start accepting new applications for the Electronics Component Manufacturing Scheme (ECMS) on a rolling basis from July 2027, once all applications submitted so far have been vetted and accepted or rejected, a senior government official has said.

The idea is to ensure that capable companies wanting to set up new greenfield or brownfield operations are not declared ineligible because they miss the deadline to submit a completed ECMS application, the official added.

"There are several aspects that companies have to lock in before they are eligible for government incentives under schemes such as ECMS. For example, they have to be ready with the technology to be used at the proposed unit for the final product, either themselves or by signing a joint-venture partnership with a technology partner. Then there are land, water, electricity, and labour agreements," the official said, adding that putting these in place takes time.

For example, a potential applicant under the ECMS scheme is often in talks in up to five states simultaneously regarding land, water, electricity, and labour agreements, weighing the incentives and tax breaks on offer, another official said.

Once these details are finalised, agreements have to be signed, and they are vetted by both sides, which can take anywhere between 60 and 90 days, the official said.

"Even as all these processes are going on at the state level, there is a clock ticking at the central level as well. Sometimes, we also miss out on good companies due to their inability to complete an application in all aspects before or on time," one of the officials quoted above said.

Notified on April 8, 2025, the ECMS was originally proposed to be rolled out with a budget of ₹22,919 crore. In the Union Budget for 2026-27, the outlay for the scheme was nearly doubled to ₹40,000 crore.

Since 2025, when the Union Cabinet approved the scheme and the Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology rolled it out, 118 applications have been approved to date.

The government has received roughly 250 applications under the ECMS scheme, with cumulative investment proposals worth ₹1.15 trillion, Union Electronics and Information Technology Minister Ashwini Vaishnaw said in October last year.

Against a production target of ₹4.56 trillion expected by the government under the ECMS scheme, the IT Ministry had received production target assurances of over ₹10 trillion from these 250-odd applicants, he had said.

Women hold 2/3rd of Mudra a/cs, get only 43% of funds disbursed

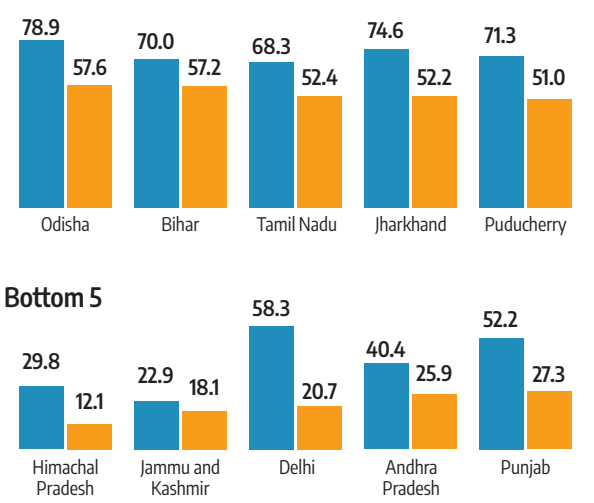
Credit gap

Mudra: Women entrepreneurs and others (all-India)

Cumulative*	Women entrepreneurs	**Others	Total
No. of accounts (in mn)	370.7	183.2	553.9
Share of accounts (%)	67%	33%	100%
Amount disbursed (₹ trn)	15.4	20.79	36.19
Share of amount disbursed (%)	43%	57%	100%

*Up to Oct 31, 2025
**Others: All account holders other than women entrepreneurs

Amount disbursed to women: Share of states and UTs



Source: Women and Men in India 2025

HIMANSHI BHARDWAJ
New Delhi, 8 November

Women entrepreneurs account for more than two-thirds of all accounts under the Pradhan Mantri Mudra Yojana (PMMY), yet receive less than half the total funds disbursed — highlighting a stark gap in loan size between them and other borrowers.

Women held 370.7 million of the 553.9 million Mudra accounts as of October 31, 2025, accounting for 67 per cent of the total, according to data published in the statistics ministry's Women and Men in India 2025 report earlier this year. However, the ₹15.40 trillion disbursed to women is just 43 per cent of the overall ₹36.18 trillion disbursal.

The difference is also seen in the average loan amount disbursed per account. Women received an average of ₹41,539 per account, against ₹1.13 lakh for other borrowers — nearly 2.7 times as much.

Earlier this month, the Ministry of Statistics and Programme Implementation (MoSPI) in collaboration with UN Women organised a national conference on the report's findings. The conference underscored the need to turn gender-disaggregated data into policy insights for inclusive development and gender equality.

The disparity extends across most states and Union Territories (UTs). Women held a majority of Mudra accounts in 23 of the 36 states and UTs, but accounted for a majority of the amount disbursed in only five: Odisha, Bihar, Tamil Nadu, Jharkhand and Puducherry.

Among the 24 states and UTs with at least 10 million Mudra accounts, Odisha and Bihar had the highest share of disbursals to women: 57.6 per cent and 57.2 per cent, respectively. At the other end were Himachal Pradesh (12.1 per cent), Jammu and Kashmir (18.1 per cent) and Delhi (20.7 per cent). New Delhi presents a particularly sharp contrast: Women held 58 per cent of Mudra accounts in the national capital but received only about a fifth of the amount disbursed.

Tamil Nadu, Bihar, West Bengal, Karnataka and Maharashtra together accounted for 53 per cent of the total amount disbursed to women under the scheme.

The share of women among Mudra account holders also varied considerably across states. Odisha (78.9 per cent), Maharashtra (78.7 per cent) and Jharkhand (74.6 per cent) had the highest proportions of women account holders among the 24 states and UTs considered. Jammu and Kashmir (22.9 per cent), Himachal Pradesh (29.8 per cent) and Andhra Pradesh (40.4 per cent) had the lowest.

Delhi AQI close to 'severe' at 383

Delhi was enveloped in a haze of toxic air on the morning of Diwali on Sunday, with the city's air quality nearing the "severe" category with an air quality index (AQI) reading of 383.

Of the 54 monitoring stations across the city, 24 recorded "severe' air quality, while the remaining stations were in the "very poor" category.

Jahangirpuri recorded the highest AQI at 450, followed by RK Puram at 448, according to the Sameer app. The city's AQI had shown marginal improvement from 382 on Friday to 369 on Saturday, but remained close to the threshold of 401 for the "severe" category. Several monitoring stations had already recorded AQI levels above 400. PTI

US verdict lifts hopes; markets celebrate, but traders cautious



EXIM MATTERS
TNC RAJAGOPALAN

Last week, Indian equity markets brought cheer ahead of Diwali, with the Sensex gaining 8.8 per cent and the Nifty 50 advancing 8.6 per cent despite a global technology sell-off. The Democratic Party's victory in the US midterm elections raised hopes of easing geopolitical and trade tensions. For exporters and importers, the test is whether political change will bring commercial relief.

Democrats will control both houses of the US Congress from January, but Donald Trump remains President until January 20, 2029. Congress can investigate his administration, scrutinise expenditure and challenge his policies. However, he retains substantial authority over diplomacy, military operations and tariffs. Expectations of an immediate change in American policy should therefore remain modest.

Pressure to end the Iran war should increase because its economic costs have become a political liability for Republicans. Freer flows of Gulf oil and gas could ease energy prices, lower production and transport costs worldwide, and support demand in importing economies. Indian businesses would benefit through more dependable supplies, lower costs and potentially stronger export orders.

However, ending hostilities would not necessarily restore shipping on pre-war terms. Iran seeks revenue connected with passage through Hormuz, while an Omani proposal envisages voluntary contributions under regional management. Any compulsory charge could leave a continuing burden, although reliable passage and lower insurance premiums could reduce total costs. Restoring normal shipping through the Red Sea would require separate progress involving Yemen's Houthis. A durable settlement in Ukraine could similarly improve Black Sea shipping and ease uncertainty over grain and fertiliser supplies. Democratic control of Congress, however, does not by itself bring a settlement closer.

On tariffs, congressional hearings and political pressure could encourage exemptions and negotiated reductions. Nevertheless, a Democratic majority cannot by itself reverse duties imposed under powers already delegated to the President. Legislation curtailing those powers could face his veto, requiring two-thirds support in each chamber to overcome it. Nor does opposition to Trump imply support for unrestricted trade. Protecting American manufacturing and strategic industries remains politically attractive. Greater consultation with allies could ease disputes, but a cooperative approach cannot be assumed. Continued barriers could divert goods towards other markets, intensifying competition and encouraging further protectionism.

For Indian traders, lower costs would be welcome, but improved competitiveness in the American market would depend on the tariff treatment of rival suppliers. A reduction in duties on Indian goods would offer little competitive advantage if competing countries secured even larger concessions. Goods redirected from the US could also intensify competition, putting pressure on domestic manufacturers' margins.

India should, therefore, pursue a commercially worthwhile bilateral trade agreement without sacrificing substance for an early signature. Ministers have reported negotiating progress. The test is whether the terms deliver durable market access, favourable tariffs relative to competitors and protection against subsequent measures eroding the concessions. Businesses need arrangements on which they can base prices, orders and investment.

The election has altered Washington's political balance, but Trump's unpredictability could still unsettle markets, disrupt contracts and delay investment. Indian traders should, therefore, prepare for abrupt policy shifts while diversifying markets and strengthening their own competitiveness.

Markets have welcomed the prospect of better days. Traders will look for those hopes to find expression in lower costs, dependable supplies and durable agreements. May this Diwali herald lasting peace and shared prosperity.

My best wishes to readers and their families.

Email: tncrajagopalan@gmail.com

SAMVAT 2083

₹, bond hinge on W Asia war, inflation and capital flows

AATHIRA VARIER & SUBRATA PANDA
Mumbai, 8 November



ILLUSTRATION: AJAYA MOHANTY

The rupee and government bonds are likely to take cues from developments in West Asia, prices of crude oil, inflation, and the flow of foreign capital in Samvat 2083, with uncertainty over rupee's trajectory and the interest-rate outlook keeping investors cautious.

The rupee could appreciate towards 92 per dollar in the near term, according to experts, if there is a credible resolution to the United States-Iran conflict, as a sharp correction in prices of crude oil would ease pressure on the domestic currency.

However, the gains are likely to be limited, with the rupee expected to gradually weaken towards 96-97 over the medium term, according to Gaura Sen Gupta, chief economist, IDFC First Bank.

Recent measures of the Reserve Bank of India (RBI), including a separate window for oil-marketing companies and steps to make currency hedging more expensive, have eased pressure on the spot market.

"The RBI's measures have improved its ability to manage the rupee and reduced pressure on the spot market. However, the appreciation is likely to be limited because the central bank will use the opportunity to rebuild its foreign-exchange reserves, given its forward-book commitments and upcoming repayments under Foreign Currency Non-Resident (Bank)," said Sen Gupta.

In contrast, V R C Reddy, head of treasury, Karur Vysya Bank, expects the rupee to remain relatively stable, supported by stronger capital inflows and softer prices of crude oil. "The new Samvat begins on a more constructive note. The inflation rate is expected to peak by December and soften thereafter, while improving global sentiment and stronger capital inflows could support equities and keep rupee depreciation in check," Reddy said.

The yield on the 10-year government bond is expected to trade in a range of 7-7.5 per cent, with market participants divided over the extent of monetary tightening and the scope for a correction in yields.

Madan Sabnavis, chief economist, Bank of Baroda, expects yields to remain elevated, citing persistent inflation and the likelihood of further rate increases. "I do not think central banks will stop increasing rates because inflation is an issue everywhere. This will keep bond yields elevated and a range of 7.3-7.50 per cent can be expected as we look at another 75 basis-point upward climb in the repo rate this cycle. The easing of bond yields we are seeing now is temporary," Sabnavis said.

In contrast, Sen Gupta has lowered her 10-year yield forecast to 7-7.2 per cent from 7.4-7.6 per cent earlier, citing lower prices of crude oil and easing expectations of the interest rate going up. However, elevated food prices, the risk of El Niño affecting rabi crops, and a higher government-bond supply in the second half of the financial year could limit gains in bond prices.

Sen Gupta expects growth in gross domestic product to exceed 7.2 per cent this year but cautions that the inflation rate could rise beyond 5.2 per cent, keeping monetary policy hawkish. She sees room for two rate increases of 25 basis points, in December and February, and has not ruled out another increase depending on how the situation evolves in Q1FY28.

The outlook comes after a difficult Samvat 2082, during which the rupee depreciated 6.37 per cent against the dollar, weighed down by outflows of foreign portfolio investment, a widening trade deficit, and global uncertainties.

Reciprocal tariffs imposed by the United States on Indian goods, uncertainty over trade negotiations, and a stronger dollar hurt investor sentiment. Escalating tensions in West Asia since late February added to the pressure, as rising prices of crude oil stoked concerns over India's import bill and current account deficit.

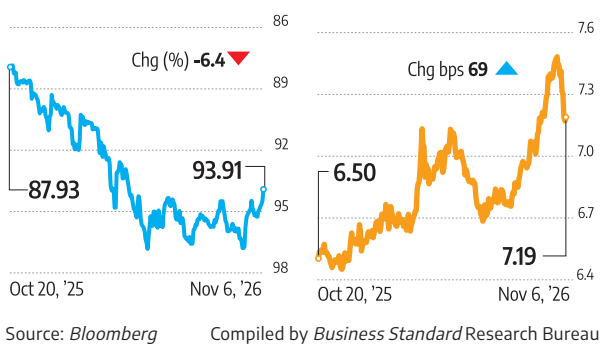
The bond market also witnessed a sharp rise in yields. The benchmark 10-year government bond yield climbed 69 basis points to 7.19 per cent on November 6, from 6.50 per cent at the beginning of Samvat 2082.

Global bond movements, foreign investor outflows, domestic liquidity and concerns over government borrowing weighed on sentiment. While the RBI's rate cuts and liquidity infusion initially supported the market, inflation concerns and rising prices of crude oil had limited gains.

The RBI raised the policy repo rate by 25 basis points to 5.50 per cent in October and shifted its stance to "calibrated tightening".

The 10-year yield subsequently touched 7.48 per cent on October 26 before easing to 7.19 per cent by November 6, as softer prices of crude oil and declining global yields improved sentiment.

Weighed down by global pressure



Source: *Bloomberg* Compiled by *Business Standard* Research Bureau

Fusion sees demand recovery in H2FY27, eyes 20-25% AUM growth

AATHIRA VARIER
Mumbai, 8 November



"WE ARE NOW SEEING GROWTH RETURNING IN OCTOBER... WE WILL CONTINUE TO REMOVE NON-PRODUCTIVE OPERATING EXPENSES AND CREDIT COSTS WILL REMAIN WITHIN OUR GUIDANCE OF 2-2.5 PER CENT"

Sanjay Garyali
Managing Director & Chief Executive Officer, Fusion Finance

Non-Banking Financial Company-Microfinance Institution (NBFC-MFI) Fusion Finance is expecting demand for microfinance and loans to micro, small and medium enterprises (MSMEs) to recover in the second half of FY27 (H2FY27), with festival activities picking up across its markets after Navratri and growth returning in October.

However, weather-related disruption during the September quarter could lead to some moderation in its earlier target of assets under management (AUM) of ₹10,000 crore by the end of FY27.

The lender expects to deliver an annual AUM growth rate of 20-25 per cent over a three-year period, supported by its focus on premium joint liability group (JLG) loans and secured MSME lending.

"Demand was pushed back in some markets during this quarter. So, there could be a little moderation on the (AUM) figure that we had given. But we are now seeing growth returning in October. We have already given a figure, so we don't want to give another one. But directionally, we will continue to remove non-productive operating expenses and credit costs will remain within our guidance of 2-2.5 per cent. In the medium term, we can safely assume that we will deliver 20-25 per cent AUM growth compounded annually," said Sanjay Garyali, managing director and chief executive officer.

The lender reported profits of ₹86.5 crore in the September quarter against a loss of ₹22 crore in the year-ago period, supported by lower credit costs and borrowing expenses.

Excessive rain and floods affected customer accessibility across 140-150 branches in five states during the quarter.

As a result, the lender's teams prioritised collection and engagement with existing borrowers over fresh disbursements, while customers deferred business investment amid uncertainty over their incomes.

"We are confident that the growth we have seen in the last two months will continue for the rest of the year," Garyali said.

On asset quality, the lender has put in place separate credit guardrails for markets vulnerable to weather-related disruption, including Karnataka and Maharashtra. In Maharashtra, it has ring-fenced branches through tighter ticket-size limits and measures to retain field employees.

Credit costs have declined from over 5 per cent to around 2 per cent while incremental borrowing costs have fallen to around 9.4 per cent from 12.5-13 per cent three to four quarters ago.

The lender expects the net interest margin (NIM) to improve by around 20 basis points in Q3 and another 10-15 basis points in Q4, supported by lower borrowing costs and the pass-through of increases in lending rates.

Fusion Finance is also looking to diversify its lending mix through an integrated, branch-led model spanning core microfinance, premium JLG and individual lending, and secured MSME loans. While core JLG lending will remain the largest part of its business, premium products will help it serve customers whose annual incomes have risen beyond the ₹3 lakh threshold.

The lender is planning to use its network of around 1,550 branches to expand into premium JLG, unsecured loans, and loans against property, while improving branch productivity and diversifying earnings without significantly increasing operating expenses. It will continue to maintain disciplined underwriting and independent credit oversight.

WEEKEND UPDATE

Rajnath in Darjeeling: Warfare no longer limited to cross-border firing



Defence Minister Rajnath Singh *(pictured)* on Saturday said the security landscape had become increasingly complex, with warfare extending beyond conventional cross-border firing to include cyberattacks, drone swarms, proxy wars and information operations.

Addressing Indian Air Force personnel at Bagdogra airfield, Singh said adversaries were seeking to exploit vulnerabilities without engaging in direct conflict. "Warfare is no longer limited merely to cross-border firing," the minister said. PTI

IAF plane makes record landing

In a historic feat, a Russian-origin heavy-lift transport aircraft of the Indian Air Force (IAF) successfully landed at the Nyoma air base in eastern Ladakh at an altitude of over 13,600 feet, achieving what the force described as the highest touchdown for the plane anywhere in the world. The airbase is located at a distance of around 25 km from the Line of Actual Control with China.

The IAF described the landing as an enduring capability of the aircraft backed by the "exceptional skill, precision and professionalism" of its crew. "An Indian Air Force IL-76MD has scripted history with a successful landing at Nyoma, marking the highest-altitude landing ever achieved by the aircraft anywhere in the world,"the IAF said on social media. PTI

FROM PAGE 1

Samvat 2083 off to a tepid start; Sensex, Nifty slip, smaller cos up



National Stock Exchange of India MD & CEO Ashishkumar Chauhan *(fourth from right)* at the beginning of Muhurat trading in Mumbai on Sunday PHOTO: KAMLESH PEDNEKAR

The recent cooling of crude prices will improve inflation numbers, corporate earnings, and market performances this Samvat, he added.

Stock exchanges conduct the one-hour muhurat trading session every year to mark the beginning of a new Hindu calendar year on Diwali. The muhurat trading session was held in the afternoon for the first time this year, instead of a traditional evening slot.

On the Multi Commodity Exchange (MCX), gold and silver were marginally lower, while crude oil gained over 1 per cent. Gold futures for December delivery slipped 0.02 per cent to ₹1.42 lakh per 10 gm, while silver futures for the same month eased 0.05 per cent to ₹1.85 lakh per kg. Crude oil futures for November delivery, in contrast, rose 1.13 per cent to ₹8,555 per barrel.

The market capitalisation (mcap) of all BSE-listed companies stood at ₹505.7 trillion as of Sunday session's close, while that of NSE-listed companies stood at ₹499.2 trillion as of session closing on Friday.

The key indices remain elevated in the short run while broader indices lagged, after FIIs bought a record ₹45,960 crore and DIIs sold a record ₹24,197 crore last week.

These indices had corrected about 15 per cent from their peaks in April amid concerns over slowing corporate earnings and US trade policies. India underperformed most global peers as investors rotated funds to other attractive markets and in favour of the artificial intelligence (AI) trade.

"Today's muhurat trading session has remained relatively muted, despite the strong rally in the preceding week. However, as we enter Samvat 2083, the key takeaway is that the market is increasingly rewarding selectivity over broad-based exposure," said Kresha Gupta, director and fund manager, Steptrade Capital.

She expects a broader-based earnings recovery and sustained economic growth in Samvat 2083, adding that the market will need several more positive triggers before investor sentiment turns overwhelmingly bullish, and that the next phase of wealth creation could come from under-researched businesses with strong fundamentals rather than the top largecaps.

Sensex valuation rebounds as Nov rally gathers pace

One basis point is one-hundredth of a percentage point.

Despite the recovery, the Sensex's valuation remains below its long-term average. Its trailing P/E is currently nearly 13 per cent lower than its 10-year median of 23.7 times.

During previous equity bull markets, including 2004-08 and 2014-20, the Sensex had consistently traded above its long-term valuation average. By contrast, extended periods below that average, including 2001-03, 2011 to early 2014, and 2024 onwards, had coincided with weak index performance and poor returns for equity investors.

Analysts said the valuation gap suggested that Indian equities remained in a "de-rating" phase. The gap indicates that foreign portfolio investors are still re-rating Indian equities downwards and are not yet willing to pay the valuation premium they did during previous bull runs, said Sinha.

However, he added that the gap also left room for further valuation gains if market sentiment remained positive. In both 2025 and 2026, the Sensex had rebounded from relatively low valuations but corrected after its P/E approached the long-term average.

From farms to factories, etractors prepare for a growth spurt

Government incentives could narrow the upfront price gap, while lower operating costs strengthen the case for electrification. According to AutoNxt, a diesel tractor undertaking rotavation (breaking up soil) across 3 acres consumes 15-20 litres of diesel, costing ₹1,500-2,000. Its electric tractor can perform the same operation using electricity worth approximately ₹300-400 at a tariff of ₹10 per unit.

However, AutoNxt's 45 HP electric tractor costs ₹15.5 lakh-16 lakh upfront, compared to ₹7 lakh-8 lakh for a comparable diesel model. The company estimates that the additional investment can be recovered within 12 months in high-utilisation industrial applications by saving fuel and operating costs.

AutoNxt has an installed capacity of around 3,000 tractors annually on a single-shift basis, expandable to 4,500 through additional shifts. It plans to increase its capacity to 12,000 tractors annually over the next couple of years.

Other manufacturers include Shree Marut E-Agrotech, Powerland Agro Tractor Vehicles, Vyomev Motors, Cygnus Motors, Royce EV, EVBharat Range and Thukral Electric.

Apart from AutoNxt, TI Clean Mobility, with 59 registrations, and Moonrider, with 27, the remaining manufacturers recorded single-digit figures individually during January-October.

Moonrider has also attracted investor interest, reportedly raising $8.38 million across its funding rounds.

AutoNxt has raised $5.4 million and is in discussion with global venture-capital investors to raise another $15 million.

Conventional tractor manufacturers including the Mahindra group, Sonalika, TAFE and Escorts Kubota have so far taken a cautious approach to electric models.

"Established tractor majors are likely to take a measured approach, given the significant shift in business priorities and management focus required, as well as the possibility of cannibalising their existing ICE (internal combustion engine) sales. As the market matures, we expect greater participation from established players," Goyal added.

Cong donations dropped 75% in FY26, most in a decade

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
New Delhi 8 November

The Congress party's receipts from donations above ₹20,000 plunged nearly 75 per cent to ₹130.69 crore in 2025-26, the steepest annual fall in such contributions in a decade, an analysis of the party's filings with the Election Commission (EC) shows.

The party had received ₹517.39 crore in such contributions in 2024-25, according to its 2024-25 contribution report submitted to the commission. A comparison with the preceding 12 financial years shows that the last steeper fall was in 2015-16, when Congress' disclosed donations dropped roughly 86 per cent from ₹141.46 crore the previous year.

The latest decline follows two years of higher collections. Congress received ₹281.48 crore in disclosed donations in 2023-24, rising to ₹517.39 crore in 2024-25, the year Lok Sabha elections were held.

BJP received ₹6,074.02 crore in donations exceeding ₹20,000 in 2024-25, nearly 12 times Congress's collection. BJP's corresponding figure for 2025-26 is not available as the party's contribution report has not been made public by the EC yet.

The Bharatiya Janata Party (BJP) collected more than the Congress in each of the 12 financial years examined.

Funding through Prudent Electoral Trust accounted for a substantial part of Congress' latest decline. The trust's contribution fell from ₹216.34 crore in 2024-25 to ₹25 crore in 2025-26, a drop of about 88 per cent.

Prudent was the only electoral trust listed in the party's latest contribution report.

Among other large contributors were Star Cement, which gave ₹5 crore, Sajjan Bhajanka, who contributed ₹4 crore, and Prem Kumar Bhajanka, who donated ₹2 crore.

The Congress' 2025-26 fund collection, though sharply lower than the previous year, was not its lowest over the period examined.

Its disclosed donations were lower in several earlier years, including ₹74.52 crore in 2020-21, ₹95.46 crore in 2021-22 and ₹79.92 crore in 2022-23.

'Notebandi' devastated economy: Cong

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
New Delhi, 8 November

"Notebandi" devastated the economy and "votebandi" is destroying the polity, the Congress said on Sunday, adding that both are contributions of Prime Minister Narendra Modi.

Congress general secretary in-charge communications Jairam Ramesh shared the screenshot of a media report which claimed that demonetisation was a disaster in 2016 and is a resounding failure 10 years on. In his post, Ramesh said, "Notebandi devastated the economy. Votebandi is destroying the polity. Both are the contributions of the PM." On this day in 2016, PM Modi announced demonetisation of high-value currency notes of ₹500 and ₹1,000.

ALL IN A DAY

Tamil Nadu scraps Kurian panel on Centre-state relations

The Tamil Nadu government has dissolved the high-level committee on Centre-state relations headed by retired Supreme Court Judge Justice Kurian Joseph, citing overlap of mandate with the newly reconstituted State Law Commission. The order, issued by Public Secretary E Sundaravalli on November 6, cuts short the panel's tenure six months before its final report deadline on May 31, 2027.

The three-member committee, comprising Justice Kurian Joseph, retired IAS officer K Ashok Vardhan Shetty, and former State Planning Commission chairman M Naganathan, had previously submitted the first part of its report to then Chief Minister M K Stalin in February 2026.

According to the government's rationale, the panel became redundant following the reconstitution of the Tamil Nadu State Law Commission on August 7, 2026, which was granted a broad mandate to examine Centre-state relations and review existing laws, official sources on Sunday said. PTI

Portion of false ceiling collapses outside Mumbai airport, one hurt

A visitor sustained injuries after a small portion of a false ceiling collapsed outside Terminal-2 of the Chhatrapati Shivaji Maharaj International Airport in Mumbai on Sunday, an official said. The airport's emergency medical team rushed to the spot immediately after the incident outside the terminal building and provided first aid to the injured, he said.

Airport authorities have launched an inquiry to ascertain the exact cause of the collapse and are inspecting the structural stability of the surrounding false ceiling area, the official added. PTI

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Easy: ★★
Solution tomorrow

HOW TO PLAY
Fill in the grid so that every row, every column and every 3x3 box contains the digits 1 to 9

POLAND IN MOURNING AFTER MASS SHOOTING



A woman places a candle near the Main Market Square after a mass shooting killed six people in Krakow, Poland. The country began two days of national mourning on Sunday, after a 24-year-old man with Far-Right views drove into a central square and opened fire PHOTO: REUTERS

QUICK READ

Anthropic buys power for AI data centres in $3.4 billion deal

Anthropic PBC has agreed to pay $3.4 billion for gas-fired generators for data centres, the *Financial Times* reported, in what it described as the largest known single purchase of power-generation equipment by an artificial intelligence (AI) lab. The company bought commitments for 1.7 gigawatts of heavy-duty generators from San Antonio-based equipment supplier OnePWR Solutions in late September, without acquiring the company itself, according to the newspaper. Anthropic initially planned to buy power from OnePWR before instead taking over its Caterpillar Inc. generator orders, it added. REUTERS

Paraguay ex-prez Peña charged over alleged role in banking scandal

Paraguay's former President Santiago Peña was charged Saturday over his alleged role in the collapse of a major bank that set off widespread protests, a day after he was removed from office by the Senate. The Public Prosecutor's Office filed charges against Peña for breach of trust and self-enrichment in the administration of assets, according to a statement on the office's website. He was placed in pretrial detention. Former central bank chairman Carlos Carvallo was charged with breach of trust, falsifying documents and enrichment. Investigations indicated that Peña "intervened in decisions concerning the placement, renewal, and retention of public and social security funds at Ueno Bank," prosecutors said. REUTERS

Trump wants UFC's Dana White for White House press secretary

United States (US) President Donald Trump on Saturday said he had asked mixed martial arts promoter Dana White *(pictured)* to serve as White House press secretary and called on him to bring some fighters along as assistants "even though some are not from our country." Trump also asked for six current or former UFC titleholders to join White, including two athletes from Russia's Dagestan region; Americans Justin Gaethje, Daniel Cormier and "Kayla Harris," likely a reference to Kayla Harrison; and Amanda Nunes, a Brazilian native. REUTERS



Saudi Aramco tower damaged by debris after Houthi attack

An administrative building belonging to state oil giant Saudi Aramco in Riyadh was damaged by falling debris following an attempted attack on Sunday, the kingdom's Energy Ministry said. A *Reuters* witness saw blown-out windows across several floors of the Aramco Tower, one of the tallest buildings in the capital's King Abdullah financial district. The incident came after the Saudi-led coalition said it had intercepted two missiles fired by Iran-baked Houthis towards Riyadh. REUTERS

Eisenkot gets first shot at forming Israeli govt

If he fails to form a govt within 42 days, Netanyahu could be next in line

BLOOMBERG
8 November

Israeli election challenger Gadi Eisenkot will get the first attempt at forming a new government, putting him a step closer to ending Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu's record tenure.

Eisenkot will be nominated on Sunday, according to a statement from President Isaac Herzog's office. He'll have up to six weeks to try to form a coalition that accounts for the majority of 120 parliamentary seats. Failure would mean the task likely reverts to Netanyahu, who for now continues to govern in a caretaker capacity.

While neither candidate's political camp won a clear parliamentary majority in the October 27 vote, Eisenkot's nomination was supported by a majority of parties.

The centrist ex-general said he was already negotiating to cobble together what he called a "national emergency government" to oust Netanyahu, under whose hard-right coalition Israel has been mired in war and deepening international isolation.

"This is the top priority given the immense and fateful challenges, from within and without, facing Israel," Eisenkot said in a post on X.

Eisenkot's bloc secured 48 seats in the election, short of Netanyahu's 53. The challenger said he would be open to allying with other parties that agree to conditions including recognition of Israel as a Jewish state and of Hamas as a terrorist group.

That appeared to be directed mainly at two parties that cater to Israel's Arab minority, which surged to 19 seats. They have historically shunned or been excluded from governance, given their pro-Palestinian sympathies and waiver from national service. Their constituents complain of system discrimination that raises questions about the inclusiveness of Israeli democracy.

Netanyahu has alleged that foreign funding illicitly boosted Arab voter turnout. Election officials ordered investigations but still certified the vote tally.

In a video statement, Netanyahu accused Eisenkot of planning to set up a government with "terrorism supporters" and offered to join him in broad coalition instead. Eisenkot has called for an end to the career of the six-term prime minister, who failed to prevent the October 7, 2023 Hamas invasion and is under indictment on corruption charges that he denies.

Still, Eisenkot may reconsider if US President Donald Trump renews the military campaign against Iran, given Israel would be expected to offer support or risk further fracturing the already vulnerable US-Israeli partnership.

Barring that, an Eisenkot government would consign Netanyahu and his religious nationalist partners to the opposition. The challenger, who is untested in domestic politics and international diplomacy, has pledged to reverse the country's course, without giving details. He's echoed Netanyahu's rejection of a Palestinian state and warnings about a nuclear-armed Iran.

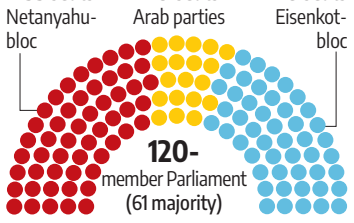
Eisenkot — a former commander of Israel's armed forces who lost a son and two nephews as soldiers in the Gaza war — will find allying with Arab parties that do not accept his conditions a tall order. The same goes for ultra-Orthodox Jewish parties which won a combined 13 seats, and want their constituents exempted from the draft. Another option for Eisenkot could be forming a minority government with tacit protection from Arab or ultra-Orthodox parties in the opposition, which would decline to join in no-confidence motions as long as their demands are met.



Gadi Eisenkot, leader of the Yashar party, waves an Israeli flag following the exit polls in Tel Aviv FILE PHOTO: REUTERS

Can Eisenkot break Israel's political deadlock?

Seats split



Minority government

Going with natural allies: Gadi Esienkot could form a minority government with his Yashar party (21 seats) and its allies — Together (12 seats), The Democrats (8 seats), and Israel Our Home (7 seats) — with external support from two Arab-led alliances

Confidence cushion: Coalition with Arab parties — Ra'am (11 seats) and the Joint List (8 seats) — would raise support to 67 seats, securing a majority and defeating any no-confidence motion

Ultra-Orthodox alliance a possibility

The kingmakers: Eisenkot's bloc could secure 61-seat majority through a deal with Israel's ultra-Orthodox parties — Shas and United Torah Judaism (UTJ) (13 seats)

Sticky point: Both sides would need to compromise on ultra-Orthodox military service exemptions, which many Israelis view as unfair

Unity government:

Eisenkot's Yashar, Together, and Israel Our Home could form a unity government with Netanyahu's Likud party (53 seats), securing 67-seat majority

NEIGHBOURHOOD WATCH

Bangladesh law minister says Hasina's extradition request sent to India

Bangladesh's Law Minister Md Asaduzzaman on Sunday described ousted prime minister Sheikh Hasina *(pictured)* as a "convicted criminal" and said Dhaka has requested India to extradite her, according to local media reports. Asaduzzaman said the government was taking all necessary legal steps to bring Hasina back from India and would follow due process. "To me, she is a criminal. A criminal convicted by our tribunal. To us, this is her identity," he said, according to a report on *bdnews24* website. "The matter will be dealt with in accordance with the law, leaving no room for emotions," Asaduzzaman was quoted as saying by the state-run *BSS news* agency. India has previously acknowledged receiving Bangladesh's extradition requests for Hasina but has not announced any decision on handing her over. The Ministry of External Affairs has said the requests are being examined as part of its established processes. PTI



Pakistan's KP plans faceless anti-terror courts

The administration in Pakistan's Khyber Pakhtunkhwa (KP) province has planned to establish faceless anti-terrorism courts to protect witnesses, prosecutors and judges involved in terrorism cases. The provincial administration also plans to spend 70 billion Pakistani rupees annually on the police and Counter-Terrorism Department to boost their capabilities, *the Dawn* reported. PTI

A 'chaotic race' for the world's top diplomat

SOMINI SENGUPTA
8 November

Angst. Confusion. Endless conjecture. Such has been the mood at the United Nations (UN) in recent weeks as world powers have deliberated behind closed doors over who will be the next secretary general.

For 80 years, the job has gone to the classic grey man: a diplomat from democracies including Sweden, South Korea and, most recently, Portugal.

The latest contest has pitted two candidates backed by regional rivals, Turkey and the United Arab Emirates (UAE), along with a diplomat supported by Argentina's right-wing leader, Javier Milei, and four other diplomats from Latin America.

It is possible that the current secretary general, António Guterres, 77, who leaves at the end of the year after two terms, could step down without a successor being chosen. In the world body's 80-year history, that has never happened. Considering how battered the UN has been by crises — wars in Ukraine and Gaza, climate change and the alarming growth of artificial intelligence (AI) — it is remarkable that anyone would want the top job, and that there is such turmoil over it.

President Trump has repeatedly attacked the organisation, pulled out of numerous UN agreements and gutted its funding. Still, in theory at least, it is the secretary general who sets the UN's agenda and goads world powers to work together to advance world peace.

This year's race was jolted by two last-minute entrants. Lana Nusseibeh, the former UN envoy from the UAE, entered the contest in October, prompting an outcry over reports that her country has supported rebels accused of atrocities in Sudan. Then, the Emirates' regional rival, Turkey, nominated its own candidate: Feridun Sinirlioglu, head of the Organization for Security and Cooperation in Europe.

The turmoil has cracked open the field, upending hopes that a Latin American official would get the job, in keeping with an informal agreement of regional rotation, or that a woman would finally take the reins. There has also never been a more chaotic time at the global body. The UN's overall budget is $6.5 billion in arrears, driven largely by the Trump administration's funding cuts. Its reputation has been hammered by its inability to negotiate peace in war zones, including Sudan, Syria and Gaza. Morale among UN staff is at rock bottom, according to several current and former staff members. Thousands of jobs have been eliminated.



UN Secretary General António Guterres may step down in December , without a successor chosen — a first in UN history REUTERS

The UN Security Council is responsible for choosing the next secretary general. But relations among its members, especially its five permanent members with veto powers range from distrustful to rotten.

Some candidates for secretary general, including Rafael Grossi, are seen as being close to the US. Grossi, an Argentine, leads the UN nuclear watchdog, the International Atomic Energy Agency (IAEA).

Others, like Rebeca Grynspan, a Costa Rican diplomat who heads the UN's trade body and helped negotiate a short-lived Black Sea grain trade deal, are viewed as too unwilling to shake up the agency enough to please the Trump administration.

Nusseibeh is also seen as cosy with Washington and Moscow, but ultimately too close to the authoritarian government of the UAE. China has made clear that it favours a Latin American secretary general, though it has not said who.

The Security Council is trying to select the next UN boss through a series of "straw polls", or informal ballots. No one knows who voted which way, but hints of the deliberations have emerged.

The eighth and latest poll was carried out on Thursday afternoon. According to Security Council Report, an independent publication, six of the Council's 15 members voted against Nusseibeh's candidacy. Sinirlioglu did worse. Neither pulled out. Grynspan emerged on top, with 12 members supporting her candidacy and three saying they did not.

But which three? And did they include any of the five permanent members? What kind of horse-trading would be required? Would the American midterm elections affect the US position?

All remained unclear, leading to more speculation and anxiety.

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Villagers demand COP31 leaders witness Türkiye coal devastation

REUTERS
8 November

Local official Nejla Isik is among the villagers living beside a coal mine who demand that world leaders gathering in Türkiye for COP31 climate talks leave the conference venue to inspect the devastation decades of lignite extraction have caused.

Beginning on Monday, the transition to cleaner energy will be among the themes at the United Nations (UN) conference that continues until November 20 in Antalya on Türkiye's Mediterranean coast.

Isik, an elected official for her community, says the government leaders and UN officials need to head a few hundred kilometres west to Ikizkoy, near the Akbelen forest in Türkiye's southwestern Mugla province, and see for themselves the impact of coal on nature and on people's lives.

Villagers, who for years have protested against coal mining, have been fined and arrested.

"They should come here, those heads of state. They should come not to Antalya but to Akbelen, to Ikizkoy," said Isik. Her home in Ikizkoy is only a few hundred metres behind a lignite mine that has crept nearer over decades of expansion. Lignite is the lowest grade of coal, meaning burning it releases more carbon dioxide than more energy-dense coal.

So far one of the prominent aims of COP31 is to agree a voluntary goal on increasing electrification, proposed by host country Türkiye, but unless the electricity is low-carbon it will not curb planet-warming emissions.

Last year, coal was Türkiye's largest electricity source, generating 34 per cent of the country's power, making Türkiye Europe's biggest coal-fired electricity generator, according to energy think tank Ember. The mines in the Akbelen area provide coal for plants that generate just over 2 per cent of Türkiye's power, according to the operator's website.

Villagers and environmental campaigners like Isik, who oppose the expansion of lignite mining, say it has destroyed forest and threatens olive groves, farmland and communities.

The fight against coal has had harsh consequences. Isik's 26-year-old daughter Esra spent 42 days in pretrial detention after a protest against the planned expropriation of land for mining. A court in July sentenced her to two years in prison for resisting public officials. She is free pending the decision of an appeal.



Yenikoy coal-fired power plant near Ikizkoy in the western province of Mugla, Türkiye PHOTO: REUTERS

"This punishment was not just handed to me. It was an attempt to punish everyone in this country who stands up for their rights, their land and their village," Esra Isik said.

Her mother has for years protested against the expansion of coal mining around her village.

"For 40 years we've been living with coal breathing down our necks. I try to live here with the breath of coal, with the dirt of coal," Nejla Isik said.

The coal supplies the nearby Yenikoy and Kemerkoy power plants, operated by Yenikoy-Kemerkoy Energy, a joint venture involving Limak and IC Ictas.

Limak declined to comment for this story. IC Ictas did not respond to a request for comment.

At a meeting with foreign media on Thursday, Energy Minister Alparslan Bayraktar said Türkiye was working on a just transition to cleaner energy, but that it was difficult as the mines employ thousands of people.

He said nuclear energy offered the most viable alternative and Ankara was aiming for 10 gigawatts of nuclear generation capacity by 2040. That would equate roughly to current coal-powered production, according to *Reuters* calculations.

Rights groups have raised concerns about restrictions on protests in Türkiye, including blanket bans on demonstrations, mass detentions and what they say is the disproportionate use of force.

Human Rights Watch said in an October report that Türkiye authorities had arbitrarily arrested and prosecuted environmental protesters in Akbelen and other parts of the country. It said security forces forcibly dispersed non-violent demonstrations and protesters, lawyers and journalists faced charges such as illegal assembly, obstructing public officials, trespass and spreading false information.

"With Türkiye about to host the annual UN climate change summit, its environmental crackdown is a salient reminder of its intolerance of dissent," said Deniz Bayram, assistant Europe and Central Asia researcher at Human Rights Watch.

The government says police intervene when demonstrations are unlawful or threaten public order. The interior ministry and justice ministry did not comment for this story.

The dispute around Akbelen intensified in 2023 when tree-felling resumed. Villagers say security forces used water cannon and pepper spray on demonstrators seeking to enter the forest and that other punishments followed.

"We were subjected to water cannon, pepper gas, detention, everything," Nejla Isik said. "Afterwards, because we didn't abandon this area, this village, there were fines, and a year later cases were opened against us."

Hasan Yorulmaz, another resident, said protesters had marched to stop pine trees being cut down when soldiers blocked their path. "They used pepper spray on women and men, young and old," he said. "Despite that, we continued the resistance. I was at the front and they took me away and detained me."

EU, UK close to deal to link their carbon markets

The European Union (EU) and the United Kingdom (UK) are in the final stages of a deal to link their emissions markets, a move that would boost liquidity and eventually save companies millions of euros in carbon border taxes.

The agreement, to be announced at a key summit later this month, would enable carbon permits to be traded across the two emissions systems, almost six years after Britain started its own cap-and-trade program in the wake of Brexit. Negotiators have already ironed out details on emissions caps, supply controls and free permits, according to people with knowledge of the matter. The treatment of financial derivatives is the only outstanding issue.

The EU's carbon market is the region's key way to meet its carbon reduction goals. BLOOMBERG

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Ten years after

Demonetisation was not worth the trouble

"Demonetisation has been a radical, unprecedented step with short-term costs and long-term benefits," noted the Economic Survey of 2016-17. To be fair, many commentators at that time believed it could have longer-term benefits. But that began to change soon. On November 8, 2016, the government decided to withdraw high-value currency notes of ₹500 and ₹1,000 from circulation. Those constituted about 86 per cent of the currency by value. The basic objective was to attack black money. It was reasoned that the "magnitude of cash in circulation is directly linked to the level of corruption". The move was part of the overall fight against corruption, counterfeiting, and terrorism. The implicit assumption was that those holding black money would not come forward to exchange or deposit cash due to the fear of getting exposed. The government had taken various other steps to curb black money, such as the 2015 law on disclosing black money and the 2016 law on benami transactions.

In a large economy like India, aggregate outcomes are often difficult to explain by a single factor. In the initial months and years of demonetisation, the government presented data and evidence in terms of an increase in the number of income-tax filings and collection of data that would help track black money and so on. Critics, on the other hand, argued that the lack of currency notes affected small businesses and the unorganised sector disproportionately. The slow pace of remonetisation did create difficulties for businesses and individuals. Sustained long queues in front of banks showed that the system was not prepared for such a large-scale operation.

Now that a decade has passed, and with the benefit of hindsight, it is worth asking whether demonetisation was worth the trouble. The answer clearly is "no". Most of the demonetised notes came back, and not much has been reported on how much black money was unearthed. Note that it was an attack on high cash circulation, which was seen as a symptom of corruption and illicit wealth. As the data featured elsewhere in this edition shows, cash as a proportion of gross domestic product was roughly at the same level in 2025-26 (12.06 per cent) as in 2015-16 (12.08 per cent). So, nothing changed.

The ratio did go down in 2016-17, partly because of the pace of remonetisation, but it started moving up in subsequent years. In fact, such a level of cash in circulation is more intriguing in 2026 than it was in 2016, given that India now has a popular and efficient digital payments infrastructure. Large volumes of transactions are processed in real time through the Unified Payments Interface (UPI). The level of cash in the economy is also puzzling for the Reserve Bank of India as was recently articulated by one of its top officials. Currency in circulation is growing even as the share of cash in individual transactions is declining. It appears that cash is still preferred for large transactions, possibly to maintain anonymity or avoid taxes. Cash usage in real estate, for instance, is still said to be very high. Clearly, withdrawing about 86 per cent of cash at one stroke hasn't yielded much. It also made it clear that there is no magic bullet for solving complex economic or social problems. Change usually is a process in a democracy and requires sustained effort and policy management. Reduction in the generation of black money will require a substantial reduction in the presence of the state in economic life, better use of technology to detect tax evasion, and tax reforms at various levels of government.

Defensive move

Agnipath 2.0 weakens the scheme's original objective

The Centre's decision to modify the Agnipath scheme partially reverses the objective for which this recruitment programme for the defence forces was launched four years ago. Introduced following the government's acceptance of the One Rank One Pension (OROP) scheme for the defence services in 2014, it sought to contain the burgeoning costs of personnel and pension owing to that decision. The original Agnipath scheme offered a four-year term of duty for soldiers below the rank of commissioned officers for all three services, bypassing traditional service benefits such as pension and rations. Those exiting the scheme after four years would be receiving a lump sum payment (Seva Nidhi) and support for future employment after discharge. The initial scheme provided for 25 per cent of Agniveers to be absorbed into the regular services on the basis of merit after the four-year term. An analysis by the Observer Research Foundation suggests that an Agniveer costs the government roughly ₹1.75 lakh less a year than a traditional soldier on standard pay bands. Under the new scheme, the 75 per cent of the Agniveers due to exit have been offered a two-year extension with a sharp pay increase of ₹43,500 and ₹47,500 in the two-year period with an option to enrol as regular soldiers at the end of two years based on their willingness to continue and merit. Those who exit after this two-year extension will benefit from an enhanced government contribution to the Seva Nidhi package from 50 per cent to 70 per cent.

The new scheme seeks to address some immediate issues. First, it would retain combat-trained Agniveers for longer and save on training costs, which will partly offset enhanced outlays under the new scheme. Second, the extension retains Agniveers who would have exited in the ordinary course, partially addressing the problem of both rising youth unemployment and a shortfall in defence personnel following a two-year recruitment freeze during Covid. These are legitimate solutions but the enhanced pay and Seva Nidhi payouts are likely to impose long-term pressures on an already stretched defence budget. The government allocated ₹17,396 crore for the Agnipath scheme in the 2026-27 defence budget, a 58 per cent increase over 2025-26. The new scheme, thus, will add to the bill for salaries and pensions, which already accounts for 44 per cent of the defence budget this financial year, with pensions alone (₹1.71 trillion) accounting for 22 per cent.

The enhanced spending on Agnipath 2.0 is also likely to crowd out defence capital expenditure, especially on modernisation, which is sorely needed to boost the defence forces' capabilities. Upgrades are urgently needed across the defence services — fighter and transport aircraft, helicopters, warships, submarines and even basic artillery guns, apart from new-age missiles and advanced unmanned aerial vehicles. An unintended consequence of Agnipath 2.0 is also likely to be accentuated — the weakening of the traditional esprit de corps of the regimental system, which relies on shared identity. There is some anxiety that competition for four- and six-year slots could vitiate the camaraderie so essential to combat efficacy. Agnipath 1.0 was launched to address a defence budgetary issue. In seeking to address unanticipated short-term problems, Agnipath 2.0 is likely to weaken the original objective.

GST: The unfinished reform

We are not yet at the GST promised in 2003

ILLUSTRATION: AJAYA KUMAR MOHANTY



In a recent paper (Arbind Modi & Ajay Shah 2026, https://bit.ly/ModiShah2026), we identified a conceptual failure in India's goods and services tax (GST). Restrictions on input-tax credit (ITC) and cash refunds compromise its character as a consumption-based value-added tax (VAT). These restrictions take Indian GST closer to the old-style turnover-based tax, burdening production and investment rather than taxing final consumption alone. The GST Council's decisions of October represent small parametric reform in the correct direction. What is required is the economic logic of GST. In India, this is one of the most important feasible reforms that would boost manufacturing, investment, exports and economic growth.



AJAY SHAH & ARBIND MODI

Economic efficiency requires that taxes fall on final household consumption, never on intermediate inputs or capital formation. GST is an accrual-based flow tax requiring symmetric treatment of positive and negative net liabilities. Each tax period, liability equals tax on outward supplies less ITC on legitimate business inputs, including goods, services and capital goods. When output tax exceeds ITC, the difference is payable to the government; when ITC exceeds output tax, the excess is paid by the government.

This is the gold standard of a consumption-type VAT. ITC or its refund is not a privilege granted to certain groups: It is the essence through which we graduate from the old Indian excise tax to GST with all the consequential economic gains. Capital-goods ITC must also be immediately available: Delayed recovery imposes financing costs on investment and undermines neutrality. A credit not promptly recovered is worth less than its nominal amount, and it is tantamount to not getting ITC correctly.

At its October 8 meeting, the GST Council recommended extending inverted-duty refunds under Section 54(3) to input services from November 1, 2026, and including capital-goods ITC in refunds for zero-rated and qualifying inverted-duty supplies from April 1, 2027, subject to apportionment over 60 months. The apportionment applies to refunds, not to credits usable immediately against output tax. It also proposed removing selected restrictions under Section 17(5) and accelerating refunds through automated, risk-based processing. These decisions are in the correct direction and represent a part of the deficiencies identified in our paper.

Yet five-year apportionment introduces an income-type feature into a consumption-type VAT. Established businesses with sufficient output-tax liability (typically brownfield projects) can utilise capital-goods credits immediately, while newly established businesses with little initial output-tax liability (typically greenfield projects) depend on deferred cash refunds. The rule, therefore, discriminates against new enterprises undertaking identical investments. Like depreciation-based relief under an income-type VAT, deferred recovery reduces capital-goods credit in present-value terms, effectively taxing investment.

The GST Council has incrementally tried to address the refundability of ITC without changing the refund architecture. Cash refunds remain exceptions available in specified circumstances rather than the automatic consequence of negative net tax liability. Consider two businesses producing supplies taxed at 5 per cent and accumulating identical legitimate ITC. One qualifies for a refund because its material inputs attract a higher GST rate; the other does not because its excess credit arises mainly from services taxed at 18 per cent before outward supplies begin. The distinction is fully arbitrary when seen through the lens of economics. Under a consumption VAT, refund entitlement depends on excess legitimate credit, not the composition of inputs — goods, services or capital expenditure.

The 60-month rule also treats firms able to utilise credits immediately differently from those dependent on refunds, raising the latter's effective investment costs. Selective relaxation of blocked-credit provisions is welcome but incomplete: Restrictions on legitimate business expenditure, including factory civil works, still interrupt the credit chain and burden firms making substantial initial investments when output-tax liabilities are modest.

The October announcements represent parametric improvement within a conceptually confused framework. Refunds remain conditional while 60-month apportionment retains an income-type feature for businesses dependent on refunds. Unrecovered ITC raises production costs, discourages investment, and disadvantages domestic value addition relative to imported finished products, which cross the border free of domestic input-tax cascading. Faster processing cannot compensate for denying refunds of legitimate credits. The measure of reform is not the number of additional categories made refundable but whether tax on business inputs and investment is eliminated in economic terms.

We now have a decade of experience with GST and there is a lot of understanding of how it works. The reform priority now is to replace exception-based refunds with a comprehensive, symmetric mechanism. All legitimate business-input taxes should qualify for immediate credit, with positive net liabilities paid to government and negative liabilities promptly refunded, subject to anti-abuse safeguards. This requires the GST architecture proposed by us in the Thirteenth Finance Commission Task Force architecture: A broader consumption base, fewer exemptions, and a low uniform rate around 12 per cent to reduce classification disputes and manipulation. Much of the immediate fiscal burden from refunds would be transitional rather than permanent. Previously blocked credits, however, carry a separate recurring fiscal cost. Eliminating taxes on production and investment would improve resource allocation, stimulate investment, and expand the tax base. Transitional costs must be managed, and not used to justify permanent economic distortions. A comprehensive GST with a single 12 per cent rate, including gold consumption but excluding investment bullion, could generate sufficient revenue to finance the transition and produce a fiscal surplus thereafter. A lower uniform rate would also weaken the justification for exemptions, expanding the tax base, and strengthening revenue productivity.

States ultimately receive 70.5 per cent of GST — 50 per cent directly as state GST and 20.5 per cent via the 41 per cent devolution of central GST. They also retain substantial taxing powers over alcohol, petroleum products, motor vehicles and property. Reforms of these taxes could offset transitional GST losses. Odisha, Karnataka, Tamil Nadu and Maharashtra are working on revenue reforms, demonstrating the path to strengthen state finances without perpetuating GST distortions.

The writers are, respectively, a researcher at the XKDR Forum, and affiliated with the Pune International Centre and XKDR Forum

Pollution control needs action, not bans

Delhi's season of despair has started with the winter setting in. When you read this, it is likely the city will have slipped into the category of "very severe" pollution. It is a time when toxins settle closer to the ground and choke us. This will be worse on windless days and on days when winds bring smoke from neighbouring fields where stubble is being burned. The question every year is: What have we done to make this season less harmful?



DOWN TO EARTH
SUNITA NARAIN

The good news is that the Delhi government has announced steps to tackle winter pollution. The bad news is that these measures are, at best, half-hearted and weak, and, worse, they signal completely giving up on pollution control. The action plan is about shutting down the city, putting the onus on the public to suspend day-to-day activities. I say this knowing fully well that activities like driving to work add to pollution.

The sheer number of private cars and two-wheelers is a major contributor to air pollution. But the plan works only when commuters have viable alternatives, such as adequate and augmented public transport and roads where people can cycle or walk, before directing us to work at 50 per cent capacity for the coming three months — from November to January.

The government has taken a page from the Graded Response Action Plan (Grap) playbook, without a clue of what this really means. Let me explain, as I was among those involved in taking the idea of Grap to the Supreme Court. This was in 2016, when I was a member of the erstwhile Environment Pollution (Prevention and Control) Authority (EPCA) for the National Capital Region (NCR), and reporting to the court. We proposed Grap as a smog-alert emergency measure — not as a substitute for real action. It was called "graded" because restrictions would be introduced based on the severity of air pollution. The EPCA also took to the court the matter of trucks and other heavy-duty vehicles passing through Delhi. This added enormously to pollution. The court levied a congestion or pollution tax on the entry of these vehicles and pressed the Union government to expedite the construction of alternative bypass expressways. Over the next two years, many decisive and tough actions were directed, including the fast transition to Bharat Stage VI fuel and vehicle technology.

When the court cleared the green signal to Grap in 2016, it was cognizant of the disruption it would cause. Closing schools, for instance, would come at the cost of education and create problems for parents. It was not a measure that could be taken lightly.

In the original Grap, notified by the Union government in 2017, schools were to close only on days when the air quality index deteriorated to the "severe" or "public emergency" category. Governments could introduce restrictions on heavy-duty vehicles entering the city and on plying private vehicles. The objective was to limit these measures to days when necessary and, meanwhile, to keep taking steps so that the measures would not be necessary. The inconvenience would prod governments to take year-long hard action. Shutdowns were not policy.

The government may argue that this is its grand plan. But frankly, there is no merit in this. Pollution-control measures are either half-baked, inadequate, or without the full-throated determination needed to clean up the air of Delhi-NCR.

Why do I say this? Two issues will clear the air. The first is the number of vehicles plying on Delhi's roads. The only real way ahead is a timebound plan to augment public transport, not just in Delhi but across the NCR and between its cities. We also need to make the transition to cleaner vehicles — electric buses, taxis, and three-wheelers should complement the electrified metro. Based on the EPCA's recommendations, the court had laid the foundations for this by 2019 — it directed (in 1998 and reiterated again and again) the need for at least 10,000 buses in the city, large or small.

It cleared the way for Delhi Metro Rail Corporation to expand its network and for the first high-speed rail corridor (Delhi-Meerut) to be built.

Obviously, much more needs to be done, particularly to interconnect the NCR so that it moves as one and to connect different modes of transport so that we can travel, switch, and reach our destination in affordable and convenient ways. But what we are doing is too little, too late.

Today, Delhi has only about 6,840 buses, instead of 10,000. Other cities of the NCR virtually have nothing for interconnections. The Delhi government's plan to electrify its bus fleet is notable, but with this we need a plan to increase ridership and provide a viable alternative to people as they shift from personal cars.

The second, and finally, is the issue of industrial pollution from factories operating in unauthorised areas in and around the city. These have been directed to stop using coal, but there is little effort to ensure that viable alternatives are available, whether reliable and cheaper electricity or natural gas. I could go on. But my gripe is that we are not acting at scale, by taking tough and time-bound action to bend the pollution curve.

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US' role in Ukraine's invasion

BOOK REVIEW

DAVID KORTAVA

In the past four years, pundits, journalists, and historians have thrown out a lot of explanations for why the war in Ukraine began. Some point to Covid-induced hysteria in the Kremlin, others to Soviet nostalgia. Some have even suggested that geography is destiny — as long as Russia exists, it will want the land on its borders.

Boiling Point, by the former *New York Times* journalist Stephen Kinzer, points the finger the other way. Based largely on secondary sources, the book may be the most comprehensive accounting of the United States' (US') long involvement in Ukraine. It is also among the clearest articulations of an iconoclastic, wildly counterintuitive argument — namely, that America and the North Atlantic Treaty Organization (Nato), not Russia, are principally responsible for the war in Ukraine.

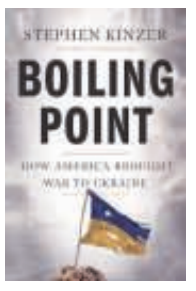
Mr Kinzer is not the first American public intellectual to make this case. In 2014, shortly after Russia occupied Crimea, the international relations scholar John Mearsheimer argued in *Foreign Affairs* that the crisis was the "West's fault". In order to appease Moscow, American and European officials should have been content to "make" Ukraine "a neutral buffer between Nato and Russia".

Boiling Point starts much earlier than the recent conflict. Beginning in the 1940s, Mr Kinzer writes, the US trained and armed anti-Soviet Ukrainian partisans, parachuting them into the country in a campaign to foment rebellion. The plans were half-baked; most of the participants were swiftly captured and killed.

For decades after, Americans funded — sometimes covertly, often openly — all manner of oppositionist activity through dissident media outlets and, later, nonprofits. In the 1950s, the CIA backed a radio station that broadcast from Germany into Ukraine. It also partnered with a publisher in New York whose pamphlets and articles were dropped into the country by balloon.

Much of this was driven, we are told, by zealous Eastern European refugees or their descendants, like the billionaire philanthropist George Soros, the American diplomat Richard Holbrooke and the former US ambassador to Nato Victoria Nuland, who, according to Mr Kinzer, had "imbibed anti-Russia passion with her mother's milk".

By the time President Vladimir Putin launched his full-scale invasion of Ukraine in 2022, Mr Kinzer contends, the country was "a fully compliant proxy of the United States". Like his predecessors, Mr Kinzer also stresses Nato enlargement as the taproot of hostility between Moscow and the West. Since the end of the Cold War, the alliance has welcomed 16 new members, most of them from what Moscow regards as its historic sphere of influence. In 1994, Ukraine joined Nato's Partnership for Peace, a programme seen as a stepping-stone to membership. Five years later, over Russian objections, Nato forces bombed Yugoslavia.



Boiling Point: How America Brought War to Ukraine
by Stephen Kinzer
Published by Holt
369 pages $32.99

By that point, Mr Kinzer writes, "no one in the Kremlin could avoid recognizing that Russia's ultimate security nightmare — Ukrainian membership in a hostile military alliance — was beginning to become real". In his view, it was this intolerable possibility, and the West's cavalier disrespect for Russia's "security concerns", that would cause the country's elites to lose faith in the US and, many years later, compel Putin to attack Ukraine.

This is an unfalsifiable thesis. We can only speculate about how Russia's position might have developed in the absence of Nato enlargement. But the opposite hypothetical is just as hard to disprove. As a pair of ambassadors who served between Poland and the United States argued in 2024: "If NATO enlargement had not taken place, then Europe might now be dealing with Russian domination of Ukraine, re-occupation of the Baltics and the direct threat of an invasion of Poland."

The trouble with fixating on Putin's ostensible concerns over Ukraine's future in Nato is that, well, there were no imminent plans for Ukraine to join. In February 2022, as Russian troops amassed on Ukraine's border, the German chancellor Olaf Scholz told reporters that the Kremlin was forcing "a military conflict about an issue that isn't even on the agenda".

For Mr Kinzer, most major political events in that part of the world can largely be explained as a reaction to American pressure. In Donald Trump's second term, Mr Kinzer and his fellow restrainers are getting a taste for what scaling back US involvement in the region could look like. Last month, the Trump administration reportedly threatened to cut off intelligence sharing and suspend weapons deliveries. Ukraine also lost access to a satellite system that its military uses for battlefield communication and drone operations. Meanwhile, as Ukraine's sixth winter in war approaches, the only thing worse than US meddling, it seems, is US abandonment.

In a narrow sense, Kinzer's overarching thesis is probably right: Were it not for American and European support for Kyiv over many years, Ukraine would likely not be at war with Russia today. Instead, it might resemble a large Belarus — a docile protectorate that is sovereign only in name, on good terms with Moscow at the cost of its own prosperity, dignity and freedom.

The reviewer is an editor at *Foreign Affairs*

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"PUNJAB TRUSTED AAP, BHAGWANT MANN. THE PROMISE WAS — WE WILL ERADICATE DRUGS. I ASK, FROM WHICH CORNER OF PUNJAB HAVE YOU ERADICATED DRUGS?"

Rahul Gandhi, Leader of Opposition in the Lok Sabha



"(BIKRAM) MAJITHIA AND AMIT SHAH ARE JUST LIKE BROTHERS. BY ALLYING WITH MAJITHIA, SHAH WILL ERADICATE DRUGS FROM PUNJAB. THIS WILL BE THE EIGHTH WONDER OF THE WORLD"

Arvind Kejriwal, Aam Aadmi Party national convenor



"I WANT TO THANK ARVIND KEJRIWAL FOR REMEMBERING ME. IT HAS BEEN 5 YEARS, AND NO CHARGESHEET HAD BEEN FILED AGAINST ME IN THE DRU-RELATED CASE TO DATE. EVEN THIS CHARGESHEET IS ONLY 12 PAGES LONG"

Bikram Singh Majithia, Shiromani Akali Dal leader, on the recent chargesheet against him

Of student politics and Muslim leadership

Beyond the demand for elections, the agitation at Jamia reflects deeper anxieties over representation, political identity and the future of campus politics. **Arushi Bhaskar** writes

Jamia Millia Islamia's 106th Foundation Day on October 29, 2026, marked a significant development in a long-running dispute over student representation: The university took its first steps towards restoring its students' union, dissolved more than two decades ago. The announcement followed an 18-day protest that brought the campus in Okhla to a standstill and raised questions extending beyond the immediate demand for elections.

The agitation for the Jamia Millia Islamia Students' Union (JMISU) saw five students go on an indefinite hunger strike. Classes were suspended or shifted online, while the presence of police and security personnel increased. Protesters and some faculty members described the campus as an "open-air prison", a characterisation that reflected their frustration with the restrictions imposed during the agitation.

JMISU was dissolved in 2006, with the administration citing campus violence and disruptions in academic activities. With the issue going to court, successive administrations had cited judicial proceedings as a reason to not hold students' union elections. In 2022, the Supreme Court while disposing a public interest litigation demanding that elections be held in accordance with the J M Lyngdoh Committee, had neither barred future elections nor mandated them.

The protest ended with the university administration agreeing to hold elections "approximately within six weeks of 16 July, 2027", following the implementation of a new students' union constitution by May 15 that year. The administration also revoked earlier orders closing hostels and withdrew disciplinary proceedings, including suspension and expulsion proceedings, against protesting students. Offline classes resumed.

The development offered a way out of the immediate standoff, but it left larger questions about the place of student politics at Jamia, the university's institutional autonomy and the political significance attached to the emergence of Muslim leadership.



Jamia students celebrate after their successful protests demanding the reinstatement of the university's students' union, on October 30 PHOTO: PTI

The 'Muslim leader'

On the face of it, the demand for a students' union is about campus representation, not religious identity. At Jamia, however, the two have become difficult to separate, given the university's status as a minority institution and its place in India's political history.

According to a faculty member who spoke on condition of anonymity, the issue acquires a wider significance because of the limited avenues available for the emergence of Muslim political leadership. "A lot of politicians were exposed to politics on the campus first. We don't really have that kind of thing for the Muslim community. We've been demanding that for 70 years now," she says. "If an institution like Jamia gets its leadership, there is a high chance it might translate into leadership on a larger scale in the country also."

Former Amroha MP and Congress leader Danish Ali shares this interpretation. He believes resistance to the emergence of Muslim leadership is among the reasons the restoration of JMISU has taken so long.

"Don't elections happen in DU (Delhi University) and JNU (Jawaharlal Nehru University)? In fact, Jamia never had the kind of violence that happens in several other universities. Why is it then that Jamia is being singled out?" he questions. "When student leaders emerge, they will become community, country leaders... Jamia's founders did not establish the varsity just to distribute degrees."

For Sanam Husain, a PhD scholar and former Jamia unit president of the Students' Federation of India (SFI), who was among the organisers of the protests, the university's role in the 2019 protests against the Citizenship Amendment Act (CAA) and National Register of Citizens (NRC) remains central to understanding the current tensions. "If we look back at 2019, the first time this government was challenged over the CAA-NRC, it was by the students of Jamia. They fear the students here. We were the first ones to take out a protest march, which then spread across the city and country," she says.

Founded in 1920 by Mohammad Ali Jauhar, Hakim Ajmal Khan, Mukhtar Ahmad Ansari and Abdul Majeed Khwaja, Jamia emerged from the nationalist movement, with Mahatma Gandhi also supporting its formation. Its history has long intersected with India's political life, and its alumni include former Chief Election Commissioner S Y Quraishi; BJP spokesperson Shazia Ilmi; Akhlaqur Rahman Kidwai, former Governor of Bihar, Haryana and West Bengal; and Amanatullah Khan, the incumbent MLA from Okhla.

The Gen Z factor

"Jamia's Gen Z celebrated Foundation Day when the administration didn't... I am proud to be a Jamia alumnus when I see that there are still students like them," says Ali.

The protests also bring into focus a wider pattern of youth-led political mobilisation. Gen Z, loosely defined as those born between 1997 and 2012, has increasingly found a voice in movements across the world, including India. Yet the extent to which these disparate protests represent a coherent political shift, rather than issue-specific bursts of discontent, remains an open question.

Earlier this year, in July, prominent BJP leader Dharmendra Pradhan had to resign as Union Education Minister following widespread protests over the NEET-UG paper leak. The agitation brought young Indians onto the streets in a major challenge to the Narendra Modi-led government, which has been in power since 2014.

Husain attributes the success of the Jamia protests partly to this wider mood of youth mobilisation. "After Jantar Mantar, students realised that we have no option but to ask for what we want, otherwise the system will keep blaming us for whatever is going wrong," she says.

The way forward

For Husain, the immediate priority is to draft the new students' union constitution and ensure that student representation goes beyond being a provision on paper.

The larger challenge, she says, is the climate of political apprehension on campus.

"For 20 years, students have been unable to come together to express their problems and other issues. There's an all-pervasive fear now among even educated Muslims that they will become the next Umar Khalids and Sharjeel Imams, and be targeted by the government. That has to go. And it will go — it's a slow process, but we will get there," she says.

The students' union is not the only representative body whose future remains uncertain. The Jamia Teachers Association (JTA) has been defunct since 2022, when the university administration dissolved it, cancelled its forthcoming elections and sealed its office over disciplinary issues.

The Delhi High Court quashed the administration's order in October 2025. Yet the association remains dissolved, with no plans announced by the university to revive it. A second faculty member, also speaking on condition of anonymity, says there is an undercurrent of support for bringing back the JTA. But organising has become increasingly difficult.

The agreement to restore JMISU may resolve one long-standing dispute, but it does not settle the larger questions surrounding campus life at Jamia. The university will now have to work out the terms of representation, the rules governing elections and the relationship between student bodies and its administration. For a university whose history is closely tied to India's nationalist movement, the debate is also about the kind of political space Jamia wants to be. Whether the return of student elections will create room for a broader generation of leadership, as its supporters hope, or bring fresh tensions to an already contested campus will depend on what follows.

PM: Maoists gone, but now '*dimagi* Naxals' targeting Constitution



PM Narendra Modi interacts with CRPF personnel in Bastar, on the occasion of Diwali PHOTO: PTI

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
Jagdalpur, 8 November

Targeting political opponents, Prime Minister Narendra Modi on Sunday said armed Maoists have been eliminated, but "*dimagi* Naxals" have infiltrated several political parties and organisations and are instigating people against the Constitution and democracy.

"We must identify and defeat such elements and secure the country," Modi said, while celebrating Diwali with security personnel at a CRPF camp in Chhattisgarh's Bastar, continuing his tradition of spending the festival with India's brave men and women in uniform.

The government had declared the country free of Naxalism on March 31 this year.

The threat of Naxalism has not ended. The government took decisions that "dealt very big blows to the funding of Naxals and secessionists," said Modi, dressed in a military-style camouflage uniform and a hat. He said the Maoist terror elimination was a victory of the country's right policies and strong political will.

"Amid the successes, we must remember one more thing. Naxalites have been eliminated, but the threat is not over yet. Armed Naxalites have disappeared from the forests, but '*dimagi* Naxals' (their ideological supporters) have taken control of several organisations," he said.

"Even today, they are instigating people against the country's Constitution and democracy. They have infiltrated several political parties and different organisations. We must identify and defeat them and secure the country," he added.

Recalling the fight against Naxalism in Bastar, Modi on Sunday said it was not easy, as at one point over 230 districts across nearly 20 states in India were affected by left-wing extremism.

After sunset, life would come to a standstill. Thousands of villages and crores of people were affected, with around 2,000 Naxalite attacks taking place annually, he said.

"This land had become soaked in the blood of our brave personnel, but not a single sigh of grief was heard from any of the '*naamdaar*' (powerful people) living in palaces. Not a single tear rolled down their eyes. Such attacks continued to take place somewhere or the other almost every day," he said, targeting previous governments.

Was 'tormented' by pull of duty and fears before joining politics: Sonia in memoir

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
New Delhi, 8 November

Former Congress president Sonia Gandhi "always disliked' politics and was at war with herself over whether she should take the plunge into the political world after her husband Rajiv Gandhi's assassination, but the *Bhagavad Gita* helped resolve her doubts and showed her the path forward.

In her memoir *Belonging: A Journey of Love*, which is coming out this week, she talks about Congress facing a challenging time in the late 1990s, and how each time she walked past Rajiv's picture and that of her mother-in-law Indira Gandhi's, a mixture of pain and guilt would seize her.

IN *BELONGING: A JOURNEY OF LOVE*, SONIA GANDHI WRITES THAT THE *BHAGAVAD GITA* HELPED ANSWER HER DOUBTS AND REALISE WHERE HER DUTY LAY

She further recalls how her children, Rahul and Priyanka Gandhi, "argued fiercely" with her as they feared she might allow herself to get drawn into politics and "they didn't want to lose me, too". "I was caught in a war with myself: Part of me recoiled at the world of politics, of the ambition and greed, hypocrisy and treachery that goes inescapably with the game of power everywhere," she writes.

Tormented by the pull of duty and her fears, Sonia says she turned to the *Bhagavad Gita*, and as her readings were drawing to a close and Krishna expounded the message, "perform your dharma without regard for the fruit of your action", "something awoke in me". "I had the answer to my own doubts and questions. I had to step out and go where my duty called. And I did," she adds.

Recalling her journey after losing her husband in 1991, Sonia says that as she gradually emerged from seclusion and became a little more active, "once in a while Rajiv's former colleagues would visit — some for a courtesy call, or to invite me to a family function, others with pleas that I take an active interest in party affairs". "To the latter I would listen quietly but not heed their request," she says in her book, excerpts of which have been published by *The Hindu*.

Noting that the 1996 election results were disappointing for the Congress as it had not been able to form a government on its own, Gandhi says the party was plagued by splits and factional disputes. "In 1995 I had been asked to support one particular group, in which the main actors were Arjun Singh, N D Tiwari, and Mohsina Kidwai, who'd been party members for decades and had held important positions and ministries. I had refused. They broke away and formed another party, followed the next year by senior Tamil leaders G K Moopanar and P. Chidambaram, and a younger Congress member, Madhavrao Scindia, who'd joined in 1980. All of them set up separate parties. In 1997, Mamata Banerjee left, due to differences with the state leadership, and formed her own party, the Trinamool Congress. I had become a primary member in 1997 when I was invited by the Congress President Sitaram Kesri to the party's 80th Plenary Session in Calcutta, but as the party's situation seemed to be worsening, the pressure on me was increasing to take over its leadership," she writes.

A dilemma in Keralam as Bengal calls back migrant workers

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
Kottayam, 8 November

Building contractor Vijayakumar is keenly awaiting the return of his expert worker, a native of Murshidabad district in West Bengal, after he left for home today celebrate Durga Puja. Only, the worker's return remains uncertain now.

The uncertainty stems from an appeal by West Bengal Chief Minister Suvendu Adhikari asking workers to stay back, citing livelihood opportunities under the VB-G RAM G scheme, which guarantees 125 days of work and enables them to earn a livelihood while living with their families.

His employee in question has been working in the construction sector in Keralam for years. He left for his native village a few weeks ago to celebrate Durga Puja. He is an expert in building houses in the traditional Keralam style, according to Vijayakumar, from Veliyannoor village in this district.

The West Bengal government's announcement has triggered anxiety in Keralam, which depends heavily on migrant workers across several sectors, particularly construction, where their services are crucial to sustaining ongoing projects.

According to Vijayakumar, the arrival of workers from West Bengal had already declined following the recent Assembly elections in the state, with the drop being particularly noticeable among Hindu workforce. "There are migrant workers who have been coming to Keralam from West Bengal for years. But many are now deciding to continue working in their home state for various reasons," he told *PTI*.

"In this situation, the West Bengal government's latest announcement is likely to further affect their migration to Keralam," he said.

Workers from West Bengal once constituted the majority of the migrant workforce in Keralam's construction sector. However, those from Jharkhand, Odisha and Assam, among other states, now account for a larger share, he said.

If the West Bengal government's announcement succeeds in persuading even a significant section of migrant workers to remain in their home state, Keralam's construction sector is likely to be the worst affected, Vijayakumar claimed.

The impact on the hotel industry, however, may not be substantial, as a large number of workers in the sector come from states such as Mizoram, he added.

A migrant mason in Keralam currently earns around ₹1,200 to ₹1,300 a day. Workers say they receive only around ₹650 to ₹700 for similar work in West Bengal.

Vijayakumar said migrant workers were also visiting their native places more frequently.

Earlier, most workers would visit their home states once or twice a year. Now, many travel home every three to four months and stay there for around a month, he said.

The latest announcement could persuade a significant percentage of workers to stay back in their home state, even if it means earning ₹100 to ₹200 less per day, he added.

West Bengal CM Adhikari had highlighted the employment opportunities available under the VB-G RAM G scheme.

"There is huge scope under the VB-G RAM G scheme, which offers a guarantee of 125 days of work. I urge migrant labourers to come back and work in their own state. Come back and work with your family. ₹34,500 per annum is guaranteed for each job card holder," he had said.

During the West Bengal Assembly election campaign, various political parties had promised a range of measures aimed at encouraging migrant workers to return to their home state.

Pala-based builder Krishnaprasad K also said assurances of employment opportunities in their home state could influence migrant workers from West Bengal and potentially affect their availability in Kerala.

He said all the migrant workers employed at his construction sites were from West Bengal, with none from other states.

"As of now, none of the workers has told me that they would not come back or that they are planning to return home. They have been travelling back and forth, particularly in connection with Dussehra celebrations. However, such an assurance from their state government could potentially affect the flow of workers from there," he told *PTI*.

Sethunath M, chief executive officer of CREDAI Kerala, however, believes that any return migration of workers to their home states would only be a temporary phenomenon.



A long way home

- Keralam depends heavily on migrant workers in several sectors, especially in construction
- According to employers, migration from West Bengal has been declining since the 2026 Assembly election results
- With West Bengal CM Suvendu Adhikari announcing that the government will expand rural employment opportunities under the VB G-RAM-G scheme, more workers could return back home
- However, a migrant mason in Keralam earns ₹1,200-1,300/day in Keralam; back home in West Bengal, similar work fetches them ₹650-700
- These wages, reportedly the highest in India, could mean that a return migration from Keralam is only a temporary phenomenon

CREDAI Kerala is the state unit of the Confederation of Real Estate Developers' Associations of India, representing private builders and real estate developers in the state.

He said Keralam offers some of the highest wages for construction workers in the country, with even an average of around ₹900 a day.

Given the relatively high wages, workers are unlikely to compromise on their earnings and return to their home states permanently, he said.

"Therefore, the West Bengal chief minister's announcement is unlikely to have any long-term impact on Keralam. Workers are not likely to leave immediately based on such an announcement. Even if some of them return, it would only be a temporary situation," he told *PTI*.

He said the better living conditions, food, social acceptance, higher wages and assured rest and leave facilities available in Keralam were factors that migrant workers would find difficult to overlook.

Sethunath also pointed out that Keralam had witnessed similar instances of return migration during the special intensive revision (SIR) of the electoral rolls and the Assembly elections in the past.

"At that time, a large number of workers returned to their home states, leaving several construction sites in Kerala facing difficulties for some time. However, they eventually came back. Even if a similar situation arises now, it is unlikely to have a lasting impact," he said.

Noted migration researcher Navas M Khadar said the West Bengal government's decision to expand rural employment opportunities under the scheme was unlikely to have any significant impact on the overall flow of interstate migrant workers to Keralam. Although the expanded scheme could provide a safety net for rural households and reduce short-distance seasonal migration, Keralam's higher wages and demand for workers were likely to sustain interstate labour migration, he said.

"The scheme may help reduce distress-driven seasonal migration to nearby states, but it cannot replace the higher-paying employment opportunities available in Keralam," Khadar told *PTI*.

A migrant worker in Keralam could earn in around 40 to 45 days what the West Bengal scheme guarantees as wages for an entire year, he pointed out.

Explaining the factors driving migration, Khadar said young workers, particularly those in the 18-35 age group, moved to Keralam not merely to meet their daily needs but also to save money, acquire skills and improve their economic prospects.

Rural employment schemes were more likely to benefit women, elderly people and other household members who did not migrate for work. These could supplement household incomes but might not replace the higher earnings available in the southern state, he said.

However, the expanded rural employment programme could discourage short-term seasonal migration to neighbouring states and regions where the wage difference was not substantial enough to justify travel and living expenses, he added.

Khadar, a research associate at Christ University, said the temporary decline in migrant labour availability in Keralam, particularly in construction, infrastructure and hospitality, should not be viewed as a permanent trend. Workers often returned to their home states during elections to cast their votes, participate in local activities and complete administrative formalities related to identity documents and welfare benefits, he said. Such visits could lead to temporary labour shortages and project delays lasting around 30 to 60 days.

However, workers were likely to return to Keralam after completing these activities, given the higher wages and employment opportunities available in the state, he added.

According to unofficial estimates, Keralam has 3.5 million to 4 million migrant workers across various sectors. Vijayakumar said many of the workers, had been working with him for around 12 to 13 years. Over the years, they had earned enough to buy land in their native villages and improve their standard of living.

Pabitra Mondal, a construction worker, said that having reached a different stage in life, some of them may now prefer to return to their villages, take up farming and supplement their income with other jobs, rather than continue migrating for work.

The desire to spend more time with their families and lead a settled life in their home villages could also be influencing their decisions. Besides, certain measures introduced by the new government may be encouraging them to return, he added.

Business Standard MUMBAI | MONDAY, 9 NOVEMBER 2026

The Smart Investor

STREET VIEW

"Fears of tighter AI regulation after the Democrats' midterm sweep in the US, and doubts over AI spending still hang over the (technology) sector"

Fawad Razaqzada,
Market Analyst, StoneX Trading & Forex.com



Bumpy ride may continue in Samvat 2083

Volatility likely on account of oil prices, geopolitical tensions, and FPI flows

KAIRAVI LUKKA
Mumbai, 8 November

After a turbulent Samvat 2082, Indian investors should brace for continued uncertainty. Analysts say volatility is expected to remain a key feature of the market in Samvat 2083, which started with Diwali on Sunday.

Domestic equities are likely to remain turbulent in the new Hindu calendar year, with geopolitical crises, crude oil prices and foreign investor flows weighing on markets.

Samvat 2082 was one of the weakest for Indian equities in 15 years, even though it ended on a high, with the Nifty 50 and Sensex posting weekly gains of 8.6 to 8.8 per cent — their largest in nearly six years. This unfolded against the backdrop of a Democratic Party victory in the US midterm elections and a partial unwinding of the artificial intelligence (AI) trade.

Consequently, Brent crude cooled to $98.3 a barrel on Friday, while 10-year US Treasury yields dropped below the 5 per cent mark to 4.86 per cent, down from their multi-year high of 5.37 per cent.

The October outlook from the US Energy Information Administration projects Brent spot averaging $84 in 2027, provided most Middle Eastern production returns to pre-conflict levels by June 2027. The agency made clear this is a conditional forecast, warning that tanker attacks could change the situation overnight.

"A de-escalation of the US-Iran war could bring oil prices down by 30-40 per cent, benefiting India. A resolution of the Russia-Ukraine conflict would further improve global sentiment. Additionally, a correction in stretched AI valuations could trigger an anti-AI trade, potentially redirecting flows towards Indian markets," said U R Bhat, co-founder and director of Alphaniti Fintech, adding that domestic fundamentals such as economic growth, GST collections, and corporate earnings have remained encouraging so far.

"A sustained rally will also require foreign portfolio investors buying or at least a moderation in their selling," Bhat said.

Overseas investors pulled out a record ₹4.55 trillion in Samvat 2082, while domestic institutional investors (DIIs) cushioned the blow with buys totalling ₹8.55 trillion. The consensus among foreign investors is cautiously positive for 2027, though they remain positive on the long-term outlook. "We retain a tactical mild underweight stance on Indian equities. Indian equities outperformed global and Asia ex-Japan equities in October. However, MSCI India now trades at more than double the price-to-earnings (P/E) ratio for Asia ex-Japan equities while offering potentially slower earnings growth in 2027, leading to low probability of sustained outperformance," said a note by HSBC Private Bank on November 5.

MSCI India has a forward P/E of 18.45 times. MSCI's Asia ex-Japan index is at 8.84 times forward P/E, according to data as on October 30.

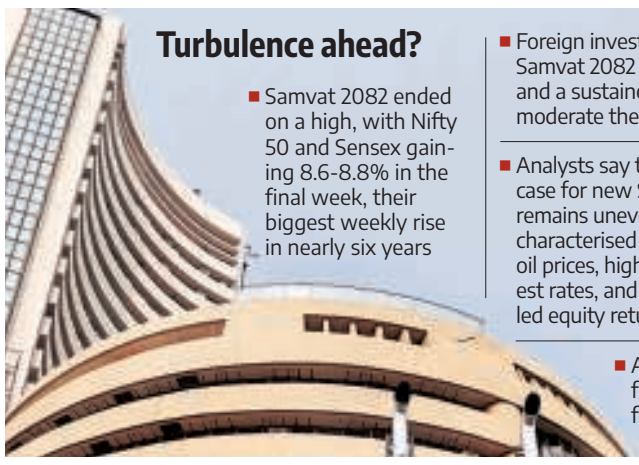
"We favour defensive, domestically oriented largecap companies, with financials and industrials remaining preferred sectors," it said.

A report by BlackRock on October 26 said: "We favour above-benchmark exposure to Indian equities in strategic portfolios over five years and beyond. We are neutral on Indian equities tactically: large-cap valuations still look expensive relative to regional peers, and earnings prospects vary across the market. We expect a selective market, with returns driven increasingly by earnings delivery."

Samvat 2082 saw benchmark indices underperform broader markets. The Sensex and Nifty 50 declined 4 per cent and 3.1 per cent, respectively, while the Nifty Midcap 100 and Nifty Smallcap 100 indices gained 2.1 per cent and 4.2 per cent.

Analysts told *Business Standard* that the base case remains uneven, characterised by lower oil prices, higher interest rates, and earnings-led equity returns. The bull case assumes lower inflation and higher profitability from India's banks and large companies, whereas the bear case sees current high oil prices persisting alongside a weak rupee and earnings downgrades. Their opinion is that under such scenarios, banks and financials are still the best bets. They are sceptical about midcaps and smallcaps where valuations are high. The Nifty Midcap 150 trades at a P/E of 28x and the Nifty Smallcap 100 trades at 34x while the Nifty 50 is attractive at a trailing PE of 21x.

Deven Choksey, promoter and managing director of DRChoksey FinServ, said he is positive about India's long-term prospects amid global uncertainty and market volatility.



Turbulence ahead?

- Samvat 2082 ended on a high, with Nifty 50 and Sensex gaining 8.6-8.8% in the final week, their biggest weekly rise in nearly six years
- Foreign investors sold a record ₹4.55 trillion in Samvat 2082 while DIIs bought ₹8.55 trillion, and a sustained rally needs FPIs to buy or at least moderate their selling
- Analysts say the base case for new Samvat remains uneven, characterised by lower oil prices, higher interest rates, and earnings-led equity returns
- HSBC is tactically mildly underweight and BlackRock neutral on India due to expensive valuations, though both are positive long term
- Analysts see banks and financials as the best bets for the new Samvat

STREET SIGNS

Select themes stole the MF show in Samvat 2082

Not all mutual fund investments disappointed in the just-ended Samvat, with select themes shining in a turbulent year. While international funds, led by ICICI Prudential Strategic Metal and Energy Equity Fund of Funds, once again dominated the list, the domestic list includes sectoral and thematic funds focused on healthcare and pharma funds, capital market, automobile and metals. The offerings have delivered 20-30 per cent returns in a year marked by heightened volatility. Among diversified funds, Motilal Oswal Focused Fund, Trust Smallcap and Bank of India Smallcap delivered the highest returns at over 20 per cent. Funds that delivered worst returns include passive funds tracking Hang Seng Tech index, Nifty India Railways PSU index, and Nifty FMCG. These schemes are down 15-30 per cent in one year.

Promoter share in listed cos at 7-qtr high of 50.4%

Promoter ownership in NSE-listed (National Stock Exchange-listed) firms rose to a seven-quarter high of 50.4 per cent in September 2026, driven by higher stakes held by private Indian and foreign promoters, according to the NSE's India Inc Ownership Tracker. Private Indian promoter share increased 58 basis points quarter-on-quarter to 32.7 per cent, while foreign promoter ownership rose 22 bps to 9.1 per cent, its highest in four years. Government ownership fell 62 bps to 9.1 per cent, a 13-quarter low, partly reflecting its stake sale in LIC. The broader trend, however, reversed in benchmark indices, with promoter ownership in the Nifty 50 and Nifty 500 declining to 40 per cent and 49.3 per cent, respectively.

Primary mkt quiet as Diwali hangover lingers

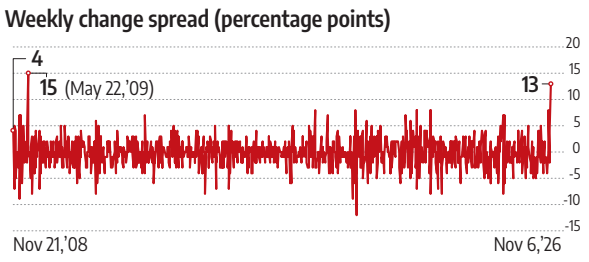
Dalal Street's primary market heads into a lull after Diwali, with no new mainboard IPO slated to open in this week. Issuers appear in no hurry to launch while festive fever keeps investors and deal teams distracted. Mainboard dates are typically announced only a few days before opening, so a late entry cannot be ruled out, but for now the week looks set to pass without a fresh public issue.

CONTRIBUTED BY ABHISHEK KUMAR & KHUSHBOO TIWARI

AI selloff rejuvenates Asia's forgotten trades

Nifty-Nasdaq spread highest since 2009

Weekly change spread (percentage points)



Source: Bloomberg

BLOOMBERG
8 November

The unravelling of the artificial intelligence (AI) trade after the US midterm elections is forcing investors to rethink their Asia playbook, reviving demand for out-of-favour Chinese and Indian stocks, and companies poised to benefit from easing inflation and trade tensions.

Aberdeen Investments favours markets powered by stronger domestic growth, including India and Vietnam, and sees upside in Chinese technology firms.

Asia has been among the hardest hit by the market fallout from the Democrats' sweep of US Congress. Many of the region's biggest stocks are critical suppliers to the global AI build-out, leaving local markets exposed as investors brace for greater scrutiny of the industry.

"I expect investors to diversify more broadly and reduce their concentration in the AI trade," said Rajeev De Mello, global macro portfolio manager at Gama Asset Management SA. "This should be supportive of China and other markets where valuations are less demanding," he said.

India's appeal has grown as oil prices fell on expectations of an earlier end to the Iran war. Its lack of AI exposure is also now seen as an advantage.

LOGOS Asset Management's Charlie Hong said he sold his shares in SK Hynix, Samsung Electronics, Intel and Lumentum Holdings last month and has since boosted his Indian holdings.

India's benchmark Nifty 50 gained 8.6 per cent last week, registering its best week since 2021, as overseas investors returned in force.

Global macros, uncertainty to drive commodity prices in new Samvat, too

KAIRAVI LUKKA
Mumbai, 8 November

Geopolitical developments, the trajectory of global interest rates and evolving supply-demand dynamics are likely to remain key factors impacting the commodity market in Samvat 2083.

Analysts said oil prices as well as bullion rates would continue to be key drivers of the Indian markets.

The World Bank expects oil and base metals to ease from the elevated 2026 annual averages. It also feels there is a bull case for gold which rests on central bank purchases and uncertainities.

Crude is expected to fall 20 per cent but if global uncertainties remain then prices may rise.

"Samvat 2083 is likely to remain volatile for oil prices," said Navneet Damani, head of research-commodities at Motilal Oswal Financial Services.

He expects some normalisation in oil prices if geopolitical tensions between the US and Iran ease, with Brent settling at $75-80 a barrel and West Texas Intermediate (WTI) returning to around $70.

"However, any escalation before the new political developments in the US in January could trigger fresh volatility. The next three months will be crucial, and we will watch how crude prices settle within a broader expected range of $70-120 a barrel," said Damani.

Vedika Narvekar, research analyst — commodities and currencies at Anand Rathi Shares and Stock Brokers, sees Brent crude oil trading in the $80-110 range.

"Oil is a tug-of-war between supply risk and diplomacy," she said. Narvekar added, "Product markets are tight, diesel is stretched into winter and inventories are shrinking. Against that, talks with Iran, the midterm result and the G7 stock release of 100 million barrels cap the upside."

Nonetheless, Narvekar said that if de-escalations, a US-Iran deal, and supply normalisation occur, oil may return below $70 a barrel. She also said gold would be the steadiest of the three in Samvat 2083.

"For gold, central bank buying, exchange-traded fund (ETF) flows, a US deficit near $2 trillion and any stagflation scare support prices. But a possible December Fed hike and high yields are the main risks," she said.

Narvekar sees MCX gold in the range of ₹1.3 lakh-₹1.75 lakh, with $4,900 (about ₹1.75 lakh) by end-2027.

Damani recommends accumulating gold on dips around $3,800-3,900, with targets of $4,200 in the short term and $4,500-4,700 over the medium term.

At a dollar-rupee assumption of 96, he sees ₹1.35 lakh as an accumulation zone, with targets of ₹1.48 lakh and ₹1.6 lakh-₹1.68 lakh.

Silver, which fell over 55 per cent from its record highs in Samvat 2082, could continue to remain volatile.

Narvekar said silver has a stronger supply story, with a sixth straight deficit expected in 2026 and a cumulative five-year shortfall of over 800 million ounces.

"But solar thrifting and artificial intelligence (AI)-linked sentiment keep its beta high relative to gold, with $48 as support, where a break opens $45," she said.

The outlook follows a year of sharp divergence in commodity performance. Brent crude spot prices surged 60.4 per cent in Samvat 2082, after declining 17.7 per cent in the previous Samvat. Gold and silver, on the other hand, fell 6.6 per cent and 0.8 per cent, respectively, in international markets.

However, domestic prices remained resilient, with gold gaining 10.8 per cent and silver rising 12.2 per cent. They were supported by the rupee depreciation.



Supply-demand tango

Commodity	Current price ($)	2027 average estimated price ($)	Change (%)
Brent (per barrel)	98	79	-19.38
Copper (per tonne)	13,900	13,000	-6.47
Aluminium (per tonne)	3,071	3,100	0.94
Gold (per ounce)	4,014	4,250	5.87
Silver (per ounce)	52	62	19.2

Source: World Bank Commodity Market Outlook

Events this week

Nov 9
- China: CPI & core CPI figures

Nov 10
- US: NFIB Small Business Optimism, CPI & core CPI figures, ADP Weekly Employment change
- China: Imports, Exports & Trade Balance

Nov 11
- US: MBA Mortgage Applications
- Result: Tata Power Co

Nov 12
- India: CPI figures
- US: Initial Jobless Claims, Continuing Claims, Existing Home Sales
- UK: RICS House Price Balance, GDP figures, Imports, Exports & Trade Balance
- Result: Hindustan Aeronautics

EGM: Bank of Baroda

Nov 13
- India: Imports, Exports & Trade Balance#
- Results: Grasim Industries, Tata Motors Passenger Vehicles

Nov 14
- Result: Ashok Leyland

Nov 15
- India: Unemployment Rate

Tentative between Nov 13-16
Results and EGM filtered for BSE100 companies
Sources: Bloomberg, Exchange

'A fresh spark for equities as macro clouds lift'

Q&A With macroeconomic (macro) headwinds beginning to ease and valuations at reasonable levels, this is a compelling opportunity to build equity portfolios, says Mumbai-based **Aniruddha Naha**, chief investment officer (CIO) — alternatives, PGIM India Asset Management. In an email interaction with **Abhishek Kumar**, Naha adds that smallcaps offer the best long-term investment opportunity, followed by largecaps and midcaps. Edited excerpts:

The equity market is showing signs of recovery even as tensions in West Asia persist. Has the market bottomed out, and how do you see Samvat 2083 panning out?

■ In the last Samvat, Indian markets were caught in a vortex of negative global macro events, including conflicts that led to higher crude oil prices, inflation, and widening twin deficits. The prolonged euphoria surrounding the artificial intelligence (AI) trade aggravated the outflow of money from India to other markets, which also put pressure on the currency.

The start of this year has seen many of these macro negatives already being factored in, even as earnings continue to surprise positively across market capitalisations (mcaps). With some unwinding of the AI trade, strong earnings momentum, reasonable valuations, and India being an underweight position in global portfolios, the risk/reward equation in the market has shifted considerably in favour of the upside. We expect this Samvat to surprise investors positively in terms of returns.

What are the key triggers to watch out for that could add to the pressure on Indian equities or change the market's course from here?

■ The price and sustained availability of crude oil, and more specifically diesel, at reasonably stable levels will be critical for Indian markets. These have a direct bearing on inflation and the twin deficits, with implications for interest rates and the currency. Any major flare-up in West Asia could affect not only the crude oil basket but also sulphur and fertilisers. Finally, the developing situation on the El Niño front could affect crop output and rural incomes.

The global slowdown in the AI trade, strong earnings momentum, and reasonable valuations make India a reasonably compelling investment destination. Any waiver or reduction in capital gains tax could also trigger strong inflows from global allocators.

How are you positioning your portfolio amid these macro headwinds? Which sectors offer relative comfort, and which ones are you cautious about?

■ We have always focused on building portfolios with strong operating cash flows, good earnings predictability, and reasonable valuations. In August-September, macro headwinds were quite strong, and valuations were stretched. Accordingly, we had raised cash levels to around 20 per cent and waited patiently. With macro headwinds now easing and valuations improving, there is a compelling opportunity to build strong portfolios. We continue to see strong earnings momentum and remain positive on capital goods, which stand to benefit from the ongoing investment cycle. Given the festival season, low-ticket discretionary consumption is likely to benefit from demand growth. Besides, market-facing businesses should benefit from the financialisation of the Indian economy. Lastly, the correction in healthcare stocks due to regulatory uncertainty has created opportunities in a sector that has a long growth runway in India.

Midcap and smallcap stocks have outperformed largecaps despite the uncertain environment. Is the trend sustainable?

■ Stock performance, while it may be swayed by emotions and liquidity in the short term, is ultimately driven by incremental earnings relative to valuations. The recent outperformance of midcap and smallcap stocks was driven by continued strong earnings, while largecaps lagged because their earnings profile was relatively tepid. Going forward, an improving earnings profile, reasonable valuations, and resilient business models could help largecaps participate meaningfully in the market recovery.

Where do valuations stand currently, and which mcap segment is in the sweet spot in terms of earnings growth potential and valuations?

■ We look at valuations through the price/earnings-to-growth (PEG) framework, which measures the price-to-earnings (P/E) ratio relative to earnings growth. Based on this framework, valuations across the market are far more reasonable compared with their recent history.

This is because sustained earnings have kept P/E multiples reasonable, while resilient earnings growth has helped the denominator in the PEG formula.

We believe that, given the higher cost of capital, stocks are unlikely to see any major P/E rerating. Going forward, stock prices will be driven by earnings.

Given the current market conditions, we continue to prefer smallcaps, which offer the best opportunity from a long-term perspective, followed by largecaps and then midcaps. While midcaps continue to report strong earnings, their valuations appear relatively less attractive than those of smallcaps and largecaps under the PEG framework.

The second-quarter (July-September/Q2) earnings season is underway. What is your assessment of the results announced so far, and has the West Asia conflict started to weigh on corporate performance?

■ The earnings season has continued to be quite strong, with generally positive earnings surprises across mcaps. Some of the effects of the West Asia conflict are reflected in margin compression, but there seems to be no major slowdown in demand. We continue to track demand closely, and the market is currently demonstrating strong demand.



"THE RISK/REWARD EQUATION IN THE MARKET HAS SHIFTED CONSIDERABLY IN FAVOUR OF THE UPSIDE"

Aniruddha Naha,
CIO (Alternatives)
PGIM India Asset Management

Top bulk deals

DATE	SCRIP	CLIENT	PRICE (₹)
Nov 06	Lenskart Solutions	Svf II Lightbulb (Cayman) (S)	697
Nov 06	Groww	Peak Xv Partners Investments (S)	215
Nov 06	Groww	Yc Holdings II Llc (S)	211
Nov 06	Groww	Goldman Sachs Bank Europe Se (B)	215
Nov 06	Lenskart Solutions	Goldman Sachs Investments (B)	697
Nov 06	Lenskart Solutions	Societe Generale Odi (B)	697
Nov 06	Alivus Life Sciences	Nirma (S)	1,370
Nov 06	CarTrade Tech	Macritchie Investments Pte (S)	2,583

(B) Buy (S) Sell Source: Exchanges

What to prioritise: Debt, insurance, or investing?



TRUTH BE TOLD

HARSH ROONGTA

I was talking to Rohini, who had just got her commercial pilot licence and begun her first job with an airline. She wanted my advice on investing the monthly surplus from her salary. She had an education loan at 8 per cent interest, with eight years to run. Her surplus was what remained after the hefty equated monthly instalment (EMI). I told her there was an order to follow. First, pay the fixed EMI on the loan. Second, buy the right insurance. Third, use the balance to repay the loan faster. Investing comes after that. She was shocked. "I thought an investment adviser would tell me where to invest. Instead, you ask me to buy insurance, though you write against it in your columns. And you want me to repay my loan faster."

After her shock wore off, I explained my position. I have always written against the mis-selling of insurance. Yet the right insurance comes before any investment. Rohini said she had no dependants, so she did not need term insurance. But she herself depended on her income. That income needed protection. She needed two covers: a critical illness policy that pays a lump sum on diagnosis of a listed illness and an accidental disability policy that pays if an accident disables her permanently. That money would replace her lost income. The airline already gave sufficient cover for both risks. It also covered her medical costs. I told her to buy her own medical policy. It is unwise to depend solely on an employer's policy.

That brought us to step three: repaying the loan faster. Rohini had two fears. The first was liquidity. Investments could be redeemed in an emergency, but could she access money used to prepay the loan? Her lender allowed her to withdraw any amount she had prepaid. She could also build an emergency fund from the surplus before beginning loan prepayment. The fear of missing out (Fomo) came second. Her friends were making returns from all kinds of ideas. She would be stuck with the boring task of repaying a loan.

My response was simple. I asked her if she would borrow at 8 per cent to invest in any idea, however good. She was horrified at the thought. I told her investing her surplus instead of repaying the loan was the same thing. It is borrowing to invest. Repaying the loan early saves her interest at a rate of eight per cent. Equity could earn more over 8-10 years, but that return is uncertain. Returns can come in bursts after long spells of losses. She may lose patience and quit at the wrong time. A systematic investment plan (SIP) can be stopped. An EMI cannot. In uncertain times, it is best to have as little committed repayment as possible.

Rohini said her father might clear the loan. Where would she then invest her surplus? Her friends were investing in cryptocurrencies, unlisted shares, unregulated start-ups and initial public offerings (IPOs). I told her to avoid such get-rich-quick ideas. She should save 30 per cent of her salary every month. Her living costs and insurance premiums must fit within the rest. She should not wait for the perfect investment. At this stage of her career, the compounding of her savings habit matters more than the compounding of her investments. I suggested a simple passive fund: an index, multi-asset or hybrid fund. If choosing was hard, even a bank recurring deposit would do.

Truth be told, Rohini expected an investment adviser to tell her where to invest. But an adviser must look at her financial life, beginning with whether she should invest at all. My advice was boring and gave her no bragging rights. She understood the reasoning and followed it. She bought the right insurance. She cleared the loan from her own income, though her father could have helped, and then started a monthly SIP in a passive multi-asset fund. Good advice is like a *kandeel* on a dark path. It does not dazzle. It lights the next few steps. I wish every reader the same light and the courage to follow it.

The writer heads Fee-Only Investment Advisors LLP, a Sebi-registered investment adviser; X: @harshroongta

Two years of a flat market: Don't let long-term goals get derailed

Rebalance towards largecaps and invest systematically in a multi-asset portfolio

SANJAY KUMAR SINGH & KARTHIK JEROME

Last week's rally gave Santosh Mishra something he had little reason to feel in two years of sideways markets: Optimism. The Delhi-based lawyer, now in his mid-50s, began investing in equities during the market boom of the covid-19 pandemic and grew accustomed to rising markets. The past two years have tested his patience. Despite last week's sharp rally, which took the Nifty 50 to 25,030, this index remains below its September 26, 2024, close of 26,216. Mishra now faces a question many investors are asking: How should he organise his portfolio so that the wait doesn't become costly?

Will the rally last?

Foreign portfolio investors (FPIs) drove the rally, buying Indian equities worth ₹45,960 crore last week. The rally's durability, according to experts, will depend on whether the new Congress pushes the United States (US) to ease tensions with Iran. De-escalation could trim oil's geopolitical premium. Cheaper oil would curb imported inflation and give the Reserve Bank of India (RBI) more room to act.

Lower US yields and a weaker dollar could lead to capital flowing into emerging markets. "A lasting re-rating, however, needs a visible improvement in earnings growth," says Shreyas Devalkar, head of equity, Axis Mutual Fund.

Largecap outlook improving

Largecaps could outperform over the next six to 12 months. "Largecap valuations have become more reasonable relative to elevated valuations elsewhere in the market, improving their relative risk-reward proposition," says Vaibhav Dusad, senior fund manager, ICICI Prudential Asset Management Company.

Results for the second quarter of financial year 2026–27 (Q2 FY27) point to stronger earnings momentum. "Based on results declared by 80 Nifty 100 companies as of November 4, 2026, median sales growth and earnings per share (EPS) growth were approximately 18.9 per cent and 19.9 per cent, respectively," says Arihant Bardia, founder and chief investment officer (CIO), Valtrust.

"Large companies offer better earnings visibility, stronger balance sheets, and greater resilience in an uncertain global environment," says Dusad. A sustained revival in FPI flows would favour largecaps.

Retain mid-and smallcap exposure

Earnings growth has improved across the market. "Based on results declared by 349 Nifty 500 companies, median sales growth and EPS growth were approximately 19.6 per cent and 20.8 per cent, respectively," says Bardia.

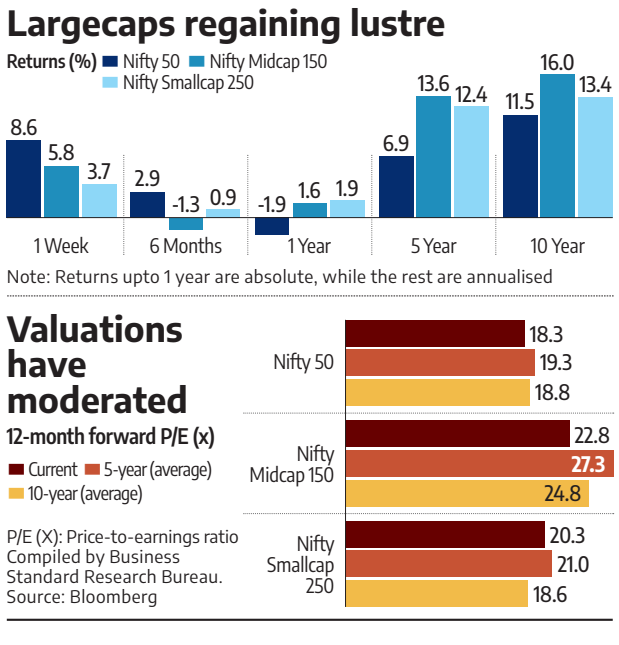
Midcaps and smallcaps are likely to drive much of India's next phase of growth in manufacturing, industrial transformation, technology and new-age businesses. Many of them have greater scope to scale up, innovate and capture new markets.

Many established largecaps allocate relatively little additional capital to research and development (R&D), innovation and emerging technologies. "The next generation of innovation-led opportunities is often found among smaller and mid-sized businesses," says Bardia.

Retain meaningful exposure to midcaps and smallcaps in long-term portfolios, even if largecaps offer better near-term risk-adjusted returns.

Diversify across assets

The past two years have shown the value of diversifying across countries and asset classes.





"Between the September 2024 peak and November 4, 2026, the S&P 500 appreciated by approximately 34 per cent and the Nasdaq Composite gained around 42 per cent, both in US dollar terms," says Bardia.

Taiwan and South Korea benefited from the boom in artificial intelligence (AI) investment. "Exposure to these international markets can give investors access to growth opportunities not adequately represented in Indian equity markets," says Bardia.

Gold helped diversify portfolios amid geopolitical uncertainty, currency volatility and broader economic risks. "Both gold and silver have performed well over the past two to three years," says Vishal Dhawan, founder and chief executive officer, Plan Ahead Wealth Advisors.

Fixed income provided stability and steady accrual income while keeping portfolio risk low.

A measured allocation to international equities alongside Indian equities, fixed income and gold can make portfolios more resilient by reducing dependence on any one country, sector or asset class.

Stay disciplined

Prolonged market stagnation tests investors' patience and can push them to abandon their strategy at the wrong time. They should avoid making abrupt allocation changes or trying to time the market.

A flat market gives investors more time to buy equities at lower prices through systematic investment plans (SIPs). "Keep SIPs running through the downturn to benefit from rupee-cost averaging instead of pausing them until the market stabilises," says Dhawan.

With largecap valuations becoming more reasonable, use fresh investments to rebalance gradually towards them.

Use the downturn to replace poor-quality funds that have underperformed. "Those switches may also allow you to harvest tax losses," says Dhawan.

Let earnings be the guide

Investors who started during the covid-19 pandemic may find their first encounter with a flat market frustrating. "The lesson is to accept such phases as part and parcel of long-term investing rather than try to avoid them through trading or by becoming a momentum trader," says Jatin Khemani, managing partner and CIO, Stalwart Investment Advisors.

Instead of focusing on short-term index moves, try to assess each business's long-term earnings potential.

"Share prices tend to follow earnings over time when business fundamentals and management continue to inspire confidence and valuations offer a margin of safety," says Khemani.

Review holdings where earnings visibility has weakened, valuations remain stretched or the original investment case no longer holds. Such holdings should be reconsidered rather than retained indefinitely in the hope of recovery.

"Check business fundamentals before averaging down so that a falling price does not lead you to keep buying a weak business," says Dhawan.

Exiting can be costly

Markets often bottom out on the worst news and recover before the news improves. Exiting can be riskier than staying invested because it is hard to buy back in as prices rise quickly. "Those who tried to stay out during covid-19 often regretted it when the pace and magnitude of the market's upside took them by surprise," says Khemani.

Finally, never borrow to invest in volatile assets. Keep enough cash for near-term needs so that a bear phase doesn't force you to sell equities at unfavourable prices.

RADHA MADHAV CORPORATION LIMITED
CIN: L74950DD2005PLC003775 |
Reg. Office: Survey No 50/9 Adaman Industrial Estate Village Kadaiya, Nani Daman, Daman And Diu, India, 396210.
Website: www.rmclindia.co.in | **Email ID:** rmcl@rmclindia.co.in

EXTRACT OF UNAUDITED STANDALONE FINANCIAL RESULTS FOR THE QUARTER ENDED SEPTEMBER 30, 2026

Rs (in million)

Sr. No.	Particulars	Quarter ended 30-Sep-26 Unaudited	Half Year ended 30-Sep-26 Unaudited	Quarter ended 30-Sep-25 unaudited
1	Total Income from Operations	3.31	5.9	3.98
2	Net Profit / (Loss) for the period (before Tax, Exceptional and/or Extraordinary items#)	0.41	-7.09	-7.96
3	Net Profit / (Loss) for the period before tax (after Exceptional and/or Extraordinary items#)	0.41	-7.09	-7.96
4	Net Profit / (Loss) for the period after tax (after Exceptional and/or Extraordinary items#)	0.41	-7.09	-7.96
5	Total Comprehensive Income for the period (after tax)	0.41	-7.09	-7.96
6	Equity Share Capital (Face Value of Re. 1/- each)	78.10	78.10	78.10
7	Earnings Per Share (of Re. 1/- each) (for continuing and discontinued operations) -			
	1. Basic :	0.01	-0.91	-0.10
	2. Diluted :	0.01	-0.91	-0.10

Notes:
The above is an extract of the detailed format of Standalone financial results for the quarter ended on September 30, 2026 filed with the Stock Exchanges under Regulation 33 of the SEBI (Listing Obligations and Disclosure Requirements) Regulations, 2015. The full format of the Standalone and Consolidated results for the quarter ended on September 30, 2026 are available on the websites of the Stock Exchanges (www.nseindia.com / www.bseindia.com) and the Company's website (www.www.rmclindia.co.in)

RADHA MADHAV CORPORATION LIMITED
sd/-
Nitin Jain
Whole Time Director and CFO
DIN: 09833381

Date: November 7, 2026
Place: Mumbai

केनरा बैंक Canara Bank | सिंडिकेट Syndicate | **DHULE BRANCH**

POSSESSION NOTICE [SECTION 13(4)]
(For Immovable property)

Whereas:
The undersigned being the Authorised Officer of the Canara Bank, under Securitisation And Reconstruction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002 (Act 54 of 2002) (hereinafter referred to as "the Act") and in exercise of powers conferred under Section 13 (12) read with Rule 3 of the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules 2002, issued a Demand Notice dated **25.08.2026** calling upon the borrower **SHRI GOYAR KAILASH BANSI (Borrower), SHRI VIVEK KAILAS GOYAR (Co-Borrower), SHRI KARAN KAILASH GOYAR (Mortgagor), SHRI AVINASH KAILASH GOYAR (Mortgagor) and SAU. UMA KAILASH GOYAR (Mortgagor)** to repay the amount mentioned in the notice, being **Rs. 1,85,469.93 (Rupees One Lakh Eighty Five Thousand Four Hundred Sixty Nine and Paisa Ninety Three Only)** along with future interest thereon within 60 days from the date of receipt of the said notice.
The borrower having failed to repay the amount, notice is hereby given to the borrower and the public in general that the undersigned has taken actual possession of the property described herein below in exercise of powers conferred on him under section 13 (4) of the said Act, read with Rule 8 of the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules on this **07th Day of November of the year 2026.**
The borrower in particular and the public in general are hereby cautioned not to deal with the property and any dealings with the property will be subject to the charge of Canara Bank, **Dhule Branch** for an amount of **Rs.1,72,763.93 (Rupees One Lakh Seventy Two Thousand Seven Hundred Sixty Three and Paisa Ninety Three Only)** and interest thereon.

The borrower's attention is invited to the provisions of Section 13(8) of the Act, in respect of time available, to redeem the secured assets.

Description of the Immovable Property
All that part and parcel of Residential House Property situated out of Municipal Limit Dhule, Shivar-Balapur Gat No 87/1+87/2A Plot No 84 area 75 Sq. Mtr. **Owned By:** 1. Shri Kailash Bansi Goyar, 2. Shri Vivek Kailash Goyar, 3. Shri Karan Kailash Goyar, 4. Shri Avinash Kailash Goyar & 5. Sau. Uma Kailash Goyar **CERSAI Security Interest ID -** 400054433605 **Bounded: On the North by:** Plot No 83 **On the South by:** Plot No 85 **On the East by:** Plot No 87 **On the West by:** Road

Date : 07.11.2026
Place : Dhule Branch
Seal of Bank
Sd/-
Authorised Officer, Canara Bank

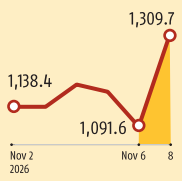
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Business Standard
Insight Out

IN THE NEWS

Finolex Cables



Top gainer amongst A group of companies

₹1,091.6 PREVIOUS CLOSE
₹1,309.7 CLOSE
▲ 20.0% UP

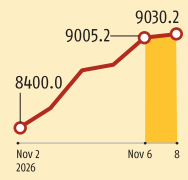
Banco Products India



Trading volume surged 42 times over 2-week average on BSE

₹598.5 PREVIOUS CLOSE
₹687.9 CLOSE
▲ 14.9% UP

Navin Fluorine International L



Hits new all-time high at ₹9,249 on BSE

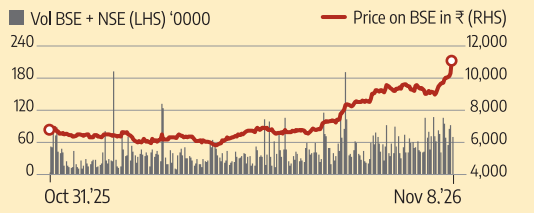
₹9,005.2 PREVIOUS CLOSE
₹9,030.2 CLOSE
▲ 0.3% UP

*OVER PREVIOUS CLOSE

STOCK OF THE DAY

Divi's Laboratories

Hits new all-time high of ₹11,196, rallied 66 per cent in last six months



NIFTY 50

Company	Close (₹) 8 Nov '26	% Chg	Wt (%)	PE Con	PE Std
Adani Enter	2731.0	-0.5	0.9	103.1	95.2
Adani Ports	1949.3	0.7	1.3	32.5	138.1
Apollo Hosp	8430.0	-0.2	0.7	53.5	74.1
Asian Paints	2529.0	-0.7	1.0	49.0	49.7
Axis Bank	1314.7	-0.6	3.2	13.7	14.8
Bajaj Auto	10910.0	0.1	1.1	22.9	25.8
Bajaj Fin	1081.8	-0.6	2.6	30.8	34.6
Bajaj Finsrv	1855.1	-0.5	1.0	27.2	114.7
Bharat Elctn	397.7	0.4	1.2	45.5	45.6
Bharti Airtel	2085.5	-1.0	5.4	38.2	75.5
BSE	3800.0	0.0	0.0	50.3	53.0
Cipla	1405.8	-0.4	0.7	36.6	39.8
Coal India	401.0	0.3	0.8	7.4	12.7
Dr Reddys	1370.0	-0.2	0.7	40.9	117.8
Eicher Motor	7651.0	-0.2	0.9	36.1	39.8
Eternal	364.4	0.3	2.9	714.5	136.0
Grasim Ind	3207.2	-0.6	1.0	37.3	259.1
HCLTech	1442.0	0.1	1.3	20.6	19.7
HDFC Bank	784.1	-0.5	10.1	15.1	15.8
HDFC Std Life	562.0	-0.6	0.5	59.6	60.0
Hindalco	953.0	-0.6	1.2	10.3	16.5
HUL	1997.0	-0.1	1.5	41.9	42.6
ICICI Bank	1565.0	-0.4	9.4	19.0	20.6
Infosys	1171.6	-0.8	3.5	15.0	15.2
InterGlobe Avia	5417.3	-1.1	1.0	-	-
ITC	283.5	0.1	3.0	18.8	19.6
Jio Financial	230.0	-0.5	0.7	92.0	188.5
JSW Steel	1351.1	-0.4	1.5	24.6	26.7
Kotak Mah Bank	480.5	0.1	3.0	22.5	30.2
L & T	4110.0	-0.2	4.7	29.6	36.3
Mah & Mah	3267.8	-0.6	2.8	20.2	24.1
Maruti Suzuki	12815.0	0.5	1.4	30.0	30.6
Max Health	926.0	-0.9	0.6	63.5	122.0
Nestle India	1273.5	-0.7	0.8	61.8	60.9
NTPC	322.7	-0.2	1.3	10.5	12.8
ONGC	234.8	1.3	1.0	5.9	7.0
Power Grid	261.4	0.6	1.0	15.0	15.2
Reliance Ind	1324.0	0.3	7.6	21.8	39.4
SBI	1016.0	-0.2	3.5	11.0	11.8
SBI Life Ins	1764.2	-1.1	0.7	-	66.6
Shriram Finance	960.1	-0.1	1.5	17.8	17.8
Sun Pharma	1915.0	3.0	1.8	37.3	131.6
Tata Consumer P	1080.0	-0.6	0.6	62.1	64.8
Tata Motors PV	295.3	1.1	0.5	119.1	172.7
Tata Steel	190.2	2.1	1.3	20.0	13.2
TCS	2498.8	0.0	2.1	16.5	16.3
Tech Mahindra	1829.9	-0.1	1.0	31.4	40.5
Titan Company	4990.5	-0.2	1.7	62.3	82.6
Trent	3057.5	-0.7	0.9	85.1	76.3
UltraTech	12499.0	0.4	1.3	41.4	46.5
Nifty 50	**24986.4**	**▼-0.2**	**100.0**	**21.7**	**26.1**

BSE SENSEX

Adani Ports	1950.5	0.7	1.5	32.5	138.1
Asian Paints	2535.0	-0.3	1.2	49.1	49.8
Axis Bank	1314.0	-0.5	3.8	13.7	14.8
Bajaj Fin	1084.9	0.0	3.1	30.9	34.7
Bajaj Finsrv	1853.0	-0.4	1.2	27.2	114.5
Bharat Elctn	397.7	0.6	1.4	45.5	45.6
Bharti Airtel	2083.3	-0.6	6.5	38.2	75.5
Eternal	364.9	0.5	3.5	715.4	136.1
HCLTech	1443.0	0.3	1.5	20.6	19.7
HDFC Bank	784.2	-0.4	12.1	15.1	15.8
HUL	2000.5	0.3	1.8	42.0	42.6
ICICI Bank	1566.0	-0.2	11.2	19.0	20.6
Infosys	1172.0	-0.7	4.1	15.0	15.2
InterGlobe Avia	5412.1	-0.9	1.2	-	-
ITC	283.2	0.1	3.5	18.8	19.6
Kotak Mah Bank	480.0	0.0	3.5	22.5	30.2
L & T	4105.0	-0.3	5.6	29.6	36.2
Mah & Mah	3264.7	-0.9	3.3	20.1	24.0
Maruti Suzuki	12837.0	0.8	1.7	30.0	30.7
NTPC	323.3	0.1	1.5	10.5	12.8
Power Grid	261.5	0.8	1.2	15.0	15.3
Reliance Ind	1323.0	0.4	9.0	21.8	39.4
SBI	1016.7	-0.1	4.2	11.0	11.8
Sun Pharma	1915.1	3.0	2.2	37.3	131.6
Tata Steel	189.5	1.9	1.6	20.0	13.2
TCS	2495.1	-0.1	2.5	16.5	16.3
Tech Mahindra	1832.0	0.1	1.2	31.4	40.5
Titan Company	4994.0	0.0	2.1	62.4	82.6
Trent	3050.1	-0.8	1.0	84.9	76.1
UltraTech	12510.0	0.5	1.5	41.5	46.6
BSE SENSEX	**80999.4**	**▼-0.0**	**100.0**	**21.8**	**25.8**

C = Consolidated; S = Standalone

WORLD INDICES

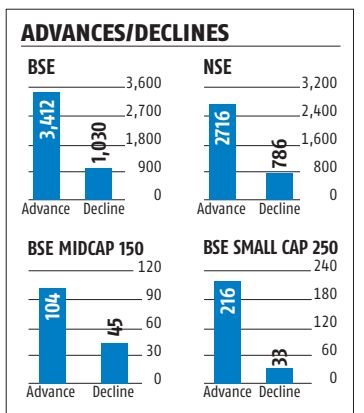
Indices	Close	% Chg*
Americas (Nov 06,26)		
Nasdaq Composite	24579.4	1.1
S&P/ TSX Composite	35789.1	0.5
Dow Jones	51285.7	-0.5
Europe/Africa (Nov 06,26)		
IBEX 35	19369.5	-0.6
CAC 40	8139.0	-0.8
FTSE 100	10673.9	-1.0
DAX	25820.4	-1.9
Asia/Pacific (Nov 06,26)		
Hang Seng	24481.9	-1.3
Nikkei 225	57434.8	-6.0
Asia/Pacific (Nov 06,26)		
Jakarta Composite	5050.4	0.4
Shanghai Se Comp	3649.2	-1.1
Kuala Lumpur Comp	1616.6	-1.2
Stock Exchange of Thai	1465.7	-2.2
Straits Times	5179.2	-2.2
Taiwan Taiex	39701.6	-4.5
Kospi	5059.7	-6.0
Volatility (Nov 06,26)		
CBOE Dow Jones	21.6	-8.1
CBOE S&P 500	25.6	-9.0

*Change over previous close

MAJOR INDICES

	Previous Close	Open	High	Low	Close	Change	% chng
BSE Sensex	81,028.0	81,299.3	81,442.1	80,932.4	80,999.4	-28.6	0.0
BSE Sensex 50	26,270.2	26,370.8	26,405.2	26,254.1	26,257.7	-12.5	0.0
BSE-100	26,436.2	26,561.1	26,591.4	26,438.3	26,447.2	11.0	0.0
BSE-200	11,472.9	11,531.4	11,543.1	11,479.4	11,482.7	9.8	0.1
BSE-500	36,697.8	36,899.7	36,952.4	36,770.2	36,788.1	90.4	0.2
BSE IPO	18,760.8	18,952.5	19,047.9	18,906.9	18,968.7	207.9	1.1
Dollex-30	7,078.1	-	-	-	7,075.6	-2.5	0.0
Nifty 50	25,030.4	25,070.5	25,131.9	24,985.3	24,986.4	-43.9	-0.2
Nifty Next50	71,657.8	72,152.1	72,304.1	71,901.0	71,991.7	333.9	0.5
Nifty 500	23,457.0	23,540.7	23,595.3	23,478.9	23,489.2	32.3	0.1
India VIX	17.5	17.5	18.5	15.8	18.4	1.0	5.5
Nifty CPSE	6,254.3	6,290.9	6,298.5	6,262.1	6,276.5	22.2	0.4

ADVANCES/DECLINES



MARKET OVERVIEW

INDEX AGGREGATES	PE C/S	SHRS MN	TRDS '000	ADV	DEC	1 YR RETURN
SENSEX	21.8/25.8	3.9	120	14	14	-2.7
NIFTY 50	21.7/26.1	68.4	1245	17	32	-2.0

C = CONSOLIDATED; S = STANDALONE

TURNOVER	BSE CASH	NSE CASH	BSE DERIVATIVES	NSE DERIVATIVES
VALUE(IN ₹ CRORE)	2679	23250	4436310	7156835
SHARES(IN MN)	282.6	1165.4	27	5246.4
TRADES('000)	1579	9780	-	19867

MARKET-CAP (₹ CR)	TRADED	TOTAL
BSE	50,476,973	50,868,994
NSE	49,875,218	50,193,086
DERIVATIVES	34,680,306	34,680,306

TRADING ACTIVITY

(₹ crore)	FIIs Equity Net	FIIs Debt Net	MF Equity Net	MF Debt Net
On 05 Nov	16279	479	-	-
On 04 Nov	7830	88	-2222	-4543
On 03 Nov	7053	81	-1945	-5179
On 02 Nov	3352	143	-227	-2011
On 30 Oct	4458	-548	-78	-1338
Nov till date	34514	791	-4394	-11732
2026 till date	-251678	64189	466474	-695442

FIIs IN DERIVATIVES

(₹crore)	Index NET	Stock Net	Index Fut OI	Index Opt OI	Stock OI
On 06 Nov	12877	-832	0.2	4.2	7.5
On 05 Nov	19345	4107	0.2	3.8	7.4
On 04 Nov	-5234	-526	0.3	3.2	7.3
On 03 Nov	1879	3218	0.3	2.6	7.2
On 30 Oct	5055	-382	0.3	3.4	7.0
Nov till date	28867	5967	-	-	-
2026 till date	-867824	-55709	-	-	-

OI in number of contracts(million)

BSE SECTORAL INDICES

	Prev cls	Close	% Chng
Auto	61,118.2	61,218.4	0.2
Bankex	66,470.0	66,297.8	-0.3
Cons. Durables	61,766.3	61,641.9	-0.2
Cap. Goods	70,461.1	70,985.2	0.7
FMCG	17,551.5	17,600.9	0.3
Healthcare	51,664.6	52,502.5	1.6
Infra	562.5	564.0	0.3
IT	31,072.7	31,044.8	-0.1
Metal	40,545.3	40,685.2	0.3
Oil & Gas	26,547.0	26,562.2	0.1
Power	7,108.1	7,138.5	0.4
PSU	20,016.4	20,058.5	0.2
Realty	6,994.8	6,960.7	-0.5

F&O SNAPSHOT

	Futures price	Cash price	Premium (%)
MOST BULLISH			
Shree Cement	25175.0	25000.0	0.7
ABB India	6905.5	6859.5	0.7
Pidilite Ind	1588.4	1578.2	0.6
Petronet LNG	316.4	314.5	0.6
Alkem Labs	5333.5	5304.0	0.6

	BSE Index	BSE Stock	NSE Index	NSE Stock
FUTURE				
Contracts	736	8	38689	219191
Open Int.(000)	3	0	18534	17213598
Shares(In Mn)	0	0	2.4	341.6
Value(₹ crore)	120	0	6392	15511
OPTIONS				
Contracts	5350474	1	43213003	1727567
Open Int.(000)	1505	0	812187	8575417
Shares(In Mn)	3	0	2792.3	2110.1
Value(₹ crore)	4436189	0	7009203	125729

ACTIVE CALLS

(In Million)	Expiry Date	Strike Price	Traded Qty	Open Interest	% Chg (OI)
Index					
Nifty	09/11/26	25100	123.2	8.5	86.2
Nifty	09/11/26	25200	82.3	7.5	28.6
Nifty	09/11/26	25000	81.4	9.7	-12.7
Nifty	09/11/26	25500	78.4	12.4	23.6
Nifty	09/11/26	25050	67.4	3.6	62.0
Stock					
Vodafone Idea	23/11/26	14	57.4	345.7	1.1
Vodafone Idea	23/11/26	13	55.3	312.6	-2.0
YES Bank	23/11/26	18	46.5	101.4	8.0
YES Bank	23/11/26	19	35.9	63.2	0.6
YES Bank	23/11/26	20	34.9	76.5	4.5

ACTIVE PUTS

(In Million)	Expiry Date	Strike Price	Traded Qty	Open Interest	% Chg (OI)
Index					
Nifty	09/11/26	25000	121.3	7.0	42.8
Nifty	09/11/26	24500	76.3	12.2	34.7
Nifty	09/11/26	24800	71.9	6.1	19.6
Nifty	09/11/26	25100	70.9	2.3	123.5
Nifty	09/11/26	25050	67.2	1.4	115.4
Stock					
Vodafone Idea	23/11/26	12	26.3	188.7	3.0
YES Bank	23/11/26	16	23.9	55.6	2.8
YES Bank	23/11/26	15	12.4	55.3	5.1
Vodafone Idea	23/11/26	11	12.1	134.6	1.8
Ashok Leyland	23/11/26	170	11.7	6.4	-8.7

	Futures price	Cash price	Discount (%)
MOST BEARISH			
Data Patterns	3584.1	3704.0	-3.2
Syrma SGS Techn	1477.0	1505.0	-1.9
Power Fin	327.0	330.6	-1.1
Dabur India	378.9	382.8	-1.0
Vishal Mega	93.3	94.0	-0.8

PUT-CALL RATIO

(Open Interest in Mn)	Put	Call	PC Ratio
Market	3856.5	5531.1	0.7

Top 5	PC Ratio	Bottom 5	PC Ratio
Shree Cement	2.5	City Union Bk	0.1
Nippon Life Ind	1.6	Inox Wind	0.2
Tata Consumer P	1.6	NBCC	0.3
Coromndl Int	1.6	Syrma SGS Techn	0.3
Anand Rathi Wea	1.6	Premier Energie	0.3

SPURT IN VOLUMES

Company	Days Volume	2-week Avg Volume	Change %	Close price	*Price %chg
Banco Prod	4630477.0	80526.4	5650.3	687.9	14.9
Miraeamc - Equa	135793.0	7107.3	1810.6	337.0	-0.1
Mobilise App	208000.0	12400.0	1577.4	121.0	5.0
Safe Enter Reta	390000.0	27750.0	1305.4	219.3	-4.0
Groww-SmallCap	101816.0	8064.8	1162.5	49.2	3.9
Transworld Ship	193614.0	15680.6	1134.7	200.1	19.0
Yasons Chemex	108000.0	10285.7	950.0	10.2	20.0
GACM Technologi	9023060.0	908100.0	893.6	0.6	9.6
Finolex Cab	5726179.0	579994.3	887.3	1309.7	20.0
Airo Lam	162813.0	22442.3	625.5	114.7	6.7

52-WEEK NEW HIGHS/LOWS

Company	Price
HIGH	
BS 200	
*Divis Lab	11196.0
*TVS Motor	4524.0
*MCX	3603.8
*Adani Ports	1961.9
*Ather Energy	1859.9
*Aurob Pharma	1815.0
*ICICI Bank	1577.6
*Motilal Oswl	1181.7
*Marico	904.0
*Indian Hotel	899.0
*Kotak Mah Bank	482.3
Eternal	367.0
Piramal Pharma	247.7
Others	
*Navin Fluo	9249.2
TCPL Pack	4719.0
*Spectrum	4620.9
*Emcure Pharma	2392.0
*Lumax Tech	2385.0
*Entero Healthca	2075.2
*Alivus Lf	1573.0
*Aayush Art And	1365.0
*Shyam Metalics	1353.0
*Galaxy Bearings	1285.0
*Sancode Techn	1255.6

Company	Price
*Liquidadd	1153.3
Permanent Mg	1143.2
*Liquidplus	1111.7
*HDFC Liquid	1090.4
Alembic Pharma	1038.4
*NINtec Sys	1001.0
*Mirae -ET	1000.0
Acrow India	922.0
*Shreeji Ship	904.2
Shri Jagdamb	850.0
Vijay Solvex	805.0
Gretex Corpor	801.0
*Infinity	765.0
Westlife Food	673.0
*Photon Capital	611.1
*Steel Str Wh	574.3
*Purplewave	573.9
*Goel Constru	560.0
*Modis Navnirma	450.9
IGIL	430.0
Halder Venture	325.0
*MKP Mobility	293.9
*SWIL	288.7
*Vegorama Punjab	284.0
*Resonance Sp	250.0
*Amir Chand	247.5
*Shining Tools	234.6

Company	Price
Rolex Rings	214.5
*Rama Vision	214.0
*Shayona Enginee	207.0
*AXAMC HC ETF	182.0
Oriental Htl	179.4
*Healthietf	177.0
*Tourism Fin	168.8
Manaksia Coat M	167.0
*Arman Ho	150.3
Ganesh Holdings	148.5
*Atharva Po	145.4
*B D Inds	144.0
*Seemax Resource	125.5
*Zero-Liquid	120.3
*Mapro Inds	109.3
*Shoora Designs	106.8
*POwergrid Invit	106.3
*Midaas Fashions	106.1
*Source Inds	104.5
Milkfood	103.0
*Aurique	98.8
Naps global	92.5
Algoquant Fin	84.9
*09Mpd	81.4
*Roopshri Resort	81.0
Capital Infra T	80.5
*Rajvi LT	79.0

Company	Price
LOW	
BS 200	
NONE	
Others	
*Deccan Cem	460.1
*W H Brady	448.9
*Panason Carb	365.2
*VIP Ind	238.1
*Shriram Asst	235.0
*TCONS E-Solutio	207.5
HIRA auto	193.0
*Meenakshi India	140.2
*Veritas	129.8
*Gem Aromatics	125.0
Canara HSBC	114.7
*Espire Hospital	113.5
*Spel Semi	87.5
*Solitair Mac	72.0
*Ace Engitech	65.5
*Justo Realfin	65.0
*Kings Infra	57.0
*Mehul Colours	44.0
Ladderup Finan	42.9
*Sonalis	27.0
*Retina Paints	25.0
Shuubham Poly	23.5
*RCCL	22.5

*Indicates that the market price of these companies reached two-year highs/lows.

DAY'S TOP GAINERS

Company	Day's high	Close	% chg*	3mth high	52 wk high
Divis Lab	11196.0	11080.3	7.5	11196.0	11196.0
Syngene Intl	437.0	434.8	4.2	437.0	678.0
Motilal Oswl	1181.7	1144.9	4.0	1181.7	1181.7
Ashok Leyland	178.3	177.8	3.4	182.7	215.4
HFCL	220.0	216.9	3.3	282.1	282.1
Titagarh	701.9	699.4	3.1	904.6	970.1
Syrma SGS Techn	1512.8	1505.0	3.1	1823.0	1823.0
Sun Pharma	1930.0	1915.1	3.0	1965.0	2047.6
Piramal Pharma	247.7	246.1	2.9	247.7	247.7
Siemens	3680.0	3655.5	2.8	4149.4	4149.4
Exide Ind	367.0	366.4	2.5	496.0	496.0
Ujjivan Small B	60.9	60.5	2.2	73.9	73.9
HUDCO	164.7	163.5	2.2	202.4	246.9
Cyient	1135.9	1131.3	2.1	1268.0	1268.0
Supreme Ind	3231.9	3220.0	2.0	3711.1	4070.0

DAY'S TOP LOSERS

Company	Day's low	Close	% chg*	3mth low	52 wk low
Voltas	1054.0	1059.6	-3.3	930.3	930.3
Data Patterns	3590.0	3700.1	-1.8	3590.0	2131.0
Jubilant Fd	451.0	451.3	-1.7	397.7	397.7
Bank of Maha	85.7	85.7	-1.5	72.8	55.5
Macrotech Devlp	1168.0	1170.1	-1.5	935.9	650.9
Godrej Prpty	1781.6	1782.3	-1.5	1468.0	1434.0
L&T Finan	273.0	273.0	-1.4	229.3	229.3
Prestige Est	1600.0	1605.0	-1.4	1365.6	1090.5
360 ONE WAM	1127.1	1127.1	-1.4	965.8	906.2
LTM	4281.9	4281.9	-1.3	3904.4	3529.6
NHPC	80.8	81.0	-1.3	68.8	68.7
SBI Life Ins	1762.4	1769.9	-1.1	1609.2	1609.2
Blue Star	1552.7	1563.1	-1.1	1432.0	1432.0
Manapp Finance	320.6	322.1	-1.0	271.0	245.1
Premier Energie	885.0	885.0	-1.0	823.8	660.8

*Ranked on the basis of percentage gain/loss on previous close

MOST TRADED

	Value BSE+NSE (₹ crore)	Volume BSE+NSE (Mn shrs)
Divis Lab	753.9	0.7
Finolex Cab	722.2	5.7
HDFC Bank	621.1	7.9
Reliance Ind	578.1	4.4
NSE	364.0	1.9
BSE	347.9	0.9
ICICI Bank	334.9	2.1
Tata Steel	327.0	17.2
Banco Prod	313.4	4.6
R R Kabel	311.2	1.5
Jio Platforms	310.8	2.2
Tonbo Imaging	310.6	2.1
MCX	285.6	0.8
Ashok Leyland	234.6	13.3
Motilal Oswl	234.0	2.0
SBI	219.9	2.2
TD Power	218.1	3.6
Symbiotec Pharm	212.2	1.3
Sun Pharma	198.2	1.0
Kalyan Jeweller	196.1	3.3
NIFTYBEES	188.6	6.6
Billionbrains	158.7	7.3
PC Jeweller	157.3	98.7
Mah & Mah	157.3	0.5
Netweb Technolo	154.4	0.4

TOP M-CAP

Rank	Company	Mcap (₹ cr)
1	Reliance Ind	1790355.0
2↑	Jio Platforms	1308925.5
3↓	Bharti Airtel	1300285.5
4	HDFC Bank	1210208.8
5	ICICI Bank	1124575.9
6	SBI	938495.4
7	TCS	902752.1
8	Bajaj Fin	675458.7
9	L & T	564807.0
10	LIC India	502205.0
11↑	NSE	477798.8
12	Kotak Mah Bank	477499.2
13↓	Infosys	475632.8
14	HUL	470037.5
15	Sun Pharma	459489.9
16	Adani Ports	449385.4
17	Titan Company	443367.3
18	Axis Bank	409212.5
19	Mah & Mah	405972.0
20	Maruti Suzuki	403595.3
21	Adani Power	393793.6
22	HCLTech	391579.7
23	Adani Enter	369491.7
24	UltraTech	368644.7
25	ITC	354903.4
26	Eternal	352094.8
27	HAL	333253.1
28	JSW Steel	331120.7
29	NTPC	313444.9
30	Bajaj Auto	299944.2

TRENDS

Company	% change
BS200	
UP 7 DAYS	
Divis Lab	14.8
Force Motors	12.6
Titan Company	12.4
Aurob Pharma	9.1
Avenue Supermar	7.7
Cipla	4.0
UP 3 DAYS	
Ashok Leyland	15.5
Motilal Oswl	13.1
Kalyan Jeweller	11.8
IIFL Finance	8.8
Karur Vysya	8.3
Sun Pharma	7.8
Swiggy	7.4
DOWN	
Data Patterns	-9.4
Polycab India	-0.9
GAIL	-0.8
Others	
UP 7 DAYS	
Rajvi LT	40.7
Purplewave	40.7
Anand Rayons	40.0
SC Agrotech	37.3
Seemax Resource	36.7

Company	% change
Apollo Finv	35.5
Lexora Global	31.8
DOWN 7 DAYS	
SAR Auto Pr	-30.2
Filtron Eng.	-30.2
Shukr Bullions	-30.1
Mayur Leather	-25.1
Adv Petroch	-13.2
Sabrimala Inds	-13.1
JTL Defence	-11.4
UP 3 DAYS	
Himalaya Nutra	46.9
Mahalaxmi Fabri	40.8
Aerpace	33.2
Jungle Camps	31.8
09Mpd	29.9
Symbiotec Pharm	29.7
M M Forgings	27.7
DOWN 3 DAYS	
Pashupati Cotsp	-27.1
RCCL	-18.2
Valson Inds	-14.3
Steilant Sec	-14.3
Bhagya Inter	-14.3
Ennature Bio Ph	-14.2
Ajwa Projects	-14.2

BOARD MEETINGS

Quarterly Results

NOVEMBER 09

Group A
Olectra
Greente
Whirlpool

Group B
HB Portfolio
Medico
Remedies
NICCO Parks
Park Medi
World
R M Drip &
Spri

Group MT
Gulf Lloyds

Group X
HB Leasing
Krypton Ind
Manraj Hsg.F
Sarvottam
Thrive Future
Ventura Textile

NOVEMBER 10

BS 200
Kalyan Jeweller
Titagarh

Group A
Avanti Feeds
MRF

Group B
Alfred Herbt
Balmer L Inv
Hirect
Matrimony.com
MMTC
Nile
Quadrant Future
Rossell India
Simplex Infr
Suraksha
Vardhmn Hold

Group M
Century BM
Raksan Transfor
Toss The Coin

Group MT
Spinaroo
Commer

Group T
ARSS Infra
Midwest Limited
Pilani Investme

Group X
Chambal Brew
Covance
Deccan Poly
DHP India
Ditco
Dynavision
Madala Holdings
National Gen
Oxygentaph
Riba Text
Skybiotech
Tai Ind
Veejay Laksh
Vision Cinemas

Group XT
Golden Carpet
Jaus Polymer
Sabrimala Inds

NOVEMBER 11

BS 200
Tata Power

Group A
Cupid Ltd
Garden Reach Sh
Hind Copper
Mishra Dhatu Ni
Power Mech Pro
Triveni Turbine

Group B
Abans Fi
AVT Natl
Baj Hind Sug
Bannr Am Spg
Bannr Am Sug
Bengal Assm
DCX Systems
EAAA India
EIH Asso Ht
Empire Ind
Frontier Spr
Gcm Secu
Glottis Ltd
Haleos Labs
Intense Tech
KJMC Fina
Kovai Medicl
Lalithaa Jewel
LEHIL
National Fer
Network People
Orchasp Ltd
Orient Green
Ortin Global
Pioneer Embr
Polyspin Exp
Popular Ve-hicle
Roto Pumps
Sakthi Sugar
Salona Cots
Securekloud Tec
SEPC
Shankar Lal Ram
Sical Logistics
Talbros Auto
Tera Software
TGV SRAAC
Vivo Bio Tec

Group M
EMM force
Injecto
Polymer
LGT Busines
Millworks
Mish Designs
Paradeep Pa-riva
PECOS Hot & Pub
Popular FL
Shamfoam
Times Green Ene

Group P
Shyamacomp

Group T
Anmol India
Bafna Pharma
Burnpur Cem
ICDS

Group X
Ajcon Glob
Asia Pack
Bambino Agro
BNR Udy

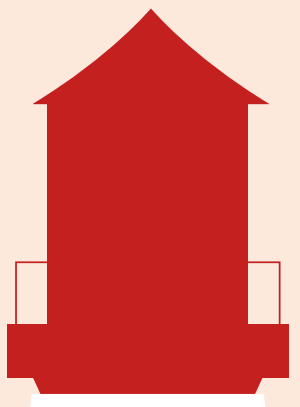


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RISHI LASER LIMITED

CIN : L99999MH1992PLC066412
612, V. K. Industrial Estate, 10-14 Pais Street, Byculla (W), Mumbai 400 011.
Tel. No. (022) 23075677 / 23074585, Fax No. (022) 23080022
Email : rlcl.mumbai@rishilaser.com; investors@rishilaser.com, Website : www.rishilaser.com

STATEMENT OF UNAUDITED FINANCIAL RESULTS FOR THE QUARTER AND SIX MONTHS ENDED 30TH SEPTEMBER 2026

(₹ In Lakhs)

Particulars	Standalone					
	Quarter Ended			Six Months Ended		Year Ended
	30.09.2026	30.06.2026	30.09.2025	30.09.2026	30.09.2025	31.03.2026
	Unaudited	Unaudited	Unaudited	Unaudited	Unaudited	Audited
Revenue from Operations	5,438 .29	4244.14	4,293.85	9,682.43	8,436.74	16235.44
Profit / (Loss) before Tax	147.95	61.33	273.03	209.28	537.53	548.65
Profit / (Loss) after Exceptional Items but before Tax	147.95	61.33	273.03	209.28	537.53	493.14
Profit / (loss) for the period	114.36	49.54	211.26	163.90	388.18	367.25
Total Comprehensive Income for the period	118.28	69.43	184.95	187.71	385.52	329.34
Paid up equity share capital (Face Value of ₹ 10/- each)	999.26	999.26	919.26	999.26	919.26	919.26
Other Equity excluding Revaluation Reserve				3,943.43		2935.73
Earnings per equity share (Face Value ₹ 10/- each)						
Basic (In ₹)	1.15	0.51	2.30	1.66	4.22	4.60
Diluted (In ₹)	1.15	0.51	2.30	1.66	4.22	4.60

Notes:

1. The above is an extract of the detailed format of the Unaudited Financial Results filed with the Stock Exchange under Regulation 33 of the Securities Exchange Board of India (Listing Obligations & Disclosure Requirements) Regulations, 2015. The Unaudited Financial Results & this extract were reviewed by the Audit Committee and approved by the Board of Directors of the Company in its meeting held on 7th November, 2026. The full Format of the Unaudited Financial Results is available on the stock exchange websites, **www.bseindia.com** and on the Company's website **www.rishilaser.com.**

Place : Mumbai
Date : 7th November 2026

For **RISHI LASER LIMITED**
sd/-
Harshad Patel
Managing Director
DIN : 00164228

Rameshwar Media

SOUTH EAST CENTRAL RAILWAY

TENDER NOTICE FOR SUPPLY OF STORES ITEMS

E-TENDER NOTICE No.: NIT/14/26/48, Dated 03.11.2026.

Sr. No.	Tender No.	Description	Tender Closing/ Opening Date	Qty.
1.	06260121	MANUFACTURING & SUPPLY OF NCR GRSP OF 1 IN 8.5 THICK WEB SWITCH 60E1 RAIL TURNOUT FOR 25T AXLE LOAD	25.11.2026	2228 Set
2.	05261117A	Low maintenance Lead Acid secondary cell, each cell 2V 80 AH capacity of 10 hrs. rating at 27deg. C.	19.11.2026	3660 Nos
3.	02261865A	Set of Dampers for WAG-9 Locos (4 items)	25.11.2026	65 Set
4.	03262440A	Kit (Poly rings-03 nos., Stooper springs-02 nos. & PU lining Top & Bottom, Design A for Constant Contact Polyurethane Side Bearer for rolling stocks	23.11.2026	24955 Set
5.	03263381	"Flap Door Arrangement BOXN"	25.11.2026	4610 Nos
6.	02261851A	Driver seat assly. for WAG-9 Loco	30.11.2026	288 Nos
7.	02264159A	DRIVER DISPLAY UNIT (DDU) TCN VCU SUITAB	26.11.2026	16 Set
8.	03261509	Bottom Cover with Quick Release Valve	25.11.2026	1382 Set
9.	02264424	POWER SUPPLY MODULE ASSEMBLY	02.12.2026	19 Nos

Tender Closing/Opening Time: At 10.30 hours

Railways reserves the right to issue any Corrigendum to the tenders. Corrigendum & Important Notice to vendors may be seen in the link **www.ireps.gov.in**

CPR/10/PHI/481 ***For Principal Chief Materials Manager/Bilaspur.***

South East Central Railway @secrail

Jammu and Kashmir Bank

Jammu and Kashmir Bank
Estates & General Department,
Zonal Office Mumbai, Srinagar,
Bandra Kurla Complex, (BKC) Pin-400098

On Line Open Tender (e-Tender) FOR HIRING OF BIG BUS FOR J&K Bank Zonal Office Mumbai

Tender Notice along with Complete Tender document outlining the minimum requirements can be downloaded from and BIDs can be submitted on the Banks' e-Tendering Portal https://jkbank.abcprocure.com w.e.f. November 07, 2026, 16.00 Hrs. Tender Document can also be downloaded from Bank's Official Website https://jkb.bank.in. Last date for submission of Bids is November 30, 2026, 17.00 Hrs.

e-NIT Ref.No. JKB/E&GD/Hiring Bus-ZOM/2026- 1935
Dated: -06-11-2026

Registered office : Corporate Headquarters, M.A.Road, Srinagar 190001, Kashmir, India
CIN: L65110JK1938SGC000048 ; **T :** +91 (0)194 2481 930-35 ; **F :** +91 (0)194 248 1928;
DIPK-NB-2070/26 Dated: 07-11-2026 **E : info@jkbmail.com ; W :** https://Jkb.bank.in

PUBLIC NOTICE

Smt Anjali Ulhas Vaidya a member of the Pushkar Niketan Co-operative Housing Society Ltd. having address at D. N. Nagar, Andheri West, Mumbai 400053 and holding **Flat No.A- 303** in the building of the society, died on **06/07/2026** without making any nomination.

The society hereby invites claims and objections from heir or other claimants/ objector or objectors to the transfer of the said shares and interest of the deceased member in the capital/ property of the society within a period of 15 days from the publication of this notice, with copies of such documents and other proofs in support of his/her/their claims/ objections for transfer of shares and interest of the deceased member in the capital / property of the society. If no claims / objections are received within the period prescribed above, the society shall be free to deal with the shares & interest of the deceased member in the capital / property of the society in such manner as is provided under the bye-laws of the society. The claims /objections, if any, received by the society for transfer of shares and interest of the deceased member in the capital/ property of the society shall be dealt with in the manner provided under the bye-laws of the society. A copy of the registered bye-laws of the society is available for inspection by the claimants / objectors, in the office of the society/ with the secretary of the society between 11.00 P.M.. to 04 P.M. from the date of publication of the notice till the date of expiry of its period.

For and on behalf of
Pushkar Niketan Co-operative Housing Society Ltd
Sd/-
Hon. Secretary.
Place : Mumbai.
Date: 08/11/2026

PUBLIC NOTICE

My clients are negotiating with **Mrs. Gnanam Shankara Narayanan** for purchase of Flat No. 501, 680 sq.ft. carpet, 5th Floor, 'B' Wing, Kalina Meenakshi CHS Ltd., Sunder Nagar, Road No.2, Kalina, Vidya Nagari, Mumbai - 400 098, CTS Nos. 4851/A & 4851/B (Part), Village Kolekalyan, Taluka Andheri. Any person having claim/objection by inheritance, sale, gift, lease, mortgage, lien or otherwise in the said flat should notify with proof to undersigned within 14 days of publication, failing which claim shall be deemed waived and transaction completed without reference.

Dated: 9th Nov, 2026

Sd/-
Jacinta D'Silva, Advocate,
402 'B' Wing, Ashoka Complex,
Ranade Road, Dadar (W),
Mumbai - 400 028.

PUBLIC NOTICE

This is to inform the general public by way of this Public Notice that our client is desirous of purchasing the immovable property described in the Schedule hereinbelow from the landowners, namely **Mr. Asif Habib Sayyed and five others**.""The description of the said property is as follows:

DESCRIPTION OF THE PROPERTY
Village: Chipale, Taluka Panvel, District Raigad.

Survey/ Gut No.	Hissa No	Area H.R.P.	Assessment
30	B	0-19-00 Po. Kh. 0-01-00 0-20-00	0-40

All persons having or claiming any right, title, interest or claim in respect of the aforesaid property or any part thereof, by way of sale, gift, donation, lease, tenancy, possession, maintenance, mortgage, occupancy rights or otherwise, are hereby called upon to submit their written objections, if any, along with relevant documentary evidence and supporting proof, to the undersigned within 14 (Fourteen) days from the date of publication of this Public Notice. In the event that no written objections or claims are received within the aforesaid period, it shall be presumed that the said property is free from all encumbrances and that no person has any right, title, interest or claim therein. Accordingly, our client shall proceed to complete the transaction in respect of the said property. Any objections, complaints or claims raised thereafter shall not be binding upon our client, and it shall be presumed that all such rights, claims and interests, if any, have been waived and relinquished. The transaction shall accordingly be completed. All concerned persons are hereby requested to take due note of the same.

Place : Panvel
Date : 08/11/2026

Sd/-
Adv. Shailesh Manohar Panchal
Address: Office No. 35, Satya Sai Plaza, Plot No. 5, Sector 11, New Panvel (East) - 410206. Mobile: 8291322338

MAHARASHTRA GRAMIN BANK

(A Scheduled Bank established by Government of India) Sponsor Bank : Bank of Maharashtra
Head Office : Plot No. 42, Gut No. 33 (Part), Golwadi Village, Growth Center, Waluj Mahanagar IV, CIDCO, Aurangabad 431 010

Tender Notice RFP. No. 02/2026-27

Maharashtra Gramin Bank, a Regional Rural Bank Owned by Government Invites tenders from 06st Nov. 2026 for Supply, Installation, Commissioning and Maintenance of Enterprise Fraud Risk Management Solution (EFRMS), EWS, Money Mule Accounts Detection with Hardware, The Last Date for submission of tenders is 26th Nov. 2026. for further details, visit our website: www.mahagramin.bank.in, Tender Section.

Date: 08/11/2026 | Place: Chh. Sambhajinagar

General Manager (IT)
Maharashtra Gramin Bank

बैंक ऑफ़ बड़ौदा Bank of Baroda

India's International Bank | 119 FOUNDATION YEAR LEADING WITH TRUST

FOR KIND ATTENTION OF OUR MOST VALUED CUSTOMERS

In our endeavor to consolidate and strengthen our services to our customers, we propose shifting our existing R C Marg Branch as per details given below:

Details of existing branch premises	Details of Alternate premises
Bank of Baroda, R C Marg, Branch Rudraksh Building 7th Cross Road Sanduwadi Chembur - 71	Unit No:4 Arham Mourya, Plot no 190/191, R C Marg, Chembur Mumbai-71

The branch is likely to be shifted to the above-mentioned alternate premises w.e.f 11.01.2027 and it shall function and cater for all types of banking business from the premises.

We also wish to inform all the locker holder customers of our existing R C Marg Branch that utmost care will be taken while shifting the lockers to the proposed premises. However, if any customer with locker facility desires to take possession of the contents before shifting and redeploy the same after shifting the lockers to the proposed location, we request you to do so before 09.01.2027 by contacting the Branch Head concerned.

We sincerely regret the inconvenience caused to you in this regard and always assure you of our best services.

Place: Mumbai
Date: 05.11.2026

Regional Head
Bank of Baroda
Mumbai Metro Central Region

SBI भारतीय स्टेट बैंक State Bank of India

Home Loan Centre, Panvel
Shop No. 5, Sharda Terrace, Sector-11, CBD Belapur, Navi Mumbai-400614.

DEMAND NOTICE

A notice is hereby given that the following borrower/s **Mr. Shyam Nanaji Todkar Office Add :** Konkan Railway Corporation Ltd, 2nd Floor, Belapur Bhavan, Plot No.6, Sector-11, CBD Belapur, Navi Mumbai, Pin - 400614. **Mrs. Leena Murari Kumbhare**, **Office Add :** Vitthal Sayanna General Hospital, Thane (W), Maharashtra. **HL A/c No. : 44421210650 & HL Top-Up No. : 44482057879** have defaulted in the repayment of principal and interest of the loans facility obtained by them from the Bank and the loans have been classified as Non Performing Assets (NPA) **on 26/10/2026**. The notices were issued to them on **30/10/2026** under section 13(2) of Securitization and Reconstruction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest Act 2002 on their last known addresses, but have been returned unserved, they are hereby informed by way of this public notice.

Amount Outstanding: **Rs. 91,79,349.86 (Rupees Ninety One Lakh Seventy Nine Thousand Three Hundred Forty Nine and Eighty Six Paise Only) as on 26/10/2026** with further interest and incidental expenses, costs, etc.

The above Borrower(s) and/or their Guarantor(s) (whenever applicable) are hereby called upon to make payment of outstanding amount within 60 days from the date of publication of this notice, failing which further steps will be taken after expiry of 60 days from the date of this notice under sub-section (4) of section 13 of Securitization and Reconstruction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002.

The borrowers attention is invited to provision of sub-section (8) of section 13 of the Act, in respect of time available to redeem the secured assets.

Description of Immovable properties

Flat No. A-803, A-Wing, Bhoomi Heights, Sec-31, Plot No. 1 & 10, Nr K K Cinema, Kamothe, Mansarovar, Panvel, Raigad, Navi Mumbai, Pin - 410209.

Date: 07/11/2026 Place: Navi Mumbai Authorised Officer, State Bank of India

DhanlaxmiBank

Branch: Ground Floor, Road No. 29, Thirumalai House, Near Sion Hill Fort, Sion East Mumbai - 400022. Ph 022-24020095/24020029
Regional Office: Sion **Corporate Office: Thrissur**

AUCTION SALE NOTICE

Notice is hereby given to the public in general and in particular to the Borrower(s) mentioned below that the gold items/security pledged by the Borrower(s) in the gold loan accounts as detailed below is proposed to be auctioned by Dhanlaxmi Bank Limited (Bank) through public auction conducted at the places mentioned below. The below mentioned borrowers have been issued notices to pay their entire outstanding amounts towards gold loan accounts mentioned below availed by them from Dhanlaxmi Bank Ltd as per guidelines and also informed them that in case of their failure to pay the dues as demanded, the Bank will be at liberty to auction the entire gold items/security pledged without issuing further notice. The borrowers have neglected and failed to repay the entire outstanding dues in their below mentioned gold loan accounts, and therefore, the Bank is constrained to conduct public auction of the gold items/security pledged to recover the dues owed by the Borrowers to the Bank.

The public auction will be conducted through physical mode at the below mentioned Branch premises on **-25/11/2026 -between 2:00pm to 4:00 pm**. The sale of the gold items/security pledged items shall be on "As-is-where-is', 'As-is-what-is', "whatever there is" and "without recourse" basis .and without any guarantee of the Bank, explicit or implied, on the quality, purity, caratage, weight, or valuation or any matter connected therewith the said gold items. It shall be the sole and absolute responsibility of the intending bidders to verify, examine and satisfy themselves about the quality, purity, caratage, weight, or valuation or any matter connected therewith the said gold items prior placing their bids and for the said purpose, it shall be open to the said intending bidders to examine, at their sole cost and expense, and at the address set out herein below, the gold items/security pledged whether with or without expert advice thirty minutes to one hour prior to the time fixed for the conduct of the auction.

SL No.	Loan Account Number	Name of Borrower/s	Branch Name	Amt. Due as on 08.10.2026	Place of Auction (Branch Address)
1	016956200034912	Rajeshwari Narayanmoorthy Devendar	Sion	Rs. 26,64,176.00	Dhanlaxmi Bank Ltd - Sion

All bids shall be subject to such minimum reserve price as the Bank may deem fit to fix in this regard. The Reserve price shall be based on the closing price of the Gold as per IBJA (Indian Bullion Jewellers Association) on the previous day. The auction process and the sale, if any pursuant to such auction shall be subject to such further terms and conditions as the bank may at its sole and absolute discretion, deem fit to impose. If the auction does not get completed on the same day due to time limit or for any other reasons, the Bank reserves the right to conduct the auction within 7 working days from the date of Auction or on any other date at the discretion of the Bank on the same terms and conditions by publishing the date and time of such action in the notice board of the respective Branch. If the borrower is deceased, all the terms of the auction shall be applicable to his legal heirs also.

If the borrower(s) pays their dues to the Bank in respect of their individual loan account(s) in full before the auction, the gold items/security pledged in the said respective loan may be withdrawn by the Bank from the said auction without any further notice. The Bank reserves the right to remove any of the above-mentioned accounts from the auction and also to postpone or change the auction date and time without any prior intimation/notice and without assigning any reason and to reject any or all the bids or offers without assigning any reasons for the same.

For the detailed terms and conditions of the auction, please refer to the link provided in Dhanlaxmi Bank's website i.e., www.dhan.bank.in or contact the concerned branch/ place of auction.

Authorised Signatory
For Dhanlaxmi Bank Ltd

FORM NO. INC-26
[Pursuant to Rule 30 of the Companies (Incorporation) Rules, 2014]
ADVERTISEMENT FOR CHANGE OF REGISTERED OFFICE OF THE APPLICANT COMPANY
FROM ONE STATE TO ANOTHER
BEFORE THE CENTRAL GOVERNMENT, REGIONAL DIRECTOR, WESTERN REGION,
IN THE MATTER OF SUB-SECTION (4) OF SECTION 13 OF COMPANIES ACT, 2013 AND CLAUSE (a) OF SUB-RULE (5) OF RULE 30 OF THE COMPANIES (INCORPORATION) RULES, 2014
AND
IN THE MATTER OF PEPE JEANS INDIA LIMITED

Pepe Jeans India Limited **.....APPLICANT**
Regd. Off.: 7th Floor, E-Wing, Times Square Building, Marol Gamdevi, Andheri Kurla Road, Andheri East, Marol Naka Mumbai, Maharashtra, India, 400059

Notice is hereby given to the general public that the Applicant Company proposes to make an application to the Central Government under Section 13 of the Companies Act, 2013 seeking confirmation of alteration of the situation clause II of the Memorandum of Association of the Applicant Company in terms of the Special Resolution passed at the Annual General Meeting of the members of the Company held on 28 September 2026 to enable the Applicant Company to change its Registered Office from Mumbai, state of Maharashtra to Bengaluru, state of Karnataka".

Any person whose interest is likely to be affected by the proposed change of the registered office of the Applicant Company may deliver either on the MCA-21 portal (www.mca.gov.in) by filing investor complaint form or cause to be delivered or send by registered post his/her objections supported by an affidavit stating the nature of his/her interest and grounds of opposition to the Regional Director, Western Region at Everest 5th Floor, 100 Marine Drive, Mumbai, 400002, Maharashtra within 14 (Fourteen) days of the date of publication of this notice with a copy to the Applicant Company at the registered office of the Applicant Company at its registered office at the address mentioned above.

For and on behalf of Pepe Jeans India Limited
SD/-
Vispi Rusi Patel
Director
DIN: 00211464

Date: 03.11.2026
Place: Mumbai

BEFORE THE NATIONAL COMPANY LAW TRIBUNAL AT MUMBAI
COMPANY PETITION NO CP / 296 (MB) / 2026

IN THE MATTER OF

SECTION 66 READ WITH SECTION 52 OF THE COMPANIES ACT, 2013 AND OTHER APPLICABLE PROVISIONS OF THE COMPANIES ACT, 2013 AND THE NATIONAL COMPANY LAW TRIBUNAL (PROCEDURE FOR REDUCTION OF SHARE CAPITAL OF COMPANY) RULES, 2016;

AND

IN THE MATTER OF

PETITION FOR REDUCTION OF SHARE CAPITAL OF INCO JADE PRIVATE LIMITED;

INCO JADE PRIVATE LIMITED)
CIN: U45200MH2019PTC476213)
A private limited company incorporated)
under the Companies Act, 2013, having its)
registered office at 1302, Tower-3, One)
International Center, Senapati Bapat Marg,)
Elphinstone Road (West), Delisle Road,)
Mumbai-400013, Maharashtra, India) **...PETITIONER COMPANY**

FORM NO. RSC - 4
[Pursuant to Rule 3(3)]
Publication of Notice

Notice may be taken that an application vide CP / 296 (MB) / 2026 (**'Company Petition'**) has been presented before the National Company Law Tribunal at Mumbai (**'Hon'ble Tribunal'**), on October 29, 2026 *(order uploaded on November 3, 2026)* for confirming reduction of the issued, subscribed and paid up equity share capital of the Company from Rs 20,03,860/- (Rupees Twenty Lakhs Three Thousand Eight Hundred and Sixty only) consisting of 2,00,386 (Two Lakhs Three Hundred and Eighty Six) equity shares of Rs 10/- (Rupees Ten only) each fully paid up, to Rs 7,23,570/- (Rupees Seven Lakhs Twenty Three Thousand Five Hundred and Seventy only) consisting of 72,357 equity shares of Rs 10/- (Rupees Ten only) each fully paid up by cancelling / extinguishing 1,28,029 equity shares of Rs 10/- (Rupees Ten only) each fully paid up held by the equity shareholders of the Company on a proportionate basis, and paying an amount of Rs 25,889.49/- (Rupees Twenty Five Thousand Eight Hundred and Eighty Nine Point Four Nine only) per equity share, aggregating to Rs 3,31,46,05,515.21/- (Rupees Three Hundred and Thirty One Crores Forty Six Lakhs Five Thousand Five Hundred and Fifteen Point Two One only) to the equity shareholders of the Company for equity shares cancelled / extinguished. The amount of Rs 3,31,33,25,225.21/- (Rupees Three Hundred and Thirty One Crores Thirty Three Lakhs Twenty Five Thousand Two Hundred and Twenty Five Point Two One only), being the difference between (a) the total amount payable on reduction of share capital of Rs 3,31,46,05,515.21/- (Rupees Three Hundred and Thirty One Crores Forty Six Lakhs Five Thousand Five Hundred and Fifteen Point Two One only) and; (b) the aggregate face value of paid-up equity share capital being reduced amounting to Rs 12,80,290/- (Rupees Twelve Lakhs Eighty Thousand Two Hundred and Ninety only), shall be adjusted and debited to the balance available in the 'Securities Premium Account' and thereafter to the 'Surplus/ (deficit) in the Statement of Profit and Loss' forming part of 'Shareholders Fund' of the Company (**'Capital Reduction'**)

The notices to individual creditors have been issued. The list of creditors prepared on the September 30, 2026 by the Petitioner Company is available at the registered office of the Company for inspection on all working days during 11 a.m. to 4 p.m. between Monday and Friday.

If any creditor of the Petitioner Company has any objection to the Company Petition or the details in the list of creditors, the same may be sent (along with supporting documents) and details about his name and address and the name and address of his authorised representative, if any, to the undersigned at the registered office of the Petitioner Company at 1302, Tower-3, One International Center, Senapati Bapat Marg, Elphinstone Road (West), Delisle Road, Mumbai-400013, Maharashtra, India within three months of date of this notice.

If no objection is received within the time stated above, entries in the list of creditors will, in all the proceedings under the above Company Petition to reduce the share capital of the Company, be treated as correct.

It may also be noted that a hearing has been fixed for Thursday, February 18, 2027 on which the Hon'ble Tribunal shall hear the Company Petition. In case any creditor intends to attend the hearing, he should make a request along with his objections, if any.

Dated this 9th day of November 2026 at Mumbai

For Inco Jade Private Limited
Sd/-
Anand Narendra Nagda
Director
DIN: 07127717
Address: Flat No. 3504, 35th Floor, Tower Blanca Atmosphere, Mulund Goregaon Link Road, Mulund (West), Mumbai-400080
Email ID: compliance2@bgre.com

Place: Mumbai
Date: 9th November 2026

SBFC Finance Limited

Registered Office: - Unit No. 103, First Floor, C&B Square, Sangam Complex, Village Chakala, Andheri- Kurla Road, Andheri (East), Mumbai-400059.

DEMAND NOTICE

Whereas the borrowers/co-borrowers mentioned hereunder had availed the financial assistance from SBFC Finance Limited. We state that despite having availed the financial assistance, the borrowers/mortgagors have committed various defaults in repayment of interest and principal amounts as per due dates. The account has been classified as Non-Performing Asset on the respective dates mentioned hereunder, in the books of **SBFC** as per guidelines of Reserve Bank of India, consequent to the Authorized Officer of SBFC Finance Limited. under Securitization and Reconstruction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002 ("SARFAESI Act") and in exercise of powers conferred under Section 13(12) read with Rule 3 of Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules, 2002 issued Demand Notices on respective dates mentioned herein below, calling upon the following borrowers /mortgagors to repay the amount mentioned in the notices together with further interest at the contractual rate on the amount mentioned in the notices and incidental expenses, cost, charges etc. until the date of payment within 60 days from the date of receipt of notices.

The notices issued to them on their last known addresses have returned un-served and as such they are hereby informed by way of public notice about the same.

Sl. No.	Name Of The Borrower / Address	Loan A/C No., Amount And Outstanding Amount And Date Of Demand Notice & NPA	Property Address Of Secured Assets
1	**1. ANITA RAVINDR SHINDE** **2. RAVINDRA TAERAM SHINDE** **Having Address at:** Flat No-502 5th Floor A Wing Pancharatna Srashs Ltd Village Kanjur Jangal Mangal Road Bhandup Mumbai 400078 Maharashtra	**Loan Account No. SBFCLAP0000096447 (PR01607435)** **Loan Amount of Rs. 4750000/-** (Rupees Forty-Seven Lakh Fifty Thousand Only) for Facility Agreement No. SBFCLAP0000096447 (PR01607435) **Total Outstanding amount Of Rs. 4882971/-** (Rupees Forty Eight Lakh Eighty Two Thousand Nine Hundred and Seventy One Only) as on 01rd October 2026 plus unapplied interest from the date of 02st October 2026, **Notice Date: 14th -October 2026** **(NPA) 04th July 2026**	All That Piece And Parcel Of Property Situated Flat No-502 5th Floor A Wing Pancharatna Srashs Ltd Village Kanjur Jangal Mangal Road Cts 178, 178/1 To 10 Bhandup Mumbai 400078 Mumbai Maharashtra **Boundaries As Per Site:** East: Happy Home Society, West: Crosswind Society, North: Satya Vijay Society, South: Internal Road.
2	**1. Roshan Bahrgav Salvi (Applicant)** **2. Bhushan Bahrgav Salvi (Co-Applicant 1)** **3. Bhargav Madhukar Salvi (Co-Applicant 2)** **Having address at:** Flat No. B9, on 2nd Floor, in Sadhana Co-Op Hsg. Soc. Ltd., Being lying and situated at Road No.22, Wagle Estate, Bearing Survey No.443(Pt)1, of Village Panchpakhadi, Tal. and Dist.Thane (W), Pin-400 606.	**Loan Account No. 621859 (PR00851952)** **Loan Amount of Rs. 2770000/-** (Rupees Twenty-Seven Lacs Seventy Thousand Only) vide Facility Agreement No. 621859 (PR00851952). **Loan Outstanding Amount of Rs. 2732438/-** (Rupees Twenty Seven Lacs Thirty Two Thousand Four Hundred Thirty Eight Only) as on 03rd October 2026, plus unapplied interest from the date of 04th October 2026, **Demand Notice Date: 14th October 2026** **(NPA) on 03rd September 2026**	All that Piece and Parcel of Flat No.B9, Admeasuring 361 sq.ft. Built-Up Area, on 2nd Floor, in Sadhana Co-Op Hsg. Soc. Ltd., Registered No. TNA/(TNA)/HSG/(TC)/1993/87-88 Dated 20-05-1988, Being lying and situated at Road No.22, Wagle Estate, Bearing Survey No.443(Pt)1, of Village Panchpakhadi, Tal. and Dist.Thane (W), Pin-400 606. And **bounded By:** East: Kadhambari Building, West: Kakare Chawl North: Kakare Compound South: Kakare Chawl

In the circumstances as aforesaid, the notice is hereby given to the above borrowers, co-borrowers, to pay the outstanding dues as mentioned above along with future interest and applicable charges within 60 days from the date of the publication of this notice failing which further steps will be taken after the expiry of 60 days of the date of this notice against the secured assets including taking possession of the secured assets of the borrowers and the mortgagors under Section 13(4) of the SARFAESI Act and the applicable Rules thereunder.

Please note that under Section 13 (13) of the SARFAESI Act, no Borrower shall, transfer by way of sale, lease or otherwise any of his secured assets referred to in the notice, without prior written consent of the secured creditor.

Dated: 09.11.2026
Place: MAHARASHTRA

Sd/- Authorized Officer
SBFC Finance Limited

GOLDIAM INTERNATIONAL LIMITED

GEMS & JEWELLERY COMPLEX,SEEPZ,ANDHERI (EAST), MUMBAI 400 096
CIN:L36912MH1986PLC041203.TEL.(022) 28291893.
FAX:(022) 28290418.Email:investorrelations@goldiam.com. Website: www.goldiam.com

EXTRACT OF CONSOLIDATED UNAUDITED FINANCIAL RESULTS FOR THE QUARTER AND HALF YEAR ENDED ON SEP 30, 2026

(Rs. In Lakhs)

	Particulars	3 Months Ended	3 Months Ended	3 Months Ended	6 Months Ended	6 Months Ended	Year to date Figures for Year Ended
		30-09-2026 Unaudited	30-06-2026 Unaudited	30-09-2025 Unaudited	30-09-2026 Unaudited	30-09-2025 Unaudited	31-03-2026 Audited
1	Total income from operations (net)	**29,166.46**	36,365.93	20,190.93	**65,532.39**	43,759.61	1,02,122.70
2	Net Profit / (Loss) for the period (before Tax, Exceptional and/or Extraordinary items)	**6,731.62**	9,737.99	4,568.19	**16,469.61**	9,107.88	23,082.10
3	Net Profit / (Loss) for the period after tax (after Exceptional and/or Extraordinary items)	**4,939.88**	7,397.44	3,135.84	**12,337.32**	6,497.44	17,059.33
5	Total Comprehensive Income for the period	**5,206.29**	7,869.44	4,048.43	**13,075.73**	7,824.42	19,048.46
6	Net Profit / (Loss) after Taxes, including Minority Interest and Share of Profit / (Loss) of Associates	**5,206.44**	7,869.27	4,049.65	**13,075.71**	7,833.41	19,049.17
7	Paid-up Equity Share Capital (Face Value of Rs. 2/-per share)	**3,011.14**	2,258.35	2,258.35	**3,011.14**	2,258.35	2,258.35
8	Other Equity	**-**	-	-	**-**	-	-
9	Earnings per Share (Not Annualised):						
	(a) Basic	**4.38**	6.55	2.60	**10.93**	5.75	15.11
	(b) Diluted	**2.96**	6.55	2.85	**9.51**	6.00	15.43

Key information on Standalone Financial Results

	Particulars	3 Months Ended	3 Months Ended	3 Months Ended	6 Months Ended	6 Months Ended	Year to date Figures for Year Ended
		30-09-2026 Unaudited	30-06-2026 Unaudited	30-09-2025 Unaudited	30-09-2026 Unaudited	30-09-2025 Unaudited	31-03-2026 Audited
1	Total income from operations (net)	**18,443.35**	15,477.50	10,920.15	**33,920.85**	24,358.76	55,000.70
2	Profit before tax	**2,949.10**	1,091.49	1,857.18	**4,040.59**	3,411.51	6,928.61
3	Profit after Tax	**2,542.84**	741.96	1,314.66	**3,284.80**	2,447.77	5,054.57
4	Total Comprehensive Income	**2,588.72**	907.08	1,447.67	**3,495.80**	2,767.38	5,605.46

1 The above information is an extract of the detailed format of Unaudited result for the Quarter and Half Year ended Sep. 30, 2026 filed with the Stock Exchanges under Regulation 33 of the SEBI (Listing Obligation and Disclosure Requirements) Regulation, 2015. The full format of the unaudited result for the Quarter and Half Year ended Sep. 30, 2026 are avilable on the Stock Exhcnages websites www.besindia.com, www.nesindia.com and on the website of the Company's at www.goldiam.com.

Place : Mumbai
Dated : Nov 07, 2026

For Goldiam International Limited
Sd/-
Rashesh Bhansali
Executive Chairman

AI brings alive India's ancient knowledge



KRANTI NATION

PRANJAL SHARMA

In the festival season, technology is helping bring alive ancient stories, epic dramas and mythologies for a new generation of Indians.

Social media creators are increasingly using artificial intelligence (AI) and digital content tools to reimagine Indian mythology for younger audiences. AI-art storytellers use generative AI platforms like Midjourney, DALL-E, and Runway to create cinematic depictions of scenes from the *Ramayana* and the *Mahabharata*, transforming ancient stories into visually rich reels and short videos. Mythology-focused influencers are also using motion graphics and visual effects to recreate legendary events such as the Kurukshetra war, Hanuman's journey to Sri Lanka, and Krishna's teachings in ways that feel similar and modern.

AI voiceovers, animated illustrations, and digital avatars are being used to narrate lesser-known stories from the Puranas and regional folklore, making them more accessible to younger audiences. Other creators employ augmented reality filters that allow users to interact with mythological themes, characters, and symbols through Instagram Stories and Reels. Animated creators such as those behind digital channels inspired by *Amar Chitra Katha*-style storytelling are adapting traditional narratives into short, shareable video formats that blend historical interpretation with contemporary visual language.



CREATORS AND RESEARCHERS ARE USING THE TECHNOLOGY TO REIMAGINE, PRESERVE AND VALIDATE INDIA'S ANCIENT HERITAGE

The result is that ancient epics and mythologies are reaching millions of young Indians through immersive, technology-enabled storytelling. By combining AI-generated imagery, animation, special effects, audio technology, and social media algorithms, influencers are helping keep cultural narratives relevant and engaging in the digital age.

The technology is being used to examine and validate aspects of ancient Indian science by analysing historical texts, archaeological evidence, linguistic patterns, and astronomical references. Researchers are applying machine learning and natural language processing to Sanskrit manuscripts, including the *Vedas*, Aryabhata's astronomical works, and Sushruta's medical texts, to better understand historical dating and early empirical knowledge. AI tools are also helping scholars map astronomical observations described in ancient epics and compare them with modern celestial models.

Researchers at institutions including the Indian Institute of Science (IISc) and the Indian Institute of Technology (IITs) have applied natural language processing to ancient mathematical, astronomical, and medical manuscripts, making large collections of texts searchable and helping scholars identify scientific concepts systematically. This has revealed sophisticated treatments of grammar, mathematics, and astronomy in works such as Aryabhata's *Aryabhatiya* and Bhaskaracharya's *Lilavati*.

A recent example is the use of AI and machine learning in Ayurgenomics, which combines principles from *Ayurveda* with modern genetics. The initiative has been highlighted by both the World Health Organization and India's Ministry of AYUSH as an example of AI being used to investigate whether traditional Ayurvedic classifications correlate with measurable biological and genetic traits.

This year, the Ministry of Culture's Gyan Bharatam initiative began piloting AI systems that can read, transcribe, search and analyse Sanskrit manuscripts on mathematics, astronomy, medicine, and other traditional disciplines. These tools are helping researchers uncover, compare and validate scientific concepts buried in manuscript collections. IIT Bombay-based BharatGen is working with the ministry on an active pilot, building AI tools that help people read these texts, learn from them and recite them correctly.

Museums, libraries and archives are digitising manuscripts, paintings, photographs, and ancient texts to prevent deterioration and make them widely accessible. Institutions such as the National Digital Library of India and the Indira Gandhi National Centre for the Arts have created digital repositories containing millions of cultural artefacts. High-resolution scanning allows fragile documents, including palm-leaf manuscripts and rare books, to be preserved without repeated physical handling.

As AI advances, it is helping India understand its own heritage better.

The writer is an economic analyst and author

Enterprises face a reckoning in their AI costs

As unguided spending burns through their budgets, companies are turning to solutions to rein in expenses, reports **Avik Das**

PHOTO: SHUTTERSTOCK



In April, Uber exhausted its entire 2026 budget for artificial intelligence (AI) after pushing engineers to adopt the technology faster. Adoption of Anthropic's Claude Code — first rolled out in December — jumped to 84 per cent in March, up from 32 per cent just a month prior. What the company seemingly failed to anticipate was a growing disconnect between the push for higher token usage and the teams controlling the spend, triggering an emergency slowdown.

Similarly, Microsoft cut employee spending on tokens in August and began monitoring consumption to ensure usage gives meaningful outcomes. Meanwhile, *Bloomberg* reported that Apple is lowering daily employee spending limits from $300 to $200, with plans for further cuts to $100.

Expense cap

High costs are prompting enterprises to adopt model orchestration — the process of assigning tasks to the right AI model to achieve desired outcomes at a reasonable cost. This shift comes as massive AI investments fail to yield adequate returns, adoption remains low, and boards and chief financial officers are wary of expenses.

"Many enterprises are currently capping AI spend, given elevated AI costs," said Goldman Sachs in its Connecting Dots report, drawing on examples from companies across technology, retail, telecom and financial services.

Model orchestration is an automated control layer that coordinates and routes tasks across multiple AI models, tools, APIs, and data sources. Instead of relying on one generalist model for every step, it separates high-level planning from specialised execution.

Enterprises woke up to smell the coffee in 2026: Corporate exuberance about AI is fine only as long as it justifies cost. But when millions spent fail to adequately boost the top or bottom line, companies must return to the drawing board, reassess their gaps and fix them.

Model orchestration has emerged as a key priority in the AI world as enterprises discover that unguided token usage does little for efficiency or productivity — it simply burns through annual AI budgets faster than expected. In response, companies are turning to a mix of large, small, and open-source models tailored to specific tasks, driving better results while reining in costs.

An AI model works best for an enterprise when it understands company context, pulls data from multiple sources, and applies that knowledge to complete its assigned tasks. "These models are very knowledgeable about the world but they have no idea about your context, your company, your terminologies, and your acronyms," says Srikanth Velamakanni, cofounder and group chief executive officer (CEO) of enterprise AI firm Fractal Analytics.

"So, bringing your context knowledge effectively to work with an AI model, that's the first thing that you have to do in order to make them very effective. Frontier models can be extremely expensive. If you don't use them correctly, it's like using a bazooka to kill a fly. It won't be a good use of the ammunition. So you have to use the right ones for the right problem," he explains.

Experts say companies should reserve frontier models for work requiring extreme speed and quality, and where cost is no concern. Ultimately, enterprises must balance the economics so that the value AI generates far outweighs its cost. The question remains: How do companies choose the right model for the job?

Using open-weight or small language models trained on proprietary, contextual data can slash costs by tenfold while improving accuracy, according to experts.

While experts advocate for smaller, specialised models to cut costs, Google argues that some of its models are so capable that customers won't need to upgrade to a higher tier.

"The best model is the smallest model that drives the outcome you need and if you look at models that we have like Gemini Flash, it's an extremely capable model compared to the cost of it. Most of our customers don't even need to use Gemini Pro because Gemini Flash is so capable," Andi Gutmans, vice-president and general manager, data cloud, Google Cloud, told *Business Standard* recently.

Context matters

"Context will matter a lot. The less context you have or the less good your context is, the more reasoning loops the agent will do and the more tokens it's going to consume and the more compute it is going to consume," he said.

Google calls this concept a "knowledge catalogue" — a system providing differentiated context so agents receive only the minimum information needed to reach an outcome. By minimising reasoning loops, it cuts down compute time and lowers overall costs.

Velamakanni points to an Australian bank — a client of his firm, Fractal — as an example. "They launched a product which was extremely successful with their customers but they launched it for about 30,000 of their customers and they wanted to take it to about 2 million. Because they were bringing in a phenomenal model, which is very good, but the model was not fully trained in the context of the organisation itself. What we suggested was to bring in a potentially open model, post-train it with their data, so that it becomes a faster and cheaper model."

Since many services for large language models (LLMs) — AI systems trained on vast datasets — charge by token usage, tracking tokens helps enterprises understand the true financial and operational cost behind every prompt, response, retrieval and automated workflow. Experts recommend implementing dynamic routing: Sending lower-complexity tasks to low-cost models, while reserving advanced, token-heavy workloads for frontier LLMs.

Model orchestration is becoming a critical part of every client conversation, according to LTM, an IT services company. Infosys, another IT firm, offers a similar solution for its clients: Based on query complexity, the system automatically selects the right backend model to optimise costs.

"We create a skill to make sure that tokens are worth the transaction automation. At Infosys, we give a specific budget to everybody so that people are more AI-aware and they are believers in AI," said Sajit Vijayakumar, CEO of Infosys Finacle.

"For clients, we have a hierarchy of models. There are open source, locally deployable models where we just need a GPU as a capital investment. If a certain task cannot be performed with that model, that framework escalates automatically to the next model. This is what the whole industry is doing to optimise cost," he said.

Managing AI bill

- Tech leaders including Uber, Microsoft and Apple have faced AI budget crunches, prompting emergency usage caps
- Enterprises are deploying automated control layers to route tasks dynamically across large, small and open-source AI models
- Experts advocate using smaller AI models tailored with proprietary data to reduce operational costs
- IT giants like Infosys and LTM are using strict token budgets to ensure AI spending delivers clear business returns

ALGO RHYTHM

86% of firms suffer cyber breaches amid crisis to find talent

Engineers are leveraging artificial intelligence (AI) to fight cyberattacks but organisations face a severe talent shortage to protect themselves, according to Fortinet's *2026 Global Cybersecurity Skills Gap* report. As many as 86 per cent of organisations suffered one or more cybersecurity breaches in the past 12 months. Unsurprisingly, their top recruiting need is experienced security experts. The survey by the multinational cybersecurity company gathered insights from 2,750 global information technology (IT) and cybersecurity leaders — including from India.



Under attack

- **86%** of organisations logged one or more breaches in the past 12 months. 29% reported 5 or more breaches
- **52%** say breaches cost them more than $1 mn — up from 38% in 2021
- **20%** of organisations took 4 to 6 months to recover from a cyberattack — up from 14% in 2024

Certifications valued

- **91%** of IT leaders prefer to hire candidates who hold tech certifications
- **58%** are likely to invest in AI-related cybersecurity training or certifications
- **73%** are willing to fund certification costs for prospective candidates

Skills gap

- **60%** of respondents say finding AI-skilled cybersecurity talent their major recruiting challenge
- **63%** expect an increased need for AI governance roles on cybersecurity teams
- **51%** of organisations say their top priority is hiring senior cybersecurity experts
- **49%** report difficulty in securing approval for additional cybersecurity headcount

Source: Fortinet's 2026 Global Cybersecurity Skills Gap survey by Sapio Research **Compiled by Shivani Shinde**

'In the cybersecurity space, we have to use AI to fight AI'

Q&A Broadridge, a New York-based company that provides technology and communications solutions to the financial services industry, says the spread of artificial intelligence (AI) means organisations are demanding more in skills while hiring. They want expertise in "real engineering design and solutions", **Tim Gokey**, chief executive officer of Broadridge, tells **Avik Das** in an interview in Bengaluru. Edited excerpts:

What are the key AI trends you anticipate will play out in the financial services industry next year?

■ The obvious would be the progress of frontier models. The interesting challenge will be the ability of all of us to harness that power. We have already introduced a number of new products and we will scale those up quite nicely. Speed in that development process will be highly relevant here as all of our engineers are using AI tools today. At the same time, we are developing a more comprehensive platform for them to test codes, promoting it and monitoring and optimising it. That will increase productivity and help us advance our product roadmap. In fact, we have already improved our productivity by 25 per cent in the last year and the target is another 25 per cent in the coming 12 months.

Individual productivity due to AI has yet to translate into organisational productivity at most enterprises. Isn't that a concern?

■ We said that we will have $25 million of savings from AI. While that is a small number relative to our total cost base, it is a very specific number. A lot of that was from technology and particularly around testing, where we have been able to automate so much of that was previously manual. We have also told investors that we will be reinvesting all of that because of so much change happening.

Broadridge is part of Project Glasswing, Anthropic's collaborative cybersecurity initiative to test its advanced AI models such as Mythos. How has that helped you strengthen your cybersecurity systems?

■ That is an area where we are investing a lot. As you know, we have to use AI to fight AI. One of the big things that Mythos can do is to take vulnerabilities that were not deemed critical and string them together to make something that is critical. We, like many other companies, are using AI to go back and clean all the backlog of non-criticals. We have already reduced our non-critical vulnerabilities by 80-90 per cent in the last few months.



"THERE IS A SAFE AMOUNT OF TIME BEFORE A SOFTWARE VULNERABILITY WILL LIKELY BE EXPLOITED. THE TIME TO FIX THE VULNERABILITY WITH A PATCH IS SHRINKING DRAMATICALLY"

Tim Gokey
CEO, Broadridge

We are also using AI to radically improve the speed of patching, the process to find a vulnerability and fix it in a certain amount of time. That is a safe amount of time before it would likely be exploited. That time is shrinking dramatically and so we are using AI to detect and remediate faster. The three pillars are speed, cost and security.

What is the one thing about Mythos that should make executives nervous and excited?

■ I think the thing that is making everyone nervous is this ability to take multiple things that are not critical and put them together to create something that is critical. That has created a lot of work for all the leading institutions to go back and resolve those. However, our ability to use AI to remediate things more quickly, identify and patch things faster and dramatic acceleration of our whole security process is something that I am really proud of.

Does that change the type of talent you would like to hire?

■ That is interesting because it does. It is actually fewer people doing the work and more designing the system, which is going to do the work automatically. There is a lot of intelligence that is now needed and a lot of the main knowledge. The skill from just pure play delivery to real engineering design and solutions is where we are seeing the transition.

While using AI internally, how do you minimise the use of tokens?

■ All the companies that I know of are looking at how they engineer things — to use the simplest possible query, to have software that automatically uses the cheapest possible model; perhaps to source models from China and use open source. There is a lot of engineering going into how to minimise the amount of tokens that are being used. When I look at our token usage, it is pretty immaterial relative to the savings that we are getting and so the return on investment is very good.

What has been the role of your Indian centre in your AI journey?

■ We have a part of our global leadership here. We have a platform that pulls together all of our applications with a common data model, common set of APIs, which is great to apply AI on. The leadership for that is coming from our team here.

OPINION

No room for pessimism



PRASHANT JAIN

"In the short run, the market is a voting machine, but in the long run, it is a weighing machine."
- Benjamin Graham

This quote reminds us that while near-term market returns are volatile and uncertain, long-term market performance is linked to the growth of underlying businesses. Given this background, it is surprising to see that the weak market returns of the past two years are driving pessimism around India, especially when its economy has shown remarkable resilience even in an adverse environment. We must remember that equities are slaves to corporate earnings in the long term, not the other way around.

India's economy continues to deliver strong growth. This economic strength is built on strong macro parameters. The current account deficit is low, the fiscal deficit is well-controlled, bank balance sheets are healthy, and corporate leverage is at historic lows. Meanwhile, corporate profit growth remains strong, and aggregate capital expenditure is growing faster than gross domestic product (GDP).

The Indian economy has grown at approximately 7.5 per cent annually across FY25 and FY26 in an adverse environment: Net foreign direct investment (FDI) was nearly zero, foreign portfolio investors (FPIs) sold heavily, gold imports remained elevated, and oil prices were volatile. What is even more impressive is that during the first quarter of FY27, when crude averaged roughly $97 per barrel, the economy still delivered an impressive 7.8 per cent growth.

The sustained growth during this difficult period was aided by proactive management from the government and the Reserve Bank of India (RBI). Interventions such as lower goods and services tax rates, reduced excise duties on petrol and diesel, and the absorption of higher fertiliser and liquefied petroleum gas (LPG) costs helped sustain strong domestic demand. Furthermore, the timely mobilisation of $136 billion through Foreign Currency Non-Resident (Bank) or FCNR(B) and external commercial borrowings has sharply improved India's forex reserves and balance of payments (BOP). This has improved sentiment toward the rupee, which in turn is supportive of capital flows. Healthy reserves improve the resilience of India in the medium term to higher oil prices and higher US yields. Additionally, India has significantly reduced its structural vulnerability to energy shocks, with oil imports as a share of GDP declining from over 5 per cent in FY2013 to around 3 per cent in FY2026.

Looking ahead, the outlook for the Indian economy is even better. India is widely known as the services leader of the world – with its share of global services (excluding tourism) around 8 per cent – and is proving resilient to artificial intelligence (AI) disruption so far. Despite negative sentiment regarding the impact of AI on information technology exports, India's services exports grew 15 per cent year-to-date (till August). What's more, India is making good progress in manufacturing. This structural shift is driven by multiple catalysts: China's per-capita income is now 5x that of India, making Indian labour competitive; supportive government policies; rupee depreciation vs Chinese Yuan (CNY); a focus on the 'China+1' strategy by developed nations seeking to diversify their supply chains; and supportive capital markets. Consequently, the manufacturing sector is now growing faster than overall GDP and, given its low base, this growth should be sustained for many years.

ILLUSTRATION: BINAY SINHA



The external environment is also gradually becoming supportive. Net FDI has started to climb, and gold prices are losing momentum, which should reduce the demand for imports. FPI selling will abate at some point and oil prices will eventually come down once the West Asia conflict calms, as the oil market is fundamentally oversupplied over the medium term, given the impending global transition toward electric vehicles.

So, if the economy and its outlook is so robust, why did the markets underperform over the past two years? The underperformance was due to elevated starting valuations, the AI trade, and primary market supply.

This period marked the emergence of an AI and semiconductor supercycle. Because India lacks direct exposure to these sectors, it effectively became a funding source for FPIs, driving significant capital outflows and causing Indian equities to sharply underperform the broader emerging markets index. It is not that India's economy was faltering; rather, markets with heavy exposure to hardware stocks — where earnings were temporarily growing exponentially — simply offered more immediate, momentum-driven returns. This has driven India's five-year performance relative to emerging markets to a record low and should mean revert at some point.

In addition to the $60 billion in FPI outflows over the past two years, a constant supply of new equity has absorbed domestic mutual fund inflows, limiting the upward movement of secondary stock prices. However, this availability of capital via initial public offerings (IPOs) is beneficial for the real economy. It allows companies across the manufacturing, services, and consumer sectors to fund expansions, which in turn drives employment and consumption.

After two years of time-consolidation and a modest price correction, valuation multiples have now normalised. Global headwinds for India also appear to be easing as US 10-year yields retreat below 5 per cent and the momentum behind the AI trade cools, with the Korean market (MSCI South Korea) down around 35 per cent from its recent peak. Encouragingly, on October 30, when the US Semiconductor Index (SOX) was down 7.2 per cent and the Nasdaq dropped 2 per cent, Indian ADRs (American depository receipts) held firm. If the AI theme wanes, the Indian market will stand in a much better light.

To summarise, India's relevance to the global economy is growing steadily, and as the world's fastest-growing major economy, its global footprint will only expand in the years to come. Over the past 25 years, India's share of world GDP has increased from 1.4 per cent to 3.3 per cent. Today, it is the sixth-largest economy in the world and is anticipated to become the third-largest in three to four years, crossing $5 trillion in nominal GDP.

In contrast to the strong and sustained economic growth, equity returns are non-linear and bunched up. Hence, Indian equities have played catch-up after every prolonged period of underperformance. Over the past 25 years, following every two-year drawdown of 15 per cent or more, the subsequent three-year returns have been significant, and we do not see any reason why it should be different this time. Rather than a cause for pessimism, this divergence creates a compelling opportunity for discerning investors.

The writer is Chief Investment Officer of 3P Investment Managers, a Sebi-registered AIF. The views, opinions, and analyses expressed in this article are those of the author in his personal capacity.

Empty bank accounts in Vigilance Week

Are IT-trained staff available when regular operators are on leave? Are daily-waged support workers restricted to non-sensitive areas? Banks need to address these questions



BANKER'S TRUST

TAMAL BANDYOPADHYAY

Farmer Vijendra Singh lost money kept with a bank. Singh told the media that his savings account at a branch of Punjab National Bank (PNB) in Greater Noida once held approximately ₹87–88 lakh, including compensation received from the authorities for land acquisition. When he checked, the balance had fallen to barely ₹1 lakh.

He is one of many depositors whose money, they allege, had disappeared from savings accounts and fixed deposits without their authorisation.

This happened in the last week of October when the banking industry was observing Vigilance Awareness Week.

Since 2000, every year, during the week that includes the birth anniversary of Sardar Vallabhbhai Patel (October 31), a nationwide campaign has been organised by the Central Vigilance Commission (CVC) to promote integrity, transparency, and the fight against corruption in public governance. This year, it was observed from October 26 to November 1 on the theme 'Probity for Prosperity'.

Government departments, central public sector enterprises, public sector banks, and other participating organisations were directed to begin the observance with an integrity pledge. Workshops, outreach programmes, debates, quizzes, and other awareness activities were also encouraged.

The vigilance-related activities are not confined to just one week. The CVC's three-month preventive-vigilance campaign this year, running from August 17 to November 16, identifies five priorities: Disposal of pending complaints, disposal of pending cases, capacity building, digital initiatives, and transparency in contract management and awarding contracts to vendors. Work under these priority heads will continue till November 30.

The initiative is great. But, beyond meetings and posters, awareness must reach branch counters. All banks must remain vigilant 24/7 through an ever-aware oversight machinery. Not pledges and activities — the real scorecard is the number of vulnerable pockets closed within the system.

The Greater Noida allegations concern savings and fixed-deposit accounts, including those of farmers who had deposited land-compensation money. Customers say transactions occurred without their consent and allege that they received no SMS alerts.

The bank concerned, I understand, has assured all aggrieved depositors of refunds within a few days. Media reports also hint at unauthorised access to lockers and growing anxiety among NRI customers. I have not been able to independently corroborate such allegations.

Scenes of distressed depositors waiting for explanations may evoke memories of troubled cooperative banks. But this bank is not insolvent, and only a tiny fraction of deposits is affected. Therefore, customers need not panic.

However, the institution's immediate task is twofold: Establish the facts and prevent uncertainty from becoming a second injury.

The bank's preliminary inquiry identified approximately Rs 10.24 crore in suspected unauthorised withdrawals, even as reconciliation continues to establish the full extent of the fraud. Earlier, customer allegations put the amount at nearly Rs 35 crore, a figure that has not been officially confirmed.

A November 1 media report noted that a first information report (FIR) filed with the police mentions transactions worth ₹12.12 crore, while a branch staff member speaking anonymously told a social media channel that approximately 35 account holders had approached the police, with alleged unauthorised transactions pegged at around ₹17 crore.

These are overlapping investigative and complaint-based figures. By November 3, the Central Bureau of Investigation had reportedly arrested two individuals—a bank office assistant and an outsider—in connection with the alleged ₹ 10.24-crore fraud case. Arrest or suspension does not establish guilt, and the investigation into other possible accomplices and the movement of funds continues.

PNB's October 30 statement said it had settled three claims totalling ₹43 lakh and would honour all genuine and valid claims.

Going by the FIR, one woman depositor found three unfamiliar transactions dated September 16, 2026, when she updated her passbook. She had neither authorised nor consented to them.

The subsequent inquiry reportedly found that credentials belonging to six bank officials had been used for unauthorised transactions. Whether those credentials were shared voluntarily or compromised remains part of the investigation.

Other reported allegations include the manipulation of customer details and fixed-deposit records, premature closures, and diversion of funds through beneficiary accounts. The suspected activities had reportedly been going on for about three years.

Why did the institution need a customer's complaint to identify a pattern that its own internal controls should have flagged? The investigation must establish whether system alerts were absent, inadequately designed, ignored, or improperly closed. It must also determine which officials had access to the relevant information and what action they took.

National figures underline the gravity of the issue. The Reserve Bank of India's (RBI's) Annual Report for 2025–26 records 10,114 fraud cases involving ₹48,021 crore, compared with 23,722 cases involving ₹32,803 crore in the preceding year. The data covers frauds of ₹1 lakh and above, and cases reported in a given year may relate to events from earlier years. Also, the FY2025-26 figure includes ₹30,199 crore relating to 314 older cases reported afresh following a re-examination. Crucially, the amount involved in reported frauds does not necessarily represent the final loss.

Reports of surprise inspections at PNB spoke of outsiders working inside banking areas, including cash counters and on branch computers. Initial reporting put the number of suspended branch heads at around 20. A recent media report revised the figure to around 50. Claims that suspensions may have reached nearly 100 remain unverified.

The bank's inspection at the branches involved found that individuals — including insurance-company personnel, recovery agents, and other helpers — were allegedly assisting with core banking work amid claims of staffing shortages.

Business correspondents, insurance representatives, and temporary workers may have legitimate, defined duties. But their presence does not justify access to another employee's password, unrestricted customer information, or transaction-authorisation powers. Staffing shortages cannot be an excuse for password sharing, and management cannot treat staffing levels as unrelated to financial controls.

Can a branch maintain a genuine dual-control separation between the person entering a transaction and the person approving it? Are sufficiently IT-trained staff available when the regular operator of a specific desk goes on leave? Are support workers hired on a daily-wage basis properly engaged, supervised, and strictly restricted to non-sensitive areas? What happens when a manager formally reports that safe working arrangements cannot be maintained?

The reported reliance on informal helpers should prompt a serious re-examination of recruitment and deployment policies, including support-staff arrangements — rather than an assumption that daily-wage labour is an acceptable substitute for controlled system access.

Management must also examine whether third-party sales targets and other performance pressures leave sufficient time for the daily verification of transactions, reconciliation of all non-customer accounts, and prompt complaint handling.

Finally, auditors should examine repeated debits and credits, ledger reversals, connected beneficiaries, and changes to deposit instructions. They must scrutinise premature fixed deposit closures, changes to maturity-proceeds credit accounts, modifications to account operating details, registered mobile number alterations, disabled alert preferences, and unusual staff access patterns.

Following the RBI's Master Direction on Fraud Risk Management (issued on July 31, 2026), banks require board-approved arrangements covering prevention, detection, investigation, staff accountability, recovery, and reporting. A dedicated board committee carries the responsibility for reviewing frauds, root causes, and corrective measures. The directions also call for early warning mechanisms covering non-credit banking transactions, with monitoring designed to promptly identify unusual activity.

PNB's experience with the 2018 Nirav Modi scandal makes the need for durable institutional learning particularly vital. Following that event, the RBI discontinued Letters of Undertaking (LoUs) for import trade credit.

For a depositor awaiting access to savings, a mere institutional explanation is not a resolution. The bank should provide a dedicated claims officer, written acknowledgements, clear verification requirements, and regular progress updates. Restoration of funds must transparently cover applicable interest alongside the principal amount, without unjust charges.

For Singh and other complainants, the test is not whether employees raised their hands to take a pledge during Vigilance Awareness Week. It is whether the institution can explain what happened, restore legitimate claims, and demonstrate that the next depositor will not face the same ordeal.

Sardar Vallabhbhai Patel's standard for public service remains a fitting measure of that responsibility. In 1947, while addressing civil service probationers, Patel said: "No service worth the name can claim to exist if it does not have in view the achievement of the highest standard of integrity."

The writer's latest book is *Roller Coaster: An Affair with Banking*
Twitter: TamalBandyo
Website: https://bankerstrust.in

STATSGURU

Demonetisation puzzles between cash and clicks



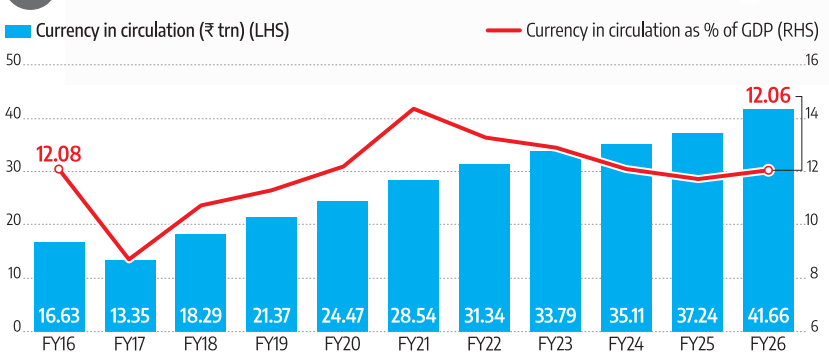
IMAGING: AJAYA MOHANTY

SNEHA SASIKUMAR

On November 8, a decade ago, Prime Minister Narendra Modi announced the scrapping of ₹500 and ₹1,000 notes to curb black money, reduce tax evasion, remove counterfeit currency and make India a less cash economy. The two notes accounted for over 86 per cent of the currency in circulation (CiC) at that time. Over the past 10 years, digital payments have moved far ahead. They now account for over 98 per cent of payments in both volume and value. While digital economy leapfrogged, CiC also made a full comeback. This is known as "cash paradox." But the cash in people's hands is not the same. Today, a new ₹500 note alone makes up about 86 per cent of the value of notes. The government also introduced the ₹2,000 note at the time of demonetisation, which made up half the value in FY17, slipped every year until its withdrawal was announced in 2023. Fake notes have not gone away either. In the year demonetisation was announced, 0.76 million pieces were detected. By FY26, the count was about 70 per cent lower, yet it was the highest in the past four years, with the ₹500 note making up over 60 per cent of fake notes.

StatsGuru is a weekly feature. Every Monday, Business Standard guides you through the numbers you need to know to make sense of the headlines

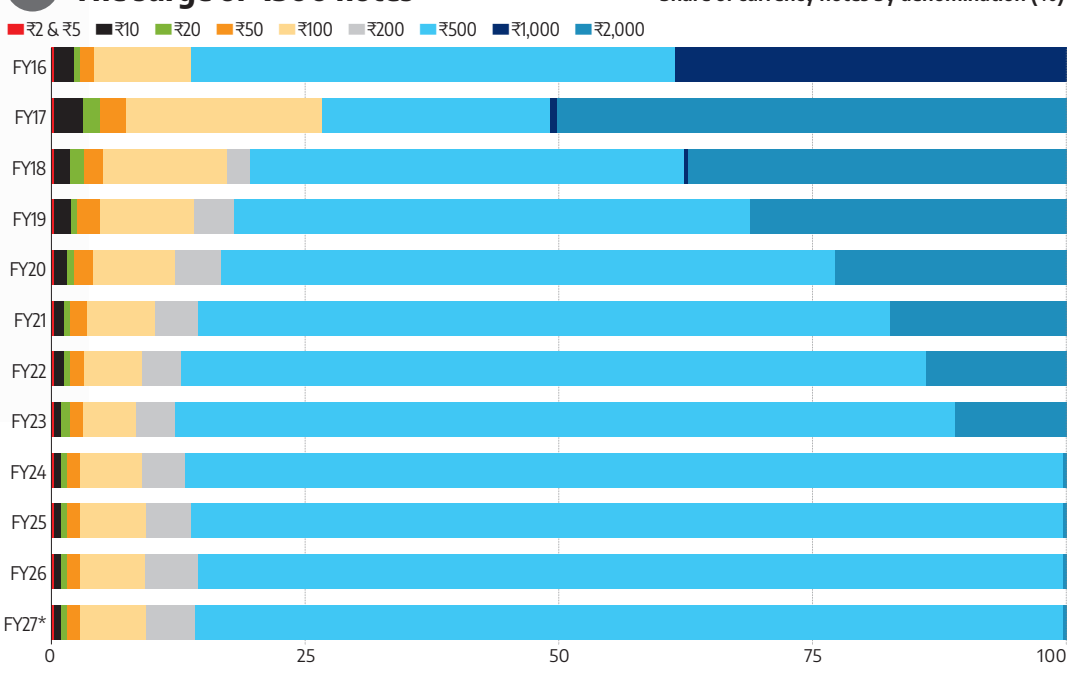
1 Cash makes a comeback



Source: RBI, Mospi, *Business Standard* calculations

2 The surge of ₹500 notes

Share of currency notes by denomination (%)



*Till October 23, 2026; Note: The ₹200 banknote was introduced on August 25, 2017. The withdrawal of the ₹2,000 banknote was announced on May 19, 2023
Source: CMIE, *Business Standard* calculations

3 Fake currency detections at 4-year high in FY26

Share of counterfeit detections by denomination (%)

	₹2,000	₹1,000	₹500	₹200	₹100	Others*	Total counterfeit notes (In no.)
FY16	0	22.6	41.35	0	34.99	1.06	632,926
FY17	0.08	33.64	41.7	0	23.25	1.33	762,072
FY18	3.43	19.82	26.36	0.02	45.75	4.62	522,783
FY19	6.88	0.22	7.2	4.01	69.7	11.99	317,384
FY20	5.74	0.03	10.13	10.78	56.87	16.45	296,695
FY21	4.22	0	18.92	11.61	53.08	12.17	208,625
FY22	5.89	0	34.5	11.74	39.93	7.94	230,971
FY23	4.34	0.21	40.36	12.08	34.86	8.15	225,769
FY24	11.69	0	38.51	12.88	29.78	7.14	222,639
FY25	1.62	0	54.15	15.02	23.49	5.72	217,396
FY26	0.36	0	61.77	13.32	19.86	4.69	229,746

Note: *Low denomination notes include 50, 20, 10, 5 and 2 rupee notes.
Source: CMIE, *Business Standard* calculations

4 Tax buoyancy declines

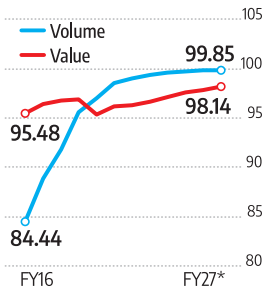
Central tax buoyancy

FY16	1.63
FY17	1.51
FY18	1.07
FY19	0.79
FY20	-0.53
FY21	*
FY22	1.78
FY23	0.92
FY24	1.12
FY25	0.98
FY26	0.75

Note: Tax buoyancy is ratio of change in central tax revenue and nominal GDP; *Can't be calculated as numerator, denominator are -ve; Source: CGA, Mospi, *Business Standard* calculations

5 Digital payments boom

Share of digital payments in total payments (%)



*Till September 2026
Source: RBI annual reports, *Business Standard* calculations

6 UPI vs RTGS

Share of top payment systems in digital transactions (%)

	Volume		Value	
Payment system	FY17	FY26	FY17	FY26
UPI	0.18	85.76	0.0031	9.66
NEFT	16.61	3.58	5.51	15.45
Card payments	11.13	2.59	0.15	0.86
IMPS	5.19	1.75	0.19	2.36
RTGS	1.1	0.12	45.09	69.94

Note: UPI was introduced in 2016.
Source: CMIE, RBI, *Business Standard* calculations

Premium K-12 school market moves into investor top class

Realty developers join the roll call as school infra draws long-term capital

AUHONA MUKHERJEE & AKSHAT AYUSH
New Delhi, 8 November



Realty surge

- Investors explore partnerships with established school chains and international education brands
- Three-tier ownership structure involving property, management and operating entities gains traction
- Land scarcity pushes premium school expansion towards Tier-II cities and suburban markets
- Bengaluru, Hyderabad, Pune, Delhi-NCR see strong demand
- International education groups were also scouting for existing schools whose operations they could take over where there was little scope for new construction
- CBRE report estimates India will need 1-1.5 billion sq ft of additional private education infrastructure by FY35
- The report also found that land requirements for K-12 schools vary widely by location, curriculum, and campus format

India's premium K-12 (kindergarten to Class 12) education market is attracting growing interest from institutional investors and real estate developers, with school infrastructure emerging as a long-term investment opportunity. Investors are exploring partnerships with established school chains and international education brands, even as the traditional model of developers leasing properties to school-operating trusts remains prevalent.

Vinod Kakumani, CEO of SchoolServe, which operates the school real estate platform SchoolProp, said some investors were exploring a three-tier structure involving separate property, management, and operating entities. "The most popular structure for investors in the K-12 segment is to have a developer that owns the land and building and a trust that runs the operations of the school. However, nowadays a three-tier ownership structure is also emerging, where a property company, a management company, and an operating entity exist together," he said.

Despite the scale of private education, the infrastructure serving the sector remains fragmented and under-invested, creating an opportunity for institutional capital, said Anshuman Magazine, chairman and chief executive officer (CEO) for India, Southeast Asia, the Middle East, and Africa at CBRE.

"This is a long-term asset class. The value comes from getting the catchment right and replicating what works. Investors who treat it like a standard commercial play will struggle. Those who build it as a platform will do well," Magazine said.

He said returns would depend on the quality of operators, location, visibility on admissions, and lease or revenue arrangements.

"We expect developers to partner more with established school operators and international education brands. As these platforms expand across core urban markets and into select Tier-II cities, education real estate could grow into an institutional segment, rather than staying the fragmented, promoter-driven market it largely is today," he added.

Saurabh Arora, founder and CEO of University Living, a global managed marketplace for student accommodation, said investor interest was likely to be selective, particularly in urban catchments where families valued accessibility, facilities, and consistent educational experiences. He cited Stoicap Ventures' announcement in August of plans to raise an education infrastructure fund of up to ₹750 crore, targeting rental-generating K-12 school and student housing assets.

Investor interest is growing amid rising demand for private education infrastructure. A CBRE report published in October estimated that India would require an additional 1-1.5 billion square feet of private education infrastructure by 2034-35, driven by rising enrolment, greater private-sector participation, and growing demand for quality education.

The report also found that land requirements for K-12 schools vary widely by location, curriculum, and campus format. Compact urban K-12 schools could require 0.5-3 acres, compared with 5-10 acres or more for suburban and international day-boarding campuses with extensive sports facilities.

Central Board of Secondary Education (CBSE)-affiliated schools generally require 1,600-6,000 square metres of land, depending on the level of the school and its location, along with prescribed playground facilities, the report said.

Dhirendra Mishra, founder and director of LIFE Educare, which operates the school real estate advisory platform School Xchange, said the separation of property ownership and school operations was an established practice, including among CBSE-affiliated institutions. Typically, developers leased land and buildings to trusts for around 15 years, with provisions to extend the arrangement, he said.

Alongside investor interest, limited availability of suitable land in major cities is influencing how school operators expand. Kakumani said demand for premium schools was particularly strong in Bengaluru, Hyderabad, Pune, and the Delhi-National Capital Region, but the availability of land was increasingly constraining new development.

"For example, with a lack of available land in Mumbai, schools are coming up in Navi Mumbai, Thane, etc., to meet the demand. On our portal, we see that the demand for such schools is increasing, but supply is not enough, with very little land for further construction of schools and buildings," Kakumani said. He added that international education groups were also scouting for existing schools whose operations they could take over in locations where there was little scope for fresh construction.

Mishra said demand for premium schooling was spreading beyond Tier-I cities into Tier-II and Tier-III markets. "However, developers want to set up schools in Tier-I areas more because that is where the highest school fees are, and developers find it most profitable," he added.

More on business-standard.com

Nasa's Swift burns up, highlighting challenges of boosting satellites

WANJIKU CHEBET KANJUMBA
Gainesville, 8 November



The special rescue spacecraft LINK, which flew on a failed mission designed to extend the life of Nasa's Neil Gehrels Swift Observatory FILE PHOTO : REUTERS

Nasa's Neil Gehrels Swift Observatory took its last look at the sky on October 20, 2026, while orbiting about 275 kilometres above Earth.

Nasa ended the telescope's mission three days later, because Swift had sunk so low that drag from the thin air there meant its telescopes couldn't hold steady. The telescope reentered the atmosphere on November 4 above the North Sumatra region of Indonesia and largely burned up, an abrupt ending to two decades spent observing powerful cosmic explosions.

Swift's reentry comes after a failed rescue mission in the summer of 2026. LINK, a commercial robotic spacecraft sent to raise Swift into a safer orbit, reentered Earth's atmosphere in September. The machine designed to save a falling satellite burned up first. As a PhD candidate in aerospace engineering, I know that rescuing satellites is hard. I research how spacecraft approach and capture satellites, including objects that tumble uncontrollably.

Swift's loss points to a new hazard for the young industry that repairs, refuels and moves spacecraft around in orbit. If something goes wrong, the spacecraft doing the rescuing can become another problem.

The rescuer started spinning

The plan was for LINK to approach Swift, grab it with one of its three robotic arms and fire its thrusters to push the telescope back up to about 600 kilometres above Earth's surface, where it could keep observing for years.

In late July, LINK lost two of its three reaction wheels, which are heavy wheels inside a spacecraft that help it turn without using fuel. That loss, combined with problems with its propulsion system, sent the spacecraft into an uncontrolled spin.

Without working wheels, a spacecraft steers with its thrusters instead, and every burn spends propellant.

Engineers eventually slowed LINK's rotation by firing its thrusters against the spin. Nasa reported in August that they had cut its spin from about nine degrees per second to roughly one and a half degrees per second.

THE CONVERSATION

Nasa and Katalyst Space, LINK's builder, called off the capture and boost later in August. The team still flew LINK within 12 to 15 kilometres of Swift, where it deployed LINK's three robotic arms and tested its electric thrusters. It never got close enough to grab the telescope.

Fuel is the rescue budget

A servicing spacecraft, like LINK, launches with a finite supply of propellant. Engineers split that fuel supply among the mission's jobs, from reaching the target and approaching it safely to capturing it and moving it to a new orbit. They also pack some extra fuel in case of surprises. Think of a tow truck that burns most of its gas getting itself out of a ditch. Even if it reaches a broken-down car, it may not have enough fuel left to tow it home.

That scenario is close to what happened to LINK. Even after engineers brought its spin under control, Katalyst said the spacecraft no longer had enough propellant to capture Swift and raise its orbit safely. A fuel budget that covers only the planned steps leaves nothing for recovering from a fault. But every extra pound of propellant also makes a spacecraft heavier, and heavier spacecraft cost more to launch and take more fuel to move.

Speed buys time and costs backup

Starting in 2024, solar activity swelled Earth's upper atmosphere, and the extra drag pulled Swift down faster than expected. Once Nasa saw how quickly Swift was falling, the agency had to move fast to try to save the observatory. Space missions typically take years to develop and launch, but in this case, a slow, conventional development programme risked arriving too late. Nasa awarded Katalyst a $30 million contract in September 2025. The company had less than a year to design, build, test and launch LINK. LINK launched on July 3, 2026. Speed comes with trade-offs. In engineering, a compressed schedule can leave less time for repeated testing, building spare hardware and planning recovery options. Public reports do not say whether that trade-off played any part in LINK's faults.

Nasa has said that even though LINK didn't succeed, the effort gave the agency experience in quickly building, launching and operating a servicing spacecraft.

Engineers also showed they could upload new control software to steady a damaged servicing spacecraft with the hardware it had left. And LINK tested its arms and fired all three thrusters at once in orbit.

What comes next

While Swift was the most pressing case for a boost mission, it's not the only one. Nasa's Hubble Space Telescope could one day use a similar boost, and news reports suggested it would have been next in line had this mission worked.

Future missions are pursuing two complementary approaches for rescuing satellites. Astroscale's ELSA-M is built to capture satellites that carry a docking plate installed before launch, which would make it easier for a rescuer to snag and boost them if the satellite eventually got into trouble. The European Space Agency's ClearSpace-1 is planned for 2029 and aims to capture the Proba-1 satellite, which doesn't have a docking plate or anything to help ClearSpace-1 capture it, and remove it from orbit.

LINK's mission showed that a rescue takes more than a robotic arm and enough thrust to reach a target. It also takes a servicer spacecraft that can stay stable, recover from its own faults and keep enough propellant reserved to finish the job. In Swift's case, the rescuer fell short before the rescue could begin.

(The writer is from University of Florida)

HINGOLI MUNCIPAL COUNCIL, HINGOLI

e-Tender Notice for 2026-27

Hingoli Municipal Council invites e-tender for the work of Proposed construction of shopping Centre at Site No. 100, CTS no.4485,4486 and S.No.94 for Hingoli Municipal Council Hingoli in the State of Maharashtra of Estimated Cost Rs. 410392310.00/-. The e- Tender details are available on **www.mahatenders.gov.in** All relevant dates will be as per the tender published in web portal **www.mahatenders.gov.in**

Date: 06/11/2026

Sd/-
(Pranjali Munde)
Chief Officer
Hingoli Municipal Council

Sd/-
(Rekhatai Bangar)
President
Hingoli Municipal Council

Kolhapur Municipal Corporation
(Health / Solid Waste Management Department)
Public Tender Notice No. 90

This notice is issued to inform all organizations and contractors that the Kolhapur Municipal Corporation is inviting e-tenders for **The Selection of an Operator for Municipal Solid Waste Management (SWM) Services viz., Collection and Transportation of waste from project area to designated depositing centers, ICCC establishment and operations, Mechanized road sweeping with O and M of vehicles, inside Project area of Kolhapur Municipal Corporation**

However, interested bidders should visit the Government of Maharashtra website **www.mahatender.gov.in** from 07/11/2026 to 07/12/2026 at 3:30 PM to receive and submit their tenders.

Sd/-
Commissioner
Kolhapur Municipal Corporation

Mukka Proteins Limited

MUKKA PROTEINS LIMITED
Regd. Office: Mukka Corporate House, Door No. 18-2-16/4, First Cross, NG Road, Attavara, Dakshina Kannada, Mangaluru - 575001, Karnataka.
Tel: +918244252889 Email: investors@mukkaproteins.com
Website: www.mukkaproteins.com CIN: L10207KA2010PLC055771

UNAUDITED STANDALONE AND CONSOLIDATED FINANCIAL RESULTS OF THE COMPANY FOR THE QUARTER AND HALF YEAR ENDED 30TH SEPTEMBER 2026

Based on the recommendation of the Audit Committee, the Board of Directors of the Company at their meeting held on 7th November 2026, have approved the unaudited standalone and consolidated financial results of the Company for the quarter and half year ended 30th September 2026.

The full financial results along with the Limited Review Report of the Statutory Auditors thereon are available on the Company's website at https://mukkaproteins.com/wp-content/uploads/2026/11/Outcome-of-Board-Meeting_Q2_final.pdf and the website of Stock Exchanges i.e. BSE Limited and National Stock Exchange of India Limited at www.bseindia.com and www.nseindia.com, respectively and can also be accessed by scanning the Quick Response ('QR') Code.

For and on behalf of the Board of Directors of
Mukka Proteins Limited
Sd/-
Kalandan Mohammed Haris
Managing Director & CEO

Place : Mangaluru
Date : 07-11-2026

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They begin as unanswered questions.

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